

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY

TEACHING MANUAL

Photography

Session Roadmap · Lesson Notes · Concept Diagrams · Answer Keys

READY TO TEACH

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OVERVIEW

Course Roadmap

What we cover in every session

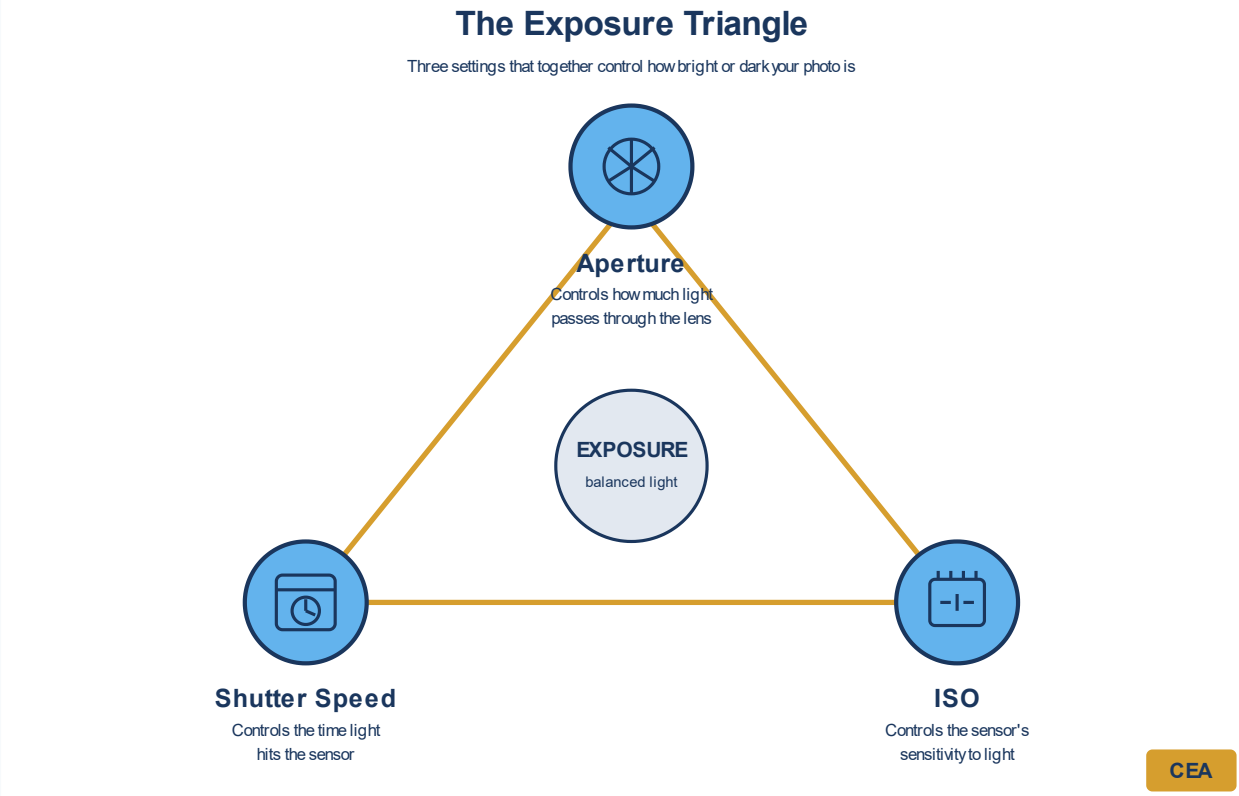
#	SESSION TOPIC	WEEK / MODULE	DURATION
01	Photography Foundations	Week 1 â€” Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)	105 minutes
02	Composition and Lighting	Week 1 â€” Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)	105 minutes
03	Shooting People Products and Events	Week 1 â€” Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)	105 minutes
04	Basic Photo Editing	Week 2 â€” Module 2: "Process and Deliver"	105 minutes
05	Building a Portfolio and Pricing Photography	Week 2 â€” Module 2: "Process and Deliver"	105 minutes
06	Capstone Photo Shoot and Portfolio	Week 2 â€” Module 2: "Process and Deliver"	105 minutes

How to use this book: Each session below is a complete, ready-to-teach lesson note. Section A tells you what to prepare, B lists the outcomes, D–F are the teaching content, G–H are your demos and practicals, and the knowledge check with answer key is at the end. The concept diagram for each session is embedded as a visual aid.

SESSION 01 OF 6

Photography Foundations

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 01



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 1 â€" PHOTOGRAPHY FOUNDATIONS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	1 of 6
Session title	Photography Foundations
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with photography)
Prerequisite knowledge	Basic smartphone use â€" opening apps, taking a photo, typing. No prior photography knowledge assumed. If a learner struggles with the phone basics, pair them with a confident

Item	Detail
	learner for the first practical.
Connection to previous work	This is the first session of the course. There is no previous photography session. It connects to everyday life: almost every learner has a phone camera and has taken photos that came out dark, blurry or crooked.
Preparation before class	Print the three "same subject, three results" comparison sets (Section D); a projector connected to the instructor's phone for live camera demonstration; a whiteboard for the exposure triangle diagram; the "Camera Setup Checklist" (Section H) printed per learner; learners' phones fully charged with at least 1 GB free storage; confirm the class understands this is a practical, hands-on course with a consent rule for photographing people.

Instructor note on tone: This session must feel *empowering*, not technical. Learners should leave feeling "I understand what my phone camera is doing and I can control it," not "photography is too complicated." Keep the mood practical, encouraging and connected to their real lives â€” their shops, their churches, their families.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** in their own words what makes a good photograph, using five key words: clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
2. **Describe** the exposure triangle in simplified terms â€” aperture, shutter speed and ISO â€” and explain why an image comes out dark, bright or blurry.
3. **Distinguish** between a phone camera and a dedicated camera, explaining what each is good for and what megapixels actually tell you.
4. **Explain** how focus works on a phone and demonstrate tap-to-focus, focus lock and focus check.
5. **Set up** a phone camera sensibly: grid lines on, high resolution, HDR deliberate, beauty filters off.
6. **Produce** a sharp, correctly exposed photograph of a real subject using tap-to-focus, exposure adjustment and a steady hold, without any filter or beautification.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera (Android or iPhone; any phone made in the last several years is capable).
- Instructor's phone connected to a projector or large screen for live camera demonstration.
- A phone tripod or improvised stand (stack of books, selfie stick) for the instructor demonstration.
- An academy reflector or improvised white card (A4 paper works) for bouncing light.

Software

- The phone's built-in camera app (default shooting tool â€” no special app needed for this session).
- No editing software needed today; editing begins in Session 4.

Accounts

- None required this session.

Sample files

- **Three comparison sets** printed or projected (Section D): each set shows the same subject photographed three ways â€” well, poorly and acceptably â€ so learners can name the difference.
- **Camera Setup Checklist** (Section H) â€ one printed page per learner.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 1.1 â€" "What Makes a Good Photo?" (a table with the five quality words and room for learners to write their own definition).
- Worksheet 1.2 â€" "Diagnose the Image" (four sample images; learners label each as dark, bright, blurry or flat and explain why).

Tools

- A whiteboard and markers for drawing the exposure triangle.
- A ruler or straight edge for drawing the triangle neatly.

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a capable phone

- Any phone with a working camera works. A learner without a phone may pair with a classmate, use an academy phone or use an academy computer with a webcam for the focus and exposure exercises. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Safety note for the instructor (read aloud at the start): Before we photograph any person in this class â€" including classmates â€" we ask for their permission first. If someone says no, we put the camera down. No exceptions. This is a rule of the academy, not a suggestion.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show the same subject â€" a bottle of water on a table â€" photographed three ways:

- **Photo A (good):** Sharp, well-lit, clean background, subject centred with space around it.
- **Photo B (poor):** Dark, blurry, cluttered background, subject barely visible.
- **Photo C (acceptable):** Better than B but not great â€" slightly crooked, a bit dark, background distracting.

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. Look at these three photos. Same bottle, same table, same room. But one looks like it could be in a shop's advert, one looks like a mistake, and one is somewhere in between. Hands up â€" which one would you use for your business? â€¦ Photo A, almost everyone agrees. Now, turn to the person next to you and tell them: what is different about Photo A? You have 90 seconds."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say things like "it is brighter," "you can see it clearly," "the background is clean," "it is not blurry," "it looks professional." Accept all answers and write the key words on the board: **bright, sharp, clean, clear, professional.**

Then reveal the lesson: Say clearly:

> *"Those words â€" bright, sharp, clean, clear â€" are not luck. They are choices a photographer makes. Today you will learn to make those choices on your own phone. By the end of this session, you will be able to look at a photo and say exactly what is wrong with it, and then fix it."*

Why this opener works: It uses a subject every learner can recognise, it produces instant opinions ("I would never use Photo B"), and it introduces the five quality words before any technical explanation, so the lecture has a hook to hang on.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What happens when you press the shutter button on your phone camera? What does the camera actually do?"

- Expected answer: It opens a hole (the lens), lets light in for a moment, and records what it sees. If a learner says "it takes a picture," press gently: "Yes, but *how*? What has to happen for the picture to look right?"
- Common gap: Learners treat the camera as a black box. Clarify: "The camera is a light-capturing machine. Light comes in through the lens, and the camera decides how much light to let in and for how long. Those decisions determine whether your photo is bright, dark or blurry."

Question 2: "Have you ever taken a photo that came out too dark or too bright? What do you think went wrong?"

- Expected answer: Learners will describe real experiences â€" a night photo that was black, a photo of a person against a window where the face was dark, a photo in bright sun that looked washed out.
- Common gap: Learners blame the phone. Clarify: "The phone did exactly what it was told â€" but it was told the wrong thing. Today you learn to tell it the right thing."

Question 3: "What is the difference between a smartphone camera and a 'proper' camera â€" like a DSLR?"

- Expected answer: Learners may say the proper camera is better, or bigger, or more expensive. Accept this and refine: "A dedicated camera has a bigger lens and more manual control. But the phone in your pocket can produce excellent photographs when you understand the same principles. The principles matter more than the price tag."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You already have the tool â€" your phone. Today we make sure you understand what it is doing when you press that button, so you can control it. Think of it like driving a car: right now most of us are pressing the accelerator and hoping. Today you learn what the brakes and steering wheel do."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes opening the camera app on the projector and pointing out the shutter button, the viewfinder and the settings icon before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What makes a good photograph

The idea. A good photograph is not an accident. It is the result of a photographer making deliberate choices about five things: what the photo is for, how the subject is arranged, how light falls on the subject, whether the subject is sharp, and whether the right moment was captured.

The five quality words (teach these and return to them all session):

Quality word	Plain-English meaning	How to recognise it
Clarity	The subject is sharp â€" you can see the details, not a blurry mess	Zoom in on the subject: can you see texture, edges, fine details?
Light	The subject is correctly exposed â€" not too dark, not too bright	Look at the subject's face or the product: can you see it clearly without squinting or losing detail?
Composition	The subject is arranged in the frame in a way that is pleasing and intentional	Does the photo look like someone *chose* where everything goes, or did they just point and shoot?
Moment	The photo captures the right instant â€" the smile, the action, the expression	Does the photo feel alive, or does it feel like a stiff, awkward snapshot?
Purpose	The photo does the job it was meant to do â€" sell a product, tell a story, capture a memory	If someone asked you to take this photo, would they be happy with the result?

Why these five words matter. They are the vocabulary you will use for the rest of the course. In Session 2 you will learn composition techniques. In Session 3 you will learn to capture the right moment. Today you focus on the first two â€" clarity and light â€" because without those, nothing else matters. A beautifully composed photo that is blurry is still a bad photo.

Real-life comparison. Think of a plate of food at a restaurant. If the food is beautifully arranged on the plate (composition), the chef is skilled (moment), and the dish is exactly what you ordered (purpose) â€" but the lights are so dim you cannot see the

food (light), and the plate is spinning so fast everything is a smear (clarity) â€" you would send it back. A photograph works the same way. Light and clarity are the foundation; everything else is built on top.

Important limitation / misconception. Learners often think good photographs require expensive cameras or professional lighting. This is false. The phone in your pocket, used well, can produce photographs that are sharp, well-lit and usable for a business. The difference between a snapshot and a photograph is not the camera â€" it is the photographer's choices.

How a learner recognises a good photograph. Show any photo and ask five questions: Is the subject sharp? Is the light right? Is the composition intentional? Did it capture the right moment? Does it serve its purpose? If the answer is yes to all five, it is a good photograph.

F.2 The exposure triangle â€" simplified

The idea. Every camera â€" phone or professional â€" makes three decisions when you press the shutter button. Together, these three decisions determine how bright or dark your photo is. Photographers call these three decisions the **exposure triangle**.

Plain-English definition. The exposure triangle is a way of understanding three camera settings that control how much light reaches the sensor:

Setting	What it does	Simple analogy	What happens when it is wrong
Aperture	How wide the lens opening is â€" how much light comes in	Like a window: a big window lets in more light than a small window	If the aperture is too small (or the light is low), the photo comes out dark
Shutter speed	How long the shutter stays open â€" how long light is collected	Like blinking: a slow blink collects more light than a fast blink	If the shutter is too fast in low light, the photo comes out dark; if the subject moves during a slow shutter, the photo comes out blurry
ISO	How sensitive the camera's sensor is to light	Like turning up the volume on a quiet radio	A high ISO brightens a dark scene but adds grain (noise); a low ISO gives a cleaner image but needs more light

The key insight (say this slowly):

> *"These three settings work together. If you make one of them let in less light, you must compensate with one of the others. A photographer's job is to balance them so the photo is correctly exposed â€" not too dark, not too bright."*

How this works on a phone (the crucial bridge):

On a professional camera, the photographer controls aperture, shutter speed and ISO directly. On a phone, the camera app makes these decisions automatically â€" but you can influence them:

- **Tap to focus:** Tapping the screen tells the camera where to focus *and* how much light to let in for that spot. Tapping a dark area brightens the photo; tapping a bright area darkens it.
- **Exposure adjustment slider:** On most phone cameras, after you tap, a small sun icon or slider appears. Slide it up to brighten, down to darken.
- **HDR (High Dynamic Range):** The camera takes several photos at different brightness levels and combines them. Useful for high-contrast scenes (a person against a bright window). Can be turned on or off in camera settings.

Why photos come out dark (the three usual reasons):

1. **Not enough light in the scene** â€" the room is dim, it is evening, the subject is in shadow.
2. **The camera exposed for the wrong part of the scene** â€" you photographed a person against a bright window; the camera exposed for the window (bright) and the face went dark.
3. **The shutter was too fast** â€" in low light, the camera used a fast shutter to avoid blur, which collected too little light.

Why photos come out bright (washed out):

1. **Too much light** â€" shooting in bright sun without adjusting exposure.
2. **The camera exposed for a dark area** â€" tapping a dark shadow makes the camera brighten everything, and the rest of the photo becomes overexposed.

Why photos come out blurry (the two usual reasons):

1. **Camera shake** â€” the photographer's hands moved during the exposure. Most common in low light when the shutter is slower.
2. **Subject movement** â€” the subject moved during the exposure. Common with children, pets, people walking, or anything that is not still.
3. **Focus error** â€” the camera focused on the wrong thing (the background instead of the subject, or nothing at all in very low light).

Real-life comparison. The exposure triangle is like cooking rice. The aperture is the amount of water, the shutter speed is the cooking time, and ISO is the heat. Too little water or too short a time and the rice is hard (dark photo). Too much heat and the rice burns (grainy photo from high ISO). A good cook balances all three; a good photographer does the same.

Misconception to correct. "If my photo is dark, I can just brighten it later in editing." Partially true â€” but brightening a very dark photo in editing also brightens the noise and grain, making it look rough. It is always better to get the exposure right in the camera. Editing can fix small problems; it cannot fix a badly exposed photo completely.

F.3 Phone camera vs dedicated camera

The idea. A phone camera and a dedicated camera (DSLR or mirrorless) are different tools with different strengths. Understanding the differences helps you choose the right tool and understand what your phone can and cannot do.

Feature	Phone camera	Dedicated camera (DSLR / mirrorless)
Lens size	Small â€” limited by the phone's thin body	Large â€” interchangeable lenses for different purposes
Sensor size	Small â€” collects less light, more noise in dark scenes	Large â€” collects more light, cleaner images in dark scenes
Manual control	Limited â€” most settings are automatic or semi-automatic	Full â€” the photographer controls aperture, shutter speed and ISO directly
Zoom	Digital zoom (cropping the image â€” loses quality)	Optical zoom (the lens magnifies â€ keeps quality)
Portability	Always with you â€ you never miss a moment	Bulky â€ you must carry it deliberately
Cost	Already owned	â‚¦300,000â€"â‚¦1,500,000+ for a body and lens
Best for	Everyday photography, social media, quick business shots, learning	Professional work, low light, sports, wildlife, studio work

What megapixels actually tell you (and what they do not):

A megapixel is one million pixels â€ tiny dots of colour that make up a digital image. A 12-megapixel camera produces images made of 12 million dots. A 48-megapixel camera produces images made of 48 million dots.

- **What megapixels tell you:** How large you can print the photo or how much you can crop it and still have a usable image. A 12-megapixel image can be printed at A4 size and look sharp. A 48-megapixel image can be cropped to a small portion and still print sharply.
- **What megapixels do NOT tell you:** How good the photo looks. A 12-megapixel photo from a large sensor with a good lens will look better than a 48-megapixel photo from a small sensor with a poor lens, especially in low light. Megapixels are about *quantity of detail*, not *quality of light*.

Why this matters for this course: Learners sometimes feel their phone is inferior because it has "only" 12 megapixels. Reassure them: for WhatsApp Business catalogues, Instagram, Facebook and most small-business uses, 12 megapixels is more than enough. The sensor size and lens quality matter more for image quality, and the photographer's choices matter most of all.

Real-life comparison. A phone camera is like a bicycle: it is always available, it gets you where you need to go, and it costs nothing extra. A dedicated camera is like a car: it is faster, more comfortable on long journeys, and more capable â€ but you have to plan to bring it, it costs money, and it does not help you if it is at home. For most everyday photography, the bicycle is exactly what you need.

F.4 How focus works on a phone

The idea. Focus is the camera's ability to make the subject sharp. On a phone, focus is automatic â€” but you can and should control it deliberately.

The three focus skills every photographer needs:

1. Tap to focus.

- Open the camera app.
- Look at the screen. Tap the subject you want to be sharp.
- A focus square or circle appears around where you tapped. The camera now focuses on that spot.
- On most phones, tapping also sets the exposure (brightness) for that spot â€” this is why tapping a bright window makes the rest of the photo dark, and tapping a dark face brightens the photo.

2. Lock focus and exposure.

- After tapping, press and hold the focus square for 2â€“3 seconds (on iPhone) or tap the lock icon (on many Android phones).
- The focus and exposure are now locked. You can move the camera slightly without the focus changing.
- This is useful when you want to focus on a subject but compose the photo differently â€” focus first, then reframe.

3. Focus check.

- After taking the photo, zoom in on it (pinch to zoom in the gallery).
- Look at the subject's eyes (for a person) or the key detail (for a product). Are they sharp?
- If they are blurry, the photo is not usable â€” no amount of editing will fix a blurry subject.

Common focus mistakes and how to avoid them:

- **Not tapping:** Letting the camera choose the focus point automatically. The camera may focus on the background, a distracting object, or nothing in particular. Always tap your subject.
- **Tapping too late:** Tapping and immediately shooting. The camera needs a moment to adjust focus. Tap, wait half a second, then shoot.
- **Moving after tapping:** Tapping to focus, then moving the camera significantly before shooting. The focus may shift. Lock focus if you need to move.

Real-life comparison. Focus is like using a magnifying glass to look at something small. You move the glass until the subject is sharp. If you move your hand, the subject blurs. Tap-to-focus is you placing the magnifying glass exactly where you need it.

F.5 Setting up your phone camera

The idea. Before you take a serious photograph, set up your camera so it behaves predictably. Four settings matter for beginners:

1. Grid lines on.

- Grid lines are two horizontal and two vertical lines that divide the screen into nine equal rectangles (a 3Ã—3 grid).
- They help you compose photos using the rule of thirds (taught in Session 2).
- How to turn on: iPhone â€” Settings > Camera > Grid. Android â€” open the camera app, tap the settings icon (usually a gear), look for "Grid" or "Grid lines," turn it on.

2. High resolution.

- Make sure your camera is set to take photos at the full resolution of the sensor.
- iPhone: Settings > Camera > Formats â€” choose "High Efficiency" (default) or "Most Compatible."
- Android: Open camera app > Settings > Photo size or Resolution â€” choose the highest number of megapixels available.
- Why this matters: if you accidentally set a low resolution, your photos will look soft when printed or viewed on a larger screen.

3. HDR â€” know what it does, use it deliberately.

- HDR (High Dynamic Range) takes multiple photos at different brightness levels and combines them.
- Useful when: the scene has very bright and very dark areas (a person against a bright window, a landscape with a bright sky and dark foreground).

- Turn it off when: photographing moving subjects (HDR can create ghosting or blur) or when you want a specific artistic effect.
- iPhone: Settings > Camera â€" turn HDR on or off. Android: HDR setting is usually in the camera app itself.

4. Beauty filters off.

- Many phone cameras and social media apps apply automatic "beauty" filters that smooth skin, enlarge eyes, or alter facial features.
- For this course: turn them off. We want photographs that look like the real person, not a filtered version.
- Why: beauty filters create unrealistic expectations and can make a person look unnatural. In business photography, they can be misleading.
- How to turn off: Look for "Beauty," "Smooth," "Face," or "Filters" in your camera app settings and turn them off.

The Camera Setup Checklist (Worksheet 1.3): Before every photo shoot in this course, run through this checklist:

- ☐ Grid lines are ON
- ☐ Resolution is set to the highest available
- ☐ HDR is set appropriately for the scene (on for high contrast, off for movement)
- ☐ Beauty filters are OFF
- ☐ Lens is clean (wipe with a soft cloth)
- ☐ Storage has at least 500 MB free

Real-life comparison. Setting up your camera is like preparing a kitchen before cooking. You wash your hands, check you have the right ingredients, and make sure the stove is working. If you skip preparation, the meal may still be edible â€" but it will not be as good as it could be.

F.6 The sharpness routine â€" getting sharp photos every time

The idea. Sharpness is the foundation of a good photograph. A blurry photo is unusable, no matter how good the composition or light. Here is a repeatable routine for getting sharp photos:

The 5-Step Sharpness Routine:

Step 1: Hold the phone steady.

- Hold the phone with both hands.
- Tuck your elbows into your sides.
- If possible, lean against a wall or rest the phone on a solid surface.
- If using a tripod or improvised stand (books, selfie stick), lock it in place.

Step 2: Tap to focus on the subject.

- Tap the subject on the screen.
- Wait half a second for the camera to adjust.
- Check the focus square â€" is it on the right spot?

Step 3: Check the exposure.

- Is the subject correctly exposed (not too dark, not too bright)?
- If not, use the exposure slider (slide up to brighten, down to darken).

Step 4: Check the background.

- Is the background clean and uncluttered?
- Is anything distracting growing out of the subject's head?
- If so, move the camera or the subject.

Step 5: Take several frames.

- Take at least 3 photos of the same scene.
- Do not delete any until you have reviewed them on a larger screen.
- Why: one frame may be slightly blurry, one may have the subject blinking, one may be perfect. Taking several frames increases your chances of getting a sharp, usable image.

Why taking several frames matters: Even professional photographers take multiple frames. The difference between a professional and an amateur is not that the professional always gets it right on the first try â€" it is that the professional takes enough tries to guarantee a good result.

Real-life comparison. The sharpness routine is like checking your work before submitting it. A student who writes an exam answer and hands it in without checking will make silly mistakes. A student who checks their work catches those mistakes. The sharpness routine is checking your work before you commit to it.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- A good photograph has five qualities: clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
- The exposure triangle â€" aperture, shutter speed and ISO â€" controls how bright or dark your photo is.
- On a phone, you influence the exposure through tap-to-focus and the exposure slider.
- A phone camera is a legitimate tool for business and everyday photography; megapixels measure detail quantity, not quality.
- Tap to focus, lock focus and focus check are the three focus skills every photographer needs.
- Set up your camera: grid on, high resolution, HDR deliberate, beauty filters off.
- The 5-step sharpness routine â€" steady, focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames â€" produces sharp photos reliably.

Key concept diagram:

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flowchart LR
    A[Aperture] --> D[Exposure]
    B[Shutter Speed] --> D
    C[ISO] --> D
    D --> E[Good photo]
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G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A phone connected to the projector, camera app open.
- A simple subject on a table: a bottle of water, a notebook, or a piece of fruit.
- A second subject in a different location: a person (a willing colleague or a mannequin/photograph of a person) against a bright window.
- A stack of books or a phone tripod for the steady-hold demonstration.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" the exposure triangle in action (5 minutes)

Say: "Watch the screen. I am going to take three photos of this bottle. Same bottle, same position. But I will change one thing each time â€" and you will see the result."

Take Photo 1: Tap the bottle, expose normally. Show the result on the projector. "This is correctly exposed â€" you can see the label, the water level, the colours."

Take Photo 2: Tap the background (the wall behind the bottle). "Now I tapped the wall. The camera exposed for the wall, which is bright. What happens to the bottle?" Show the result. "The bottle is darker â€" almost a silhouette. The camera let in less light because I tapped something bright."

Take Photo 3: Tap the bottle, then use the exposure slider to brighten. "Now I tapped the bottle and slid the exposure up. What happens?" Show the result. "The bottle is brighter â€" maybe too bright. This is what happens when you over-expose."

Say: "One tap, one slider â€" that is how you control exposure on a phone. The camera does the maths; you make the decisions."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" focus control (4 minutes)

Say: "Now watch focus. I am going to focus on the bottle, then on the background."

Focus on the bottle: Tap the bottle. Show the focus square. "The square is on the bottle. The bottle is sharp."

Focus on the background: Tap the wall behind the bottle. "Now the square is on the wall. What happened to the bottle?" Show the result. "The bottle is blurry â€” out of focus. The camera focused on what I tapped, not on the bottle."

Lock focus: Tap and hold the focus square. "Now I locked the focus. Watch â€ I can move the camera slightly and the focus stays on the bottle." Move the camera a little, take a photo. Show it. "Sharp. Lock focus is useful when you want to compose the photo differently after focusing."

Say: "Focus is not automatic in the way most people think. The camera focuses where you tell it. If you do not tell it, it guesses â€ and it guesses wrong often enough to ruin photos."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€ the sharpness routine (4 minutes)

Say: "Now I will run the 5-step sharpness routine on a real subject. Watch and count the steps."

Step 1: Hold the phone with both hands, elbows tucked. "Steady hold."

Step 2: Tap the subject on screen. "Tap to focus."

Step 3: Check the exposure, adjust the slider. "Check exposure."

Step 4: Check the background â€ move the camera slightly to remove a distracting object. "Check background."

Step 5: Take three photos in a row. "Take several frames."

Say: "Five steps, every time. It becomes a habit â€ like brushing your teeth. You do not think about it after a while, but your photos are sharp because you do it."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€ before and after (2 minutes)

Show a blurry, poorly exposed photo (taken earlier or from the sample files). "This is what happens without the routine â€ dark, blurry, unusable."

Show a sharp, well-exposed photo (taken using the routine). "This is what happens with the routine. Same phone, same room, same subject. The difference is the photographer, not the camera."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "What happened when I tapped the bright wall?" (The subject went dark.)
- "What is the difference between tapping the subject and tapping the background?" (The camera focuses and exposes for wherever you tap.)
- "Why take three photos instead of one?" (One might be blurry, one might have the subject blinking, one will be good.)
- "Can you fix a blurry photo in editing?" (No â€ editing cannot create detail that was not captured. Prevention is the only cure.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner sets up their phone camera, applies the sharpness routine and produces three sharp, correctly exposed photographs of a real subject.

Starting materials: Learner's own phone; the printed Camera Setup Checklist; a subject in the classroom (a classmate who has agreed, a bag, a plant, a book, a water bottle, or any object).

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open your camera app. Turn on **grid lines** in your settings. (Instructor waits while learners find the setting; help those who cannot.)
2. Set **resolution to the highest available**. Check that **beauty filters are off**.
3. Choose your subject. It can be a classmate (ask their permission first â€ this is the consent rule), your bag, a plant, or any object on your desk.
4. **Step 1 â€ Steady hold:** Hold the phone with both hands, elbows tucked. If you have a surface nearby, rest your hands on it.
5. **Step 2 â€ Tap to focus:** Tap your subject on the screen. Wait half a second.
6. **Step 3 â€ Check exposure:** Is the subject too dark or too bright? Use the exposure slider to adjust.

7. **Step 4 â€" Check background:** Is anything distracting in the background? Move slightly to remove it.
8. **Step 5 â€" Take three frames:** Take three photos of the same scene without moving.
9. **Focus check:** Open each photo in your gallery and pinch to zoom in on the subject. Is it sharp? If not, repeat steps 4â€"8.
10. Repeat steps 4â€"9 for a second subject and a third subject.

Expected result: Nine sharp, correctly exposed photographs (three per subject, three subjects) in the learner's gallery.

Points to pause and predict:

- After step 5: "Look at the focus square â€" is it on your subject? If it is on the background, what will happen?" (The subject will be blurry.)
- After step 8: "Why three frames? What might be wrong with frame one that is not wrong with frame three?" (Frame one might be slightly blurry from movement; the subject might blink in frame two; frame three is perfect.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner cannot find the grid setting â†' Show them on their phone. The location differs between iPhone and Android; walk to each learner and help.
- Learner's photos are consistently dark â†' Check if they are tapping a bright part of the scene. Have them tap the subject directly.
- Learner's photos are blurry â†' Check if they are moving the camera after tapping. Have them hold steady or rest the phone on something.
- Learner has a beauty filter on and cannot turn it off â†' Check the camera app settings; some phones have a separate "Beauty" mode in the camera app. Turn it off or switch to "Photo" mode.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Grid lines are ON
- ☐ Resolution is set to highest
- ☐ Beauty filters are OFF
- ☐ Three photos taken of subject 1, all sharp and correctly exposed
- ☐ Three photos taken of subject 2, all sharp and correctly exposed
- ☐ Three photos taken of subject 3, all sharp and correctly exposed
- ☐ Every photo has been focus-checked by zooming in

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Photograph the same subject in three different lighting situations and diagnose the result.

Setup: Choose one subject â€" a classmate, your bag, a bottle, or a plant. You will photograph it in three places:

1. **Near a window or in open shade** (good light).
2. **In a dim corner or against a bright background** (challenging light).
3. **In direct bright sun** (harsh light).

Requirements:

1. For each lighting situation, take at least one photo using the 5-step sharpness routine.
2. After each photo, use Worksheet 1.2 ("Diagnose the Image") to label the photo: is it **dark, bright, blurry or flat**?
3. Write one sentence explaining *why* you think it came out that way.

Constraints:

- Use only the built-in camera app â€" no filters, no editing.
- Photograph a classmate only if they have agreed. If not, use an object.
- Do not leave the building â€" find the three lighting situations inside or near the classroom.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Three photos taken in three different lighting situations.

- Each photo is labelled with a diagnosis (dark / bright / blurry / flat) and a one-sentence reason.
- At least one photo is sharp and correctly exposed (the good-light photo).

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: "Good light" means the subject is clearly visible without squinting or being in shadow. A window with indirect light is good light.
- Hint 2: "Challenging light" means the subject is darker than the background, or the background is much brighter than the subject.
- Hint 3: If your photo is blurry, go back to Step 1 of the sharpness routine â€" hold the phone steadier.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Photo 1 â€" near a window (good light): Sharp, correctly exposed, subject clearly visible. Diagnosis: **none â€" good photo.** Reason: "The light is soft and even, and I tapped to focus on the subject."

Photo 2 â€" dim corner against bright background: Subject is dark, almost a silhouette. Diagnosis: **dark.** Reason: "The background is bright and the subject is in shadow. The camera exposed for the background, not the subject. I should have tapped the subject and brightened the exposure."

Photo 3 â€" direct bright sun: Harsh shadows on the subject's face or the object. Diagnosis: **flat or overly bright.** Reason: "Direct sun creates hard shadows and bright highlights. The photo looks contrasty and unflattering. Open shade or indirect light would be better."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Three photos taken in three different lighting situations (3)
- Each photo correctly diagnosed (3)
- At least one photo sharp and correctly exposed (2)
- Reason given is accurate (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Chinedu* runs a small phone accessory shop in Port Harcourt. He wants to post photos of his products â€" phone cases, earbuds, chargers â€" on his WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram. He takes photos on his phone during the day, in his shop, and posts them directly. His photos are dark, blurry and have cluttered backgrounds (other products, his hands, the counter). Customers rarely order from the photos; they prefer to come to the shop to see the products in person.

Relevant facts.

- Chinedu's phone is a recent model with a good 12-megapixel camera.
- He takes photos standing in his shop, holding the phone in one hand, the product in the other.
- He does not tap to focus â€" he just points and shoots.
- He has never changed any camera settings.
- His shop has a window that lets in good natural light, but he usually photographs under the fluorescent ceiling lights.

Decision point. What is the main reason Chinedu's photos are not helping his business?

Possible approaches.

1. Buy a better phone with more megapixels.
2. Learn to use the camera he already has â€" tap to focus, expose correctly, use natural light, hold steady.
3. Hire a professional photographer once to take all his product photos.

Recommended solution. Approach 2. Chinedu's phone is already capable of good photographs. His problem is not the camera â€" it is the photographer's choices. By learning to tap to focus, expose correctly, use the natural light from his window and hold the phone steady, he can produce photos that look professional and help sell his products.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 costs money (a new phone costs â‚¦150,000â€"â‚¦400,000) and does not solve the problem â€" a better phone used badly still produces bad photos.

- Approach 2 is free, takes a few hours to learn, and the skill stays with Chinedu forever. He can photograph new products himself whenever he needs to.
- Approach 3 works but costs money every time (a product photographer in Port Harcourt may charge â‚¦5,000â€“â‚¦20,000 for a small set). Chinedu has many products; hiring a photographer for all of them is expensive.

Professional connection. Small business owners across Nigeria lose sales every day because of poor product photographs. A business that can produce its own clean, sharp product photos saves money and looks more professional. This is a skill that pays for itself many times over.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Not tapping to focus

Symptoms: Photos where the subject is blurry but the background is sharp, or where everything looks slightly soft. **Likely cause:** The photographer let the camera choose the focus point automatically. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner to open a photo and zoom in on the subject. Is the subject sharp, or is something else sharp? **Corrective steps:** Tap the subject on the screen before every photo. Wait half a second before shooting. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is sharp when zoomed in. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make tapping a habit â€” tap before every single photo.

K.2 Photos consistently too dark

Symptoms: Every photo looks dim, the subject is hard to see, details are lost in shadow. **Likely cause:** The photographer is tapping a bright part of the scene (or not tapping at all), so the camera exposes for the bright area and the subject goes dark. **How to investigate:** Check if the learner is tapping the subject or the background. Check if the exposure slider is being used. **Corrective steps:** Tap the subject directly. If it is still dark, slide the exposure slider up. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is clearly visible with detail. **How to prevent recurrence:** Always tap the subject; adjust exposure after tapping.

K.3 Photos consistently too bright (washed out)

Symptoms: The photo looks pale, colours are faded, bright areas are pure white with no detail. **Likely cause:** Over-exposure â€” too much light reaching the sensor, often from tapping a dark area and not adjusting, or from shooting in very bright conditions without reducing exposure. **How to investigate:** Check the exposure slider â€” is it set too high? Check if the scene is very bright. **Corrective steps:** Tap the subject. If it is too bright, slide the exposure slider down. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject has natural colour and visible detail in both highlights and shadows. **How to prevent recurrence:** Check the photo immediately after taking it. If it looks washed out, adjust and retake.

K.4 Blurry photos from camera shake

Symptoms: The whole photo is blurred, as if smeared slightly. **Likely cause:** The photographer's hands moved during the exposure, especially in low light when the shutter is slower. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner how they were holding the phone. Were they using one hand? Were they standing still or moving? **Corrective steps:** Hold the phone with both hands, elbows tucked. Rest on a solid surface if possible. Take the photo gently â€” do not jab the shutter button. **How to confirm resolved:** The photo is sharp, not smeared. **How to prevent recurrence:** Always use the two-handed hold. In low light, use a surface or a tripod.

K.5 Blurry photos from subject movement

Symptoms: The subject is blurry but the background is sharp. **Likely cause:** The subject moved during the exposure â€” a person turned their head, a child moved, a hand shifted. **How to investigate:** Is the background sharp but the subject blurry? If so, the camera was steady but the subject moved. **Corrective steps:** Ask the subject to hold still. Take the photo quickly after focusing. Take several frames and pick the sharpest. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is sharp. **How to prevent recurrence:** For moving subjects, take many frames and choose the best. For portraits, ask the person to hold still and breathe out before you shoot.

K.6 Leaving beauty filters on

Symptoms: People in photos look unnatural â€” skin is too smooth, eyes are too large, facial features are distorted. **Likely cause:** A beauty or smooth filter is active in the camera app or social media app. **How to investigate:** Look at a portrait photo

â€" does the person's skin look like skin, or like plastic? **Corrective steps:** Turn off all beauty, smooth and face filters in the camera app settings. Turn off any "beauty mode" in the social media app before posting. **How to confirm resolved:** People in photos look like real people with natural skin texture. **How to prevent recurrence:** Check camera settings before every shoot. Make "filters off" part of the pre-shoot routine.

K.7 Not taking several frames

Symptoms: The photographer takes one photo, it is slightly blurry or the subject blinked, and they have no alternative. **Likely cause:** The habit of taking a single frame and moving on. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner how many photos they took of their last subject. If the answer is one, this is the problem. **Corrective steps:** Take at least three frames of every scene. Review them and pick the best. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner always has a sharp, usable photo. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make "take three" a rule. It costs nothing â€" storage is cheap.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" look at the actual photo, ask the learner what they did, and confirm the cause before correcting. Teaching learners to diagnose before fixing is part of becoming a photographer.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Focus and Exposure Drills â€" My First Nine"

Purpose: To practise the sharpness routine and exposure control on real subjects, producing a set of nine sharp, correctly exposed photographs that form the technical foundation of the capstone portfolio.

Realistic scenario. You are a new photographer building your skill. Your client â€" a friend with a small business, or your own business â€" needs clear, professional-looking product photos. Before you can take those photos, you need to prove to yourself that you can consistently produce sharp, correctly exposed images on your phone.

Detailed instructions:

1. Find **three different subjects** in your home or neighbourhood: one person (with their permission), one product (a shoe, a bag, a plate of food, a phone accessory), and one scene (a street view, a garden, a room).
2. For each subject, use the **5-step sharpness routine** and take **at least three photos**.
3. Review all photos. Delete the blurry or poorly exposed ones. Keep only the sharp, correctly exposed ones.
4. From your keeps, select the **best three photos** (one per subject).
5. For each of the three, write one sentence: *"This photo is sharp and correctly exposed because I _____."* (e.g., "â€¦because I tapped to focus on the subject and held the phone steady with both hands.")
6. Organise your nine photos (three per subject) in a folder named `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname`.

Required deliverables:

- A folder with at least nine photos (three per subject, three subjects).
- A short written note (three sentences) explaining why your three best photos are sharp and correctly exposed.

Submission format: Share the folder with the instructor (via WhatsApp, Google Drive or a USB stick) or bring your phone to Session 2 and show the folder.

Deadline: Before Session 2.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Sharpness	3	All nine photos are sharp on the subject (verified by zooming in)
Correct exposure	3	All nine photos are correctly exposed â€" not too dark, not too bright
Variety of subjects	2	Three different subjects (person, product, scene)
Written explanation	2	Three accurate sentences explaining why the best photos work

Common mistakes to avoid: submitting blurry photos; submitting photos where the subject is too dark to see; using beauty filters; photographing a person without their permission; taking only one photo per subject.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner submission contains:

- **Person:** A portrait of a classmate or family member, sharply focused on the eyes, correctly exposed (face is clearly visible, not a silhouette against a window).
- **Product:** A clean product shot â€" for example, a shoe on a plain surface, sharp, well-lit, background uncluttered.
- **Scene:** A street or room view that is sharp throughout and correctly exposed (not a dark interior with blown-out windows).
- Written note: "This photo is sharp and correctly exposed because I tapped to focus on the subject, held the phone steady with both hands, and checked the photo by zooming in before I moved on."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. In your own words, what makes a good photograph? Name the five quality words and explain one of them.

Q2. Multiple choice. Your photo of a person against a bright window comes out with the person very dark and almost invisible. What is the most likely reason? a) The phone's camera is broken. b) The camera exposed for the bright window, not for the person. c) The photo needs a beauty filter. d) The person was standing too close to the window.

Q3. Explain in your own words. What is the exposure triangle? Name the three parts and explain what happens when one of them is set wrong.

Q4. Practical identification. A classmate's photo is blurry â€" the whole image looks smeared. What are the two most likely causes, and how would you fix each one?

Q5. Matching. Match each term to its plain-English meaning: **aperture, shutter speed, ISO.** a) How sensitive the sensor is to light b) How wide the lens opening is c) How long the shutter stays open

Q6. Scenario. You are photographing a friend's product (a handbag) for her WhatsApp Business. The photo comes out sharp but the handbag is too dark to see the details. What are two things you could do to fix this?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. A good photograph has five qualities: clarity (sharpness), light (correct exposure), composition (intentional arrangement), moment (right instant) and purpose (does the job it was meant to do). Explanation of any one: e.g., clarity means the subject is sharp and you can see the details when you zoom in. (Accept any answer that names the five words and explains one correctly.)

A2. (b) The camera exposed for the bright window, not for the person. Fix: tap the person on the screen to set focus and exposure on them, then use the exposure slider if needed.

A3. The exposure triangle is the three camera settings that control how bright or dark a photo is: aperture (how wide the lens opening is), shutter speed (how long the shutter stays open) and ISO (how sensitive the sensor is to light). If aperture is too small or shutter is too fast in low light, the photo comes out dark. If ISO is too high, the photo comes out grainy. If the shutter is too slow and the subject moves, the photo comes out blurry. (Accept any answer that names all three parts and explains at least one consequence correctly.)

A4. The two most likely causes: (1) camera shake â€" the photographer's hands moved during the exposure. Fix: hold the phone with both hands, elbows tucked, and rest on a solid surface. (2) subject movement â€" the subject moved during the exposure. Fix: ask the subject to hold still and take several frames. (Accept both causes with correct fixes.)

A5. aperture = (b); shutter speed = (c); ISO = (a).

A6. Two things: (1) Tap the handbag on the screen to set focus and exposure on it â€" this tells the camera to expose for the handbag, not the bright background. (2) Use the exposure slider to brighten the photo after tapping. (3) Alternatively, move the handbag away from the bright background into more even light. (Accept any two correct actions.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that a good photograph is not luck â€" it is the result of deliberate choices. You learned the five quality words: clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose. You learned the exposure triangle in simple terms â€" aperture, shutter speed and ISO â€" and how they control whether your photo is bright, dark or blurry. You learned that a phone camera is a legitimate tool, what megapixels really mean, and how to control focus by tapping, locking and checking. You set up your camera properly â€" grid on, high resolution, beauty filters off â€" and you practised the 5-step sharpness routine: steady, focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames. You took nine photos and diagnosed why some worked and some did not.

Five important takeaways:

1. A good photograph has five qualities: clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
2. The exposure triangle â€" aperture, shutter speed and ISO â€" controls brightness; on a phone you influence it through tap-to-focus and the exposure slider.
3. Megapixels measure detail quantity, not quality â€" a 12-megapixel phone photo is more than enough for business use.
4. Tap to focus, lock focus and focus check â€" focus is a choice, not an accident.
5. The 5-step sharpness routine produces sharp photos reliably: steady, focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I name the five quality words and explain what each means?
- Can I explain the exposure triangle in simple terms and diagnose why a photo is dark, bright or blurry?
- Can I set up my phone camera: grid on, high resolution, beauty filters off?
- Can I tap to focus, lock focus and focus check?
- Can I run the 5-step sharpness routine without looking at my notes?
- Can I take three photos of the same subject and pick the sharpest one?

Connection to the next session. You now know how to make a photo sharp and correctly exposed. But a sharp, well-lit photo can still be boring â€" if the composition is poor. Next session we train the eye. You will learn the rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry and perspective, and you will learn to use natural light â€" golden hour, window light and open shade â€" to make your photographs look beautiful, not just usable. You will take a four-image composition series and a four-image light study.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner taps the subject before every photo without being reminded.
- Learner holds the phone with both hands and checks the background before shooting.
- Learner diagnoses their own photos accurately ("this one is dark because I tapped the bright wall").
- Learner can explain the exposure triangle in their own words, even if imperfectly.
- Learner takes multiple frames and selects the best.
- Learner asks permission before photographing a person.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A better phone will fix my photos." â†' No â€" the photographer's choices matter more than the camera.
- "I can fix everything in editing." â†' Editing can improve a good photo; it cannot rescue a badly exposed or blurry one.
- "Focus is automatic â€" I do not need to think about it." â†' The camera focuses where you tap; if you do not tap, it guesses.
- "Beauty filters make photos look better." â†' They create unrealistic images that can mislead clients.
- "One photo is enough." â†' Always take several frames; one might be blurry or the subject might blink.
- "Megapixels are the most important spec." â†' Megapixels measure detail quantity; sensor quality and the photographer's choices matter more.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Tap-and-focus drill:** Place three objects at different distances. The learner taps each one in turn and takes a photo. Review all three â€" each subject should be sharp.

2. **Exposure slider drill:** Photograph the same subject with the slider at minimum, middle and maximum. Review all three â€" the middle or slightly above should be correctly exposed.
3. **Diagnosis drill:** Show five photos (dark, bright, blurry, good, flat). The learner labels each and explains why. Review together.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a printed step-by-step card with the 5-step sharpness routine and the camera setup checklist. Pair the learner with a confident learner for the practical.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical and independent exercise.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to photograph the same subject using all three exposure triangle variables deliberately â€" tap to change aperture effect (by tapping different brightness areas), use a slower shutter (by photographing a moving subject like a fan or flowing water), and explain what happened in each case. They should also research and present one additional camera setting not covered in the session (e.g., white balance or scene modes).

Timing guidance. The priority is learners taking photos with the sharpness routine (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the exposure triangle lecture (F.2) to the key points â€" the three settings and how to influence them on a phone â€" and protect the practical time. A learner who leaves without taking nine sharp photos has no foundation for Session 2.

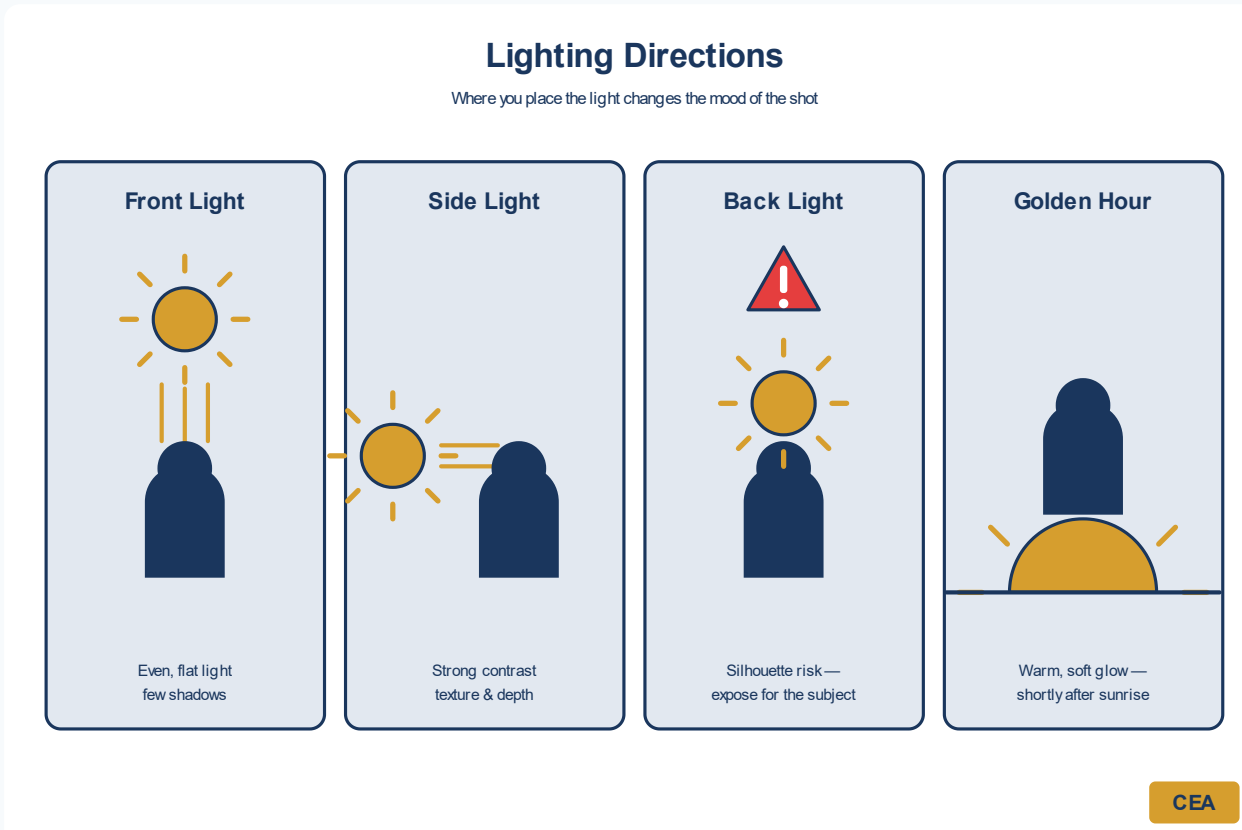
END OF SESSION 1

Next: Session 2 â€" Composition and Lighting.

SESSION 02 OF 6

Composition and Lighting

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 02



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 2 â€" COMPOSITION AND LIGHTING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	2 of 6
Session title	Composition and Lighting
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (practical, eye-training focus)
Prerequisite knowledge	Session 1 â€" the learner should be able to tap to focus, adjust exposure and produce a sharp, correctly exposed photo. The 5-step sharpness routine is assumed.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	In Session 1 you made photos sharp and correctly exposed. Today you learn to make them beautiful â€" by composing with intention and using light deliberately. A sharp, well-lit photo with poor composition is still a weak photo.
Preparation before class	Print the four-technique composition cards (rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry/perspective) as visual examples for the opening; a projector connected to the instructor's phone for live composition demonstration; two identical small objects (two cups, two bottles) for the good-light/bad-light comparison; a window with natural light and a shaded outdoor area (or two very different indoor lighting spots) for the light study; the "Composition Technique Log" (Section H) printed per learner.

Instructor note on tone: This session is about training the eye. Keep it visual â€" show more than you tell. Learners should feel the difference between good and bad light physically (squinting, leaning in) before they can name it. Celebrate every "I see it now" moment.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Apply the rule of thirds** to a live subject, placing the subject on the grid intersection rather than dead centre, and explain why this is stronger.
2. **Use framing** â€" shooting through a natural frame (a doorway, window, tree branches) to add depth and focus attention on the subject.
3. **Identify and use leading lines** â€" paths, edges, walls, railings that draw the viewer's eye toward the subject.
4. **Recognise and use symmetry and perspective** â€" balanced compositions for formal effect, and converging lines to create depth.
5. **Identify golden hour, window light and open shade** as flattering natural light, and explain why harsh midday sun and backlight are unflattering.
6. **Produce a four-image composition series** (one image per technique) and a **four-image light study** (same subject in four different lighting conditions), each image visibly demonstrating the named technique.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera.
- Instructor's phone connected to a projector or large screen for live demonstration.
- A phone tripod or improvised stand for the instructor demonstration.
- Two identical small objects (two cups, two bottles, two fruits) for the light comparison.
- A window with natural light and a shaded spot (or two contrasting indoor lighting areas) for the light study.

Software

- The phone's built-in camera app (default shooting tool).
- No editing software needed today; editing begins in Session 4.

Accounts

- None required this session.

Sample files

- **Four composition technique cards** (Section F) â€" each card shows a photograph demonstrating one technique with a brief explanation.
- **Good light / bad light comparison** â€" two photos of the same subject in flattering and unflattering light, printed or projected.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 2.1 â€" "Composition Technique Log" (a table: technique name, description, my photo description, why it works).
- Worksheet 2.2 â€" "Light Study Record" (a table: lighting condition, time/place, description of light, result).

Tools

- A whiteboard and markers for drawing composition diagrams.
- A ruler or straight edge for drawing grid lines.

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a capable phone

- Any phone with a working camera works. A learner without a phone may pair with a classmate, use an academy phone or use an academy computer with a webcam. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Safety note: When photographing outdoors or near windows, be aware of surroundings. Do not stand in roads, do not lean out of windows, and do not photograph anyone without their consent.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show the same subject â€" a chair in a room â€" photographed three ways:

- **Photo A (centred, flat):** The chair is dead centre in the frame, shot from standing height, with a cluttered background. It looks like a random snapshot.
- **Photo B (rule of thirds, intentional):** The chair is placed on the right third of the frame, shot from a slightly lower angle, with a clean background. It looks deliberate and pleasing.
- **Photo C (with leading lines):** The chair is framed by a doorway or at the end of a corridor, with lines drawing the eye toward it. It looks like a designed image.

What the instructor says:

> *"Same chair, same room. But Photo B and Photo C look like someone made them â€" they look like they belong in a magazine or a shop advert. Photo A looks like something you would delete. Hands up â€" which photo would you use for a furniture business? â€¦ B and C, almost everyone. Now tell me: what is different about them?"*

Expected learner response: Learners will say things like "the chair is not in the middle," "it looks nicer," "the background is cleaner," "it looks professional," "it has depth." Accept all answers and write the key phrases on the board: **off-centre, clean background, depth, intentional, pleasing.**

Then reveal the lesson: Say clearly:

> *"Composition is not a mystery â€" it is a set of choices. Where do you put the subject in the frame? What do you include around it? What angle do you shoot from? Today you learn four composition techniques that professionals use every day. And then you learn about light â€" the difference between a snapshot and a photograph is often not the camera, it is the light. By the end of this session, you will take photos that look like someone made them on purpose."*

Why this opener works: It uses a subject every learner can recognise, it produces instant visual recognition of quality, and it introduces the four techniques and the light concept before any technical explanation.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five quality words for a good photograph? Which two did we focus on in Session 1?"

- Expected answer: Clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose. Session 1 focused on clarity (sharpness) and light (correct exposure).
- Common gap: Learners may forget the five words. Clarify: "Clarity means sharp. Light means correctly exposed. Today we add composition â€" how the subject is arranged â€" and we go deeper into light."

Question 2: "What is the 5-step sharpness routine? Name the steps."

- Expected answer: Steady hold, tap to focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames.
- Common gap: Learners may remember the steps but not the order. Clarify: "The order matters. Steady first, then focus, then exposure, then background, then frames."

Question 3: "What happens when you tap a bright part of the scene instead of the subject?"

- Expected answer: The camera exposes for the bright area, so the subject goes dark.
- Common gap: Learners may say "the photo gets brighter." Clarify: "The *background* gets correctly exposed, but the *subject* goes dark. The camera exposes for wherever you tap."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"In Session 1 you learned to make photos sharp and correctly exposed. That is the foundation. But a sharp, well-lit photo of a chair in the middle of the frame is still not a great photo. Today you learn to arrange the photo â€" composition â€" and to choose the light. These are the two skills that turn a snapshot into a photograph."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the 5-step routine, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing it on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What composition is and why it matters

The idea. Composition is how you arrange everything inside the frame â€" the subject, the background, the empty space, the lines, the shapes. It is the difference between pointing a camera and *making* a photograph.

Plain-English definition. Composition is deciding what goes in the photo, where everything sits in the frame, and what angle you shoot from. It is the photographer's way of guiding the viewer's eye to what matters.

Why it matters. A well-composed photo is pleasing to look at. It feels intentional â€" like someone made choices. A poorly composed photo feels accidental â€" like the camera just happened to be pointed that way. For business, a well-composed product photo makes the product look more valuable. For a portrait, a well-composed photo makes the person look more confident and appealing.

The key insight (say this slowly):

> *"Composition is not about following rules blindly. It is about understanding a few principles and then making deliberate choices. Today you learn four techniques. After this session, you will see them everywhere â€" in adverts, in magazines, in Instagram posts. And you will start using them yourself."*

Real-life comparison. Composition is like arranging a shop display. You can throw everything on the shelf randomly, or you can place the most important item at eye level, give it space around it, and remove anything distracting. Both are displays, but one makes people stop and look, and the other makes them walk past. Composition is arranging the photo so people stop and look.

Misconception to correct. "Composition rules are rigid â€" you must always follow them exactly." No. The rules are starting points. Once you understand them, you can break them deliberately for creative effect. But you must first learn the rules before you can break them with intention.

F.2 Technique 1 â€" The rule of thirds

The idea. The rule of thirds is the most fundamental composition technique. It says: do not put the subject in the centre of the frame. Instead, place it on one of the grid intersections â€” the points where the horizontal and vertical grid lines cross.

How it works:

1. Turn on grid lines in your camera settings (you did this in Session 1).
2. The grid divides the screen into nine equal rectangles.
3. The four points where the grid lines intersect are the "power points."
4. Place your subject â€” or the most important part of the subject (usually the eyes in a portrait) â€” on or near one of these four points.

Why it works:

- A centred subject feels static and balanced â€” but also boring. The eye has nowhere to travel.
- An off-centred subject creates tension and movement. The eye moves around the frame, exploring.
- The empty space around the subject (called "negative space") gives the subject room to breathe and makes it feel important.

How to use it in practice:

- For a portrait: place the subject's eyes on the top horizontal line, on one of the vertical lines. Leave space in the direction the person is looking.
- For a product: place the product on one of the four intersections, with the label facing the camera.
- For a landscape: place the horizon on the top or bottom horizontal line â€” not in the middle.

Worked example:

- Weak: A photo of a person, dead centre, looking at the camera, with equal space on both sides. The photo feels flat and stiff.
- Strong: The same person, placed on the right vertical line, with their eyes on the top horizontal line, looking toward the left side of the frame (into the empty space). The photo feels dynamic and intentional.

Real-life comparison. The rule of thirds is like seating at a dinner table. If you sit exactly in the middle of the table, you are the centre of attention but the table feels stiff. If you sit slightly to one side, the table feels more natural and conversational, and people can still see you clearly. The rule of thirds is placing your subject slightly off-centre so the photo feels natural.

Common mistake. Placing the subject on the grid intersection but leaving no space in the direction they are looking. If a person is looking left, place them on the right side of the frame so they have space to "look into."

F.3 Technique 2 â€” Framing

The idea. Framing means using elements in the scene to create a frame *within* the frame â€” a natural border around the subject that draws the eye inward.

What can be used as a frame:

- A doorway or window
- Tree branches or leaves
- An archway or gate
- A corridor or tunnel
- Two walls creating a natural frame
- A person's arms or hands (in creative portraits)

How it works:

1. Find a natural frame in the environment â€” a doorway, a window, branches.
2. Position yourself so the frame surrounds your subject.
3. Shoot through the frame, keeping both the frame and the subject in focus (if possible).
4. The frame draws the viewer's eye toward the subject and adds depth to the photo.

Why it works:

- The frame creates a sense of depth â€” the photo feels like you are looking *into* a scene, not just *at* it.
- The frame focuses attention â€” the viewer's eye is guided to the subject, not distracted by the surroundings.

- The frame adds context â€” a doorway tells you the person is inside, branches tell you the person is outdoors.

Worked example:

- Weak: A photo of a person standing in an open field, with nothing around them. The photo is flat â€” there is no sense of place.
- Strong: The same person, photographed through a doorway or an archway. The door frame creates a natural border, the person is framed within it, and the photo feels like a window into a moment.

Real-life comparison. Framing is like hanging a picture on a wall. The wall is the background, the frame is the border around the picture, and the picture is the subject. Without a frame, the picture blends into the wall. With a frame, the picture stands out. In photography, you use the environment to create that frame.

Common mistake. Using a frame that is too busy or distracting â€” the frame competes with the subject for attention. The frame should enhance the subject, not overpower it.

F.4 Technique 3 â€” Leading lines

The idea. Leading lines are lines in the scene â€” paths, roads, walls, railings, fences, rivers, shadows â€” that lead the viewer's eye toward the subject.

What can be leading lines:

- A road or path leading to a building
- A fence or wall leading to a person
- A row of trees leading to a house
- A river or stream leading to a bridge
- Shadows created by light
- Railway lines, power lines, staircases

How it works:

1. Look at the scene and identify any lines â€” straight or curved.
2. Position yourself so the lines lead from the foreground (near the camera) toward the subject (in the distance).
3. The lines act as arrows, guiding the viewer's eye through the photo to the subject.

Why it works:

- Lines create a sense of journey â€” the viewer's eye travels from the foreground to the subject.
- Lines add depth â€” they make the photo feel three-dimensional.
- Lines create interest â€ a photo with leading lines feels more dynamic than a photo without them.

Worked example:

- Weak: A photo of a market stall, shot straight on, with no lines. The photo is flat â€ everything is at the same distance.
- Strong: The same market stall, shot from the end of the aisle, with the aisle lines leading the eye toward the stall. The photo feels like you are walking toward the stall.

Real-life comparison. Leading lines are like the yellow line on a road. The line guides your eyes forward, toward where you are going. In a photograph, leading lines guide the viewer's eyes toward the subject.

Common mistake. Lines that lead the eye *away* from the subject or out of the frame. Always check: do the lines lead toward the subject, or do they lead somewhere else? If they lead away, reposition yourself.

F.5 Technique 4 â€” Symmetry and perspective

The idea. Symmetry means balance â€” both sides of the photo are similar or identical. Perspective means using depth and distance to create a three-dimensional feeling. Together, they create formal, structured compositions.

Symmetry:

- When to use it: architecture, reflections, formal portraits, anything with a clear centre line.
- How to use it: place the subject in the centre of the frame, with both sides of the photo mirroring each other as closely as possible.
- Why it works: symmetry feels stable, formal and pleasing. It works well for buildings, doorways, faces and reflections.

- Example: A building photographed straight on, with both sides equal. Or a reflection in a lake or a puddle â€" the top half and bottom half are mirror images.

Perspective:

- When to use it: any scene with depth â€" corridors, roads, hallways, rows of objects.
- How to use it: place the camera at the start of the depth, with the subject at the far end. The converging lines (the sides of the corridor, the edges of the road) create a strong sense of depth.
- Why it works: perspective makes the photo feel immersive â€" like you could step into it.
- Example: A photo down a long corridor, with the walls converging toward a door at the far end. The viewer feels like they are standing at the start of the corridor.

Worked example:

- Weak: A photo of a corridor, shot from the side, with no sense of depth. The photo is flat.
- Strong: The same corridor, shot from one end, with the walls converging toward the far end. The photo feels deep and immersive.

Real-life comparison. Symmetry is like a face â€" both eyes, both ears, both sides roughly the same. A symmetrical face feels balanced and pleasing. Perspective is like looking down a long road â€" the road narrows in the distance, and you feel the depth. Both are powerful composition tools.

Common mistake. For symmetry, even a small tilt ruins the effect. Use the grid lines to make sure the centre line is truly centred. For perspective, if the camera is too far from the start of the depth, the effect is weak â€" get close to the beginning of the lines.

F.6 What light is and why it matters

The idea. Light is the raw material of photography. Without light, there is no photograph. But not all light is equal. The quality, direction and colour of light can make a subject look beautiful, dramatic, flat, harsh or unflattering.

The three qualities of light (teach these and return to them all session):

Quality	Plain-English meaning	Effect on the subject
Direction	Where the light comes from â€" front, side, top, behind	Front light is flat and safe; side light is dramatic and dimensional; top light (midday sun) is harsh and unflattering; backlight (behind the subject) creates silhouettes
Softness	How spread out the light is â€" soft or hard	Soft light (cloudy day, window light) is flattering and even; hard light (direct sun) creates strong shadows and bright highlights
Colour	The warmth or coolness of the light â€" measured in Kelvin	Warm light (sunrise, sunset, indoor bulbs) feels cozy and golden; cool light (shade, overcast sky) feels clean and blue; neutral light (overcast day, open shade) is balanced and true

Why light matters more than the camera. A â‚¦500,000 camera in bad light produces a bad photo. A â‚¦50,000 phone in good light produces a beautiful photo. The camera records the light; the photographer chooses the light. This is why professional photographers talk about light constantly â€" it is the most important variable.

Real-life comparison. Think of a person's face. In the soft light of a window, their face looks smooth, warm and pleasing. In the harsh midday sun, their face has dark shadows under the eyes and nose, and they are squinting. Same person, same face â€" completely different light, completely different result. Light is the difference.

Misconception to correct. "More light is always better." No. Too much light (direct midday sun) is harsh and unflattering. The best light is often soft and indirect â€" the light of a cloudy day, a window, or open shade. Quality matters more than quantity.

F.7 The four natural light conditions every photographer must know

1. Golden hour (the best light of the day).

- When: The hour after sunrise and the hour before sunset.
- What it looks like: Warm, golden, soft, directional light with long shadows.

- Why it is beautiful: The low angle of the sun creates soft, flattering light with a warm glow. Skin looks smooth, colours look rich, and everything feels magical.
- How to use it: Shoot during golden hour whenever possible. Place the subject facing the sun (front-lit) for a warm glow, or at an angle to the sun (side-lit) for dramatic shadows.
- Nigerian context: In Port Harcourt, golden hour is roughly 6:00â€"7:00 AM and 5:30â€"6:30 PM (varies by season). The light is consistent year-round near the equator.

2. Window light (the easiest indoor light).

- When: Any time during the day, near a window.
- What it looks like: Soft, directional light coming from one side.
- Why it is beautiful: The window acts as a large, soft light source. The light is even and flattering, especially for portraits and products.
- How to use it: Place the subject near the window, facing the window (or at a 45-degree angle to it). Do not place the subject with their back to the window â€" this creates a silhouette.
- Nigerian context: Almost every home and shop in Port Harcourt has a window. This is the most accessible good light.

3. Open shade (the safest outdoor light).

- When: Any time during the day, in a shaded area.
- What it looks like: Soft, even, cool light â€" no direct sun on the subject.
- Why it is beautiful: The shade eliminates harsh shadows and squinting. The light is even and flattering, especially for portraits.
- How to use it: Place the subject in the shade of a tree, a building, or an umbrella â€" but with a bright, open area in front of them (not a dark wall). The subject should be in shade, but the light in front of them should be bright.
- Nigerian context: Open shade is everywhere in Port Harcourt â€" under trees, under awnings, in covered walkways. It is the easiest good light to find.

4. Harsh midday sun (the worst light â€" avoid when possible).

- When: Roughly 11:00 AM to 2:00 PM.
- What it looks like: Hard, overhead light with strong shadows under the eyes, nose and chin. Subjects squint. Colours look washed out.
- Why it is unflattering: The light comes from directly above, creating shadows in the worst places. It is too harsh for portraits and can create washed-out colours.
- How to handle it if you must shoot in it: Move the subject into open shade. If you cannot, use a reflector or white card to bounce light into the shadow areas. Or embrace the harsh light for creative effect (strong shadows can be dramatic).
- Nigerian context: The midday sun in Port Harcourt is extremely strong. Avoid shooting portraits or products in direct midday sun unless you have no choice.

Backlight â€" the most common mistake:

- What it is: Light coming from behind the subject, toward the camera.
- What happens: The subject becomes a silhouette â€" dark, with no detail. The background is bright.
- Why it happens: The camera exposes for the bright background, not the dark subject.
- How to fix it: Move the subject so the light is coming from the front or side, not behind. Or tap the subject on the screen and brighten the exposure. Or use a reflector to bounce light onto the subject's face.
- Golden hour exception: Backlight during golden hour can be beautiful â€" it creates a warm glow around the subject (called "rim light"). This is intentional backlight, not accidental backlight.

Real-life comparison. The four light conditions are like four different shirts:

- Golden hour is a beautiful traditional outfit â€" rich, warm, special.
- Window light is a clean white shirt â€" simple, professional, always works.
- Open shade is a casual polo â€" relaxed, comfortable, safe.
- Harsh midday sun is a fluorescent vest â€" bright, harsh, unflattering, best avoided.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- Composition is how you arrange the subject, background and space within the frame.

- The rule of thirds: place the subject on a grid intersection, not dead centre.
- Framing: use a natural frame (doorway, window, branches) to draw the eye to the subject.
- Leading lines: use lines in the scene to guide the viewer's eye toward the subject.
- Symmetry and perspective: use balance and depth for formal, immersive compositions.
- Light has three qualities: direction, softness and colour.
- The four natural light conditions: golden hour (best), window light (easy), open shade (safe), harsh midday sun (avoid).
- Backlight is the most common mistake â€” fix it by repositioning or adjusting exposure.

Key concept diagram:

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flowchart LR
    A[Rule of Thirds] --> D[Balanced composition]
    B[Leading Lines] --> D
    C[Framing] --> D
    D --> E[Interesting photo]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A phone connected to the projector, camera app open, grid lines on.
- A subject: a bottle, a cup, or a piece of fruit on a table.
- A second subject for the light study: two identical objects (two cups or two bottles).
- A window with natural light.
- A shaded area (indoor corner or under a tree/awning outside).
- A white card or reflector (A4 paper works).

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” rule of thirds (3 minutes)

Say: "Watch the screen. Grid lines are on. I am going to place the bottle on one of the four grid intersections."

Step 1: Move the phone so the bottle is on the right vertical line, on the top horizontal line. "The bottle is on a power point. It is off-centre."

Step 2: Take the photo. Show the result. "See how the bottle has space on the left? It feels intentional, not accidental."

Step 3: Move the bottle to the centre. Take the photo. Show the result. "Now it is centred. Compare â€” which one feels more dynamic?" The class should say the off-centre one.

Say: "The rule of thirds is not magic â€” it is simply about not putting everything in the middle. The eye likes to move around the frame. Off-centre gives it somewhere to go."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” framing (2 minutes)

Say: "Now I will use a doorway to frame the bottle. Watch."

Step 1: Position the camera so the bottle is visible through a doorway. The door frame surrounds the bottle.

Step 2: Tap the bottle to focus. Take the photo. Show the result.

Say: "The doorway is a natural frame. It draws your eye to the bottle. Without the frame, the bottle is just sitting on a table. With the frame, the bottle feels like it is in a scene â€” you are looking *into* something."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€” leading lines (2 minutes)

Say: "Now I will use leading lines. I am going to place the bottle at the end of a row of books, so the edges of the books lead the eye toward it."

Step 1: Arrange a row of books leading toward the bottle. Position the camera at the start of the row.

Step 2: Tap the bottle to focus. Take the photo. Show the result.

Say: "The edges of the books are lines. They lead your eye from the foreground â€" near the camera â€" to the bottle in the distance. Without the lines, the bottle is just there. With the lines, your eye travels to it."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" light study (6 minutes)

Say: "Now the most important part â€" light. I have two identical cups. I am going to photograph the same cup in four different lights and you will see the difference."

Light 1 â€" Window light: Place the cup near a window. Photograph it. Show the result. "Soft, even, flattering. You can see the colour and texture of the cup clearly."

Light 2 â€" Open shade: Place the cup in a shaded area (under a tree, in a covered walkway). Photograph it. Show the result. "Even, cool, safe. No harsh shadows. This is the easiest good outdoor light."

Light 3 â€" Direct sun (if available) or a bright indoor spot with harsh overhead light: Place the cup in direct bright light. Photograph it. Show the result. "Harsh shadows, bright highlights, the cup looks washed out and unflattering. This is the light to avoid."

Light 4 â€" Backlight: Place the cup with a bright window behind it. Photograph it without adjusting. Show the result. "The cup is dark â€" a silhouette. The camera exposed for the bright window." Then tap the cup, brighten the exposure, retake. Show the result. "Now the cup is visible. Same cup, same position â€" the only thing I changed was the exposure."

Say: "Same cup, same camera. The only thing that changed was the light. That is why light matters more than the camera. A photographer's job is to find good light â€" or fix bad light."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Which photo feels more dynamic â€" the centred one or the off-centre one?" (Off-centre â€" rule of thirds.)
- "What does the doorway do for the bottle?" (It frames it â€" draws the eye in.)
- "What do the edges of the books do?" (They lead the eye to the bottle â€" leading lines.)
- "Which light made the cup look best?" (Window light or open shade.)
- "Why was the cup dark when the window was behind it?" (Backlight â€" the camera exposed for the bright window, not the cup.)
- "Can you fix backlight?" (Yes â€" tap the subject and brighten the exposure, or move the subject.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner produces a four-image composition series (one photo per technique) and begins a four-image light study.

Starting materials: Learner's own phone with grid lines on; a subject in the classroom (a bottle, a cup, a bag, a plant, or a classmate who has agreed); the printed Composition Technique Log.

Procedure â€" Part 1: Composition Series (12 minutes)

The instructor calls out each technique. Learners find a subject and apply the technique. Instructor walks the room.

1. **Rule of thirds:** Find a subject. Turn on grid lines. Place the subject on one of the four grid intersections. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
2. **Framing:** Find a natural frame â€" a doorway, a window, a gap between two objects. Shoot through the frame so the subject is framed. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
3. **Leading lines:** Find or create leading lines â€" the edge of a table, a row of books, a corridor. Position yourself so the lines lead to the subject. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
4. **Symmetry or perspective:** Find a symmetrical scene (a door, a face, a reflection) or a perspective scene (a corridor, a row of objects). Compose for symmetry or depth. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.

For each photo, the learner writes one line in the Composition Technique Log: "Technique: _____. What I did: _____."

Procedure â€" Part 2: Light Study (6 minutes)

5. Choose one subject (a bottle, a cup, or a classmate's hand â€" something that can stay still).
6. Photograph it in two different lighting situations available in or near the classroom:

    - Near a window (soft light).
    - In a shaded area or a dim corner (different light).
7. For each photo, write one line in the Light Study Record: "Light: _____. What I see: _____."

Expected result: Four composition photos (one per technique) and two light study photos, each with a written description.

Points to pause and predict:

- After the rule of thirds photo: "Is your subject on a grid intersection, or is it still in the middle? Check the grid."
- After the framing photo: "Does the frame surround your subject, or is it just something in the background? If it does not surround, it is not a frame."
- After the light study: "Compare your two light photos. Which one looks better? Why?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner cannot find a natural frame â†' Suggest a doorway, a window, or even the gap between two chairs.
- Subject is centred despite trying â†' Have them look at the grid lines on the screen, not just the subject. Move the camera, not the subject.
- Leading lines are not leading anywhere â†' Ask: "Where do the lines go? Do they go to the subject or somewhere else? Reposition."
- Light study photos look the same â†' The learner may have photographed in the same light twice. Have them move to a genuinely different lighting situation.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Rule of thirds photo â€" subject on a grid intersection
- ☐ Framing photo â€" subject framed by a natural frame
- ☐ Leading lines photo â€" lines lead to the subject
- ☐ Symmetry or perspective photo â€" balanced or deep
- ☐ Light study photo 1 â€" near a window
- ☐ Light study photo 2 â€" in shade or a different light
- ☐ Composition Technique Log completed for all four techniques
- ☐ Light Study Record completed for both photos

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Complete the light study â€" photograph the same subject in four different lighting conditions and diagnose the light.

Setup: Choose one subject â€" a bottle, a cup, a fruit, or a classmate's hand (with permission). The subject must stay in the same position; only the light changes.

You will photograph it in four places (find these in or near the classroom):

1. **Near a window** (soft, directional light).
2. **In open shade** (soft, even light â€" under a tree, in a covered area, or in a shaded corner).
3. **In direct bright light** (harsh light â€" in a sunny spot or under a bright overhead light).
4. **With a bright background behind it** (backlight â€" place the subject in front of a window or bright opening).

Requirements:

1. For each lighting condition, take at least one photo using the 5-step sharpness routine (from Session 1).
2. After each photo, label it in the Light Study Record: is the light **soft or hard**, **warm or cool**, **flattering or unflattering**?
3. Write one sentence explaining what you see in each photo.

Constraints:

- Use only the built-in camera app â€" no filters, no editing.
- The subject must be the same in all four photos (same position, same angle if possible).
- Do not leave the building â€" find the four lighting situations inside or immediately outside.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Four photos taken in four different lighting conditions.
- Each photo is labelled with a light diagnosis (soft/hard, warm/cool, flattering/unflattering).
- At least one photo is clearly flattering (the window or shade photo).
- The backlight photo shows a visible difference from the others.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: "Soft light" means no harsh shadows â€” the light is spread out. "Hard light" means strong, defined shadows.
- Hint 2: If you cannot find open shade, a shaded corner of a room works â€” anywhere the subject is not in direct light.
- Hint 3: For backlight, place the subject between the camera and a bright window. The subject will look dark â€” that is the point.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€” do not show learners):

Photo 1 â€” near a window: Soft, directional, flattering light. The subject is clearly visible with gentle shadows. Diagnosis: **soft, neutral-warm, flattering.** Reason: "The window acts as a large, soft light source."

Photo 2 â€” open shade: Soft, even, cool light. The subject is evenly lit with no harsh shadows. Diagnosis: **soft, cool, flattering.** Reason: "The shade eliminates direct sun, creating even light."

Photo 3 â€” direct bright light: Hard, harsh, unflattering light. Strong shadows, bright highlights, the subject may look washed out. Diagnosis: **hard, warm, unflattering.** Reason: "Direct light creates harsh shadows and bright spots."

Photo 4 â€” backlight: The subject is dark (silhouette) against a bright background. Diagnosis: **hard, unflattering (as shot).** Reason: "The camera exposed for the bright background, not the subject. Fix: tap the subject and brighten."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Four photos taken in four different lighting conditions (4)
- Each photo correctly diagnosed (soft/hard, warm/cool, flattering/unflattering) (4)
- At least one photo clearly flattering (1)
- Written reasons are accurate (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Adaeze* is a tailor in Port Harcourt. She makes beautiful ankara dresses and sells them through WhatsApp and Instagram. She takes photos of her dresses on a mannequin in her shop, usually in the afternoon, and posts them. Her photos have the dresses looking flat, washed out, and unflattering â€” the colours look dull, and the fabric texture is hard to see. Customers often say the dresses look better in person than in the photos.

Relevant facts.

- Adaeze's phone is a recent model with a good camera.
- She photographs the mannequin in the middle of her shop, under fluorescent ceiling lights.
- She does not think about composition â€” she just points and shoots.
- Her shop has a large window with beautiful natural light, but she never uses it.
- The background of her photos is cluttered â€” fabric rolls, scissors, other dresses, her sewing machine.

Decision point. What is the main reason Adaeze's photos are not showing her dresses at their best?

Possible approaches.

1. Buy a better phone with a bigger camera sensor.
2. Learn to use natural light (her window), improve her composition, and clean up her background.
3. Hire a professional fashion photographer for every new dress.

Recommended solution. Approach 2. Adaeze's phone is already capable of good photographs. Her problem is threefold: poor light (fluorescent ceiling lights instead of natural window light), poor composition (centred, cluttered, no intention), and no attention to the background. By moving the mannequin near her window, using the rule of thirds, and cleaning up the background, she can produce photos that show her dresses beautifully â€” for free.

Specific fixes for Adaeze:

- Move the mannequin near the window (soft, natural light).
- Place the mannequin on a grid intersection, not dead centre (rule of thirds).
- Remove everything from the background except a plain wall or a clean surface (clean background).
- Photograph in the morning or late afternoon when the light is softest (avoid harsh midday sun).
- Take several frames and pick the sharpest.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 costs money (â‚¦150,000â€“â‚¦400,000) and does not solve the problem â€” a better phone used in bad light with poor composition still produces bad photos.
- Approach 2 is free, takes a few hours to learn, and the skill stays with Adaeze forever. She can photograph every new dress herself.
- Approach 3 works but costs money every time. Adaeze makes many dresses; hiring a photographer for each one is not sustainable for a small business.

Professional connection. Across Nigeria, small businesses lose sales because their product photos do not show the products at their best. A tailor, a food vendor, a hair stylist, a jeweller â€” all need good photographs. The difference between a photo that sells and a photo that does not is often not the product or the camera â€” it is the light and the composition.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Centring every subject

Symptoms: Every photo has the subject dead centre in the frame, with equal space on both sides. **Likely cause:** The photographer is pointing at the subject without thinking about placement. **How to investigate:** Look at the grid lines on the screen. Is the subject on the vertical centre line? **Corrective steps:** Move the subject to one of the four grid intersections. Leave more space on the side the subject is facing or looking toward. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is on a grid intersection, not the centre line. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make "off-centre" a habit. Before every photo, ask: "Is my subject in the middle? If so, where should it go?"

K.2 Cluttered backgrounds

Symptoms: The subject is lost in a busy background â€” objects, people, patterns competing for attention. **Likely cause:** The photographer is focusing on the subject and ignoring everything else in the frame. **How to investigate:** Look at the photo â€” can you identify the subject immediately, or does your eye wander? **Corrective steps:** Move the camera to change the background. Or move the subject. Or use a wider aperture (on phones, use portrait mode if available) to blur the background. Or simply clean up the background before shooting. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is the clear focus of the photo; the background is clean and uncluttered. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before every photo, scan the entire frame â€” not just the subject. Ask: "What else is in this photo? Does it help or distract?"

K.3 Harsh midday sun for portraits

Symptoms: The subject is squinting, with dark shadows under the eyes, nose and chin. Colours look washed out. **Likely cause:** Photographing in direct midday sun (roughly 11 AMâ€“2 PM). **How to investigate:** Check the time of day and the direction of the shadows. If shadows are directly under the subject, the sun is overhead. **Corrective steps:** Move the subject into open shade (under a tree, in a covered area). Or wait for a better time (morning or late afternoon). Or use a reflector to bounce light into the shadows. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is not squinting, shadows are soft or absent, colours are natural. **How to prevent recurrence:** Plan outdoor shoots for morning or late afternoon. If you must shoot at midday, find shade.

K.4 Backlight â€” subject is a silhouette

Symptoms: The subject is very dark, almost a silhouette, against a bright background. **Likely cause:** The light is coming from behind the subject, toward the camera. The camera exposes for the bright background. **How to investigate:** Is there a bright area (window, sky, light source) behind the subject? **Corrective steps:** Move the subject so the light comes from the front or side. Or tap the subject on the screen and brighten the exposure. Or use a reflector to bounce light onto the subject. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is clearly visible with detail, not a dark silhouette. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before every photo, check where the light is coming from. If it is behind the subject, reposition.

K.5 Lines that lead nowhere

Symptoms: Leading lines in the photo lead the eye to the edge of the frame or to a distracting object, not the subject. **Likely cause:** The photographer saw lines but did not check where they lead. **How to investigate:** Trace the lines with your finger. Where do they go? To the subject or somewhere else? **Corrective steps:** Reposition yourself so the lines lead to the subject. If they cannot lead to the subject, find different lines or a different angle. **How to confirm resolved:** The lines lead the viewer's eye directly to the subject. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before taking the photo, trace the lines and confirm they lead where you want the eye to go.

K.6 Using a frame that distracts

Symptoms: The natural frame (doorway, branches) is so busy or colourful that it competes with the subject. **Likely cause:** The photographer saw a frame and used it without considering how it looks. **How to investigate:** Look at the photo â€" is the frame more interesting than the subject? **Corrective steps:** Find a simpler frame. Or change the angle so the frame is less prominent. Or use a wider aperture (portrait mode) to blur the frame slightly. **How to confirm resolved:** The frame enhances the subject, not competes with it. **How to prevent recurrence:** Choose frames that are simple and complementary to the subject.

K.7 Symmetry that is not symmetrical

Symptoms: A supposedly symmetrical photo where one side is slightly different from the other â€" a door frame is tilted, one side has an object the other does not. **Likely cause:** The camera is not perfectly aligned with the centre line of the subject. **How to investigate:** Look at the grid lines. Is the centre of the subject exactly on the vertical centre line? **Corrective steps:** Adjust the camera position until the subject is perfectly centred. Use the grid lines as a guide. Take the photo from directly in front of the subject, not at an angle. **How to confirm resolved:** Both sides of the photo are as identical as possible. **How to prevent recurrence:** For symmetry, take time to align carefully. Small tilts ruin the effect.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" look at the actual photo, trace the lines, check the light direction, and confirm the cause before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Composition and Light Series â€" My Eight"

Purpose: To practise the four composition techniques and produce a light study that shows clear understanding of how light affects a subject. This assignment forms the raw material for the Week 1 mini-project (the foundations folder) and the capstone portfolio.

Realistic scenario. You are building your photography skill. Your client â€" a friend with a small business, your own business, or a fictional client â€" needs a set of photos that look intentional and professional. Before you can deliver that, you need to prove to yourself that you can compose deliberately and use light well.

Detailed instructions:

1. Find **one subject** that can stay still for several photos: a bottle, a cup, a bag, a plant, or a classmate who has agreed.
2. **Composition series (4 photos):** Photograph the subject using each of the four techniques:
    - Rule of thirds (subject on a grid intersection)
    - Framing (subject framed by a natural frame)
    - Leading lines (lines lead to the subject)
    - Symmetry or perspective (balanced or deep)
3. **Light study (4 photos):** Photograph the same subject in four different lighting conditions:
    - Near a window (soft light)
    - In open shade (soft, even light)
    - In direct bright light (harsh light)
    - With a bright background behind it (backlight)
4. For each of the eight photos, write one sentence in your workbook: "*Technique/Light:* _____. *What I did:* _____."
5. Organise all eight photos in your `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname` folder in a subfolder named `Week1-Composition-Light`.

Required deliverables:

- A folder with eight photos (four composition, four light study).
- Eight written sentences (one per photo) explaining the technique or light used.

Submission format: Share the folder with the instructor (via WhatsApp, Google Drive or a USB stick) or bring your phone to Session 3 and show the folder.

Deadline: Before Session 3.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Rule of thirds	1	Subject clearly on a grid intersection, not centred
Framing	1	Subject clearly framed by a natural frame
Leading lines	1	Lines clearly lead to the subject
Symmetry or perspective	1	Balanced or deep composition, clearly intentional
Light study â€" variety	2	Four genuinely different lighting conditions
Light study â€" quality	2	At least two photos clearly flattering (window or shade)
Written explanations	2	Accurate descriptions of technique/light for all eight photos

Common mistakes to avoid: centring every subject; cluttered backgrounds; photographing in harsh midday sun for portraits; backlight silhouettes; lines that lead nowhere; labelling a photo as "rule of thirds" when the subject is actually centred.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner submission contains:

- **Rule of thirds:** A subject placed on a grid intersection, with space in the direction the subject is facing.
- **Framing:** A subject photographed through a doorway, window or natural arch, with the frame clearly surrounding the subject.
- **Leading lines:** A subject at the end of a line or row (books, table edge, corridor), with the lines clearly leading the eye inward.
- **Symmetry or perspective:** A symmetrical scene (a door, a face) or a perspective scene (a corridor, a row of objects) with clear depth.
- **Light study:** Four photos showing genuinely different light â€" soft window light, even shade, harsh direct light, and backlight (with the backlight photo showing the subject as a silhouette or corrected with exposure).

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is composition, and why does it matter?

Q2. Multiple choice. You are photographing a person who is looking toward the left side of the frame. According to the rule of thirds, where should you place the person in the frame? a) Dead centre, looking left b) On the right vertical line, looking left into the empty space c) On the left vertical line, looking left out of the frame d) On the bottom horizontal line, looking left

Q3. Explain in your own words. What is framing in photography? Give one example of a natural frame.

Q4. Practical identification. A photo has a bright window behind the subject, and the subject is very dark â€" almost a silhouette. What is this problem called, and what are two ways to fix it?

Q5. Matching. Match each light condition to its description: **golden hour, window light, open shade, harsh midday sun.** a) Soft, directional light from a window â€" best for indoor portraits and products b) The hour after sunrise or before sunset â€" warm, golden, flattering light c) Direct overhead sun â€" harsh shadows, squinting, washed-out colours d) Soft, even light in a shaded area â€" safe and flattering for outdoor portraits

Q6. Scenario. You are photographing a product for a WhatsApp Business catalogue. The product is on a cluttered table, under a fluorescent light, in the middle of the afternoon. What are three things you could do to make the photo look better?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6)

A1. Composition is how you arrange the subject, background and space within the frame. It matters because a well-composed photo looks intentional and pleasing â€” it guides the viewer's eye to the subject. A poorly composed photo looks accidental and unprofessional.

A2. (b) On the right vertical line, looking left into the empty space. The person should have space in the direction they are looking.

A3. Framing is using elements in the scene to create a natural border around the subject â€” a doorway, window, tree branches, an archway. It draws the eye to the subject and adds depth. Example: photographing a person through a doorway.

A4. This is called backlight (or silhouette). Two fixes: (1) Move the subject so the light comes from the front or side, not behind. (2) Tap the subject on the screen and brighten the exposure.

A5. golden hour = (b); window light = (a); open shade = (d); harsh midday sun = (c).

A6. Three things: (1) Move the product to a window or shaded area with better light. (2) Clean up the background â€” remove clutter and use a plain surface. (3) Use the rule of thirds â€” place the product on a grid intersection, not dead centre. (Also acceptable: tap to focus on the product, take several frames, use the 5-step sharpness routine.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that composition is how you arrange the photo â€” where the subject sits, what is around it, and what angle you shoot from. You learned four techniques: the rule of thirds (off-centre is stronger than centred), framing (use a natural frame to draw the eye in), leading lines (use lines to guide the viewer to the subject), and symmetry and perspective (balance and depth). Then you learned about light â€” the raw material of photography. You learned the four natural light conditions: golden hour (best), window light (easiest), open shade (safest) and harsh midday sun (avoid). You learned that backlight is the most common mistake and how to fix it. You took a four-image composition series and a four-image light study.

Five important takeaways:

1. Composition is a set of choices â€” the rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry and perspective.
2. Off-centre is stronger than centred â€” place the subject on a grid intersection.
3. Light matters more than the camera â€” a phone in good light beats an expensive camera in bad light.
4. Golden hour, window light and open shade are your friends; harsh midday sun is not.
5. Backlight turns your subject into a silhouette â€” fix it by repositioning or adjusting exposure.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I place a subject on a grid intersection without thinking about it?
- Can I find a natural frame in any environment?
- Can I identify where the light is coming from â€” front, side, top or behind?
- Can I explain the difference between soft light and hard light?
- Can I choose a flattering time and place to shoot a portrait?
- Can I take a four-photo light study and explain why each photo looks the way it does?

Connection to the next session. You now know how to make a photo sharp, correctly exposed, well-composed and beautifully lit. Next session you apply all of that to the three subjects that earn money: people, products and events. You will learn to direct a simple portrait pose, build a clean product scene, and work an event to capture key moments sharply. Consent is confirmed for every person photographed. This is where your foundations folder comes together.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner places the subject off-centre without being reminded.
- Learner scans the background before taking a photo and removes distractions.

- Learner identifies the direction and quality of light before shooting.
- Learner moves the subject or themselves to find better light.
- Learner produces photos where the technique is visible â€" you can look at the photo and name the technique used.
- Learner diagnoses their own photos accurately.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Composition rules are too restrictive â€" I want to be creative." â†' Learn the rules first, then break them deliberately.
- "I can fix the light in editing." â†' Editing can improve exposure slightly; it cannot fix harsh shadows or a silhouette.
- "More light is better." â†' Soft, indirect light is often better than bright, direct light.
- "The background does not matter." â†' A cluttered background ruins an otherwise good photo.
- "Backlight is always bad." â†' Intentional backlight (e.g., golden hour rim light) can be beautiful. The problem is *accidental* backlight that creates a silhouette.
- "I need to shoot at midday because that is when I am free." â†' Choose the light, then fit your schedule around it.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Grid drill:** Take 10 photos of any subject, each with the subject on a different grid intersection. Review â€" all should be off-centre.
2. **Frame hunt:** Walk around the building and find five natural frames (doorways, windows, gaps between objects). Photograph a subject through each one.
3. **Light comparison:** Photograph the same subject in four different lights. Label each photo with the light condition and why it looks the way it does.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a printed sheet with the four techniques illustrated with simple diagrams. Pair the learner with a confident learner for the practical.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical and assignment.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to combine two techniques in one photo (e.g., rule of thirds + leading lines, or framing + symmetry) and explain why the combination works. They should also research and present one additional composition technique not covered in the session (e.g., negative space, filling the frame, or the golden ratio).

Timing guidance. The priority is learners taking photos with good composition and good light (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the lecture's composition techniques to the key demonstrations (rule of thirds and framing) and protect the practical time. A learner who leaves without taking a four-photo composition series and a light study has no material for the Week 1 mini-project.

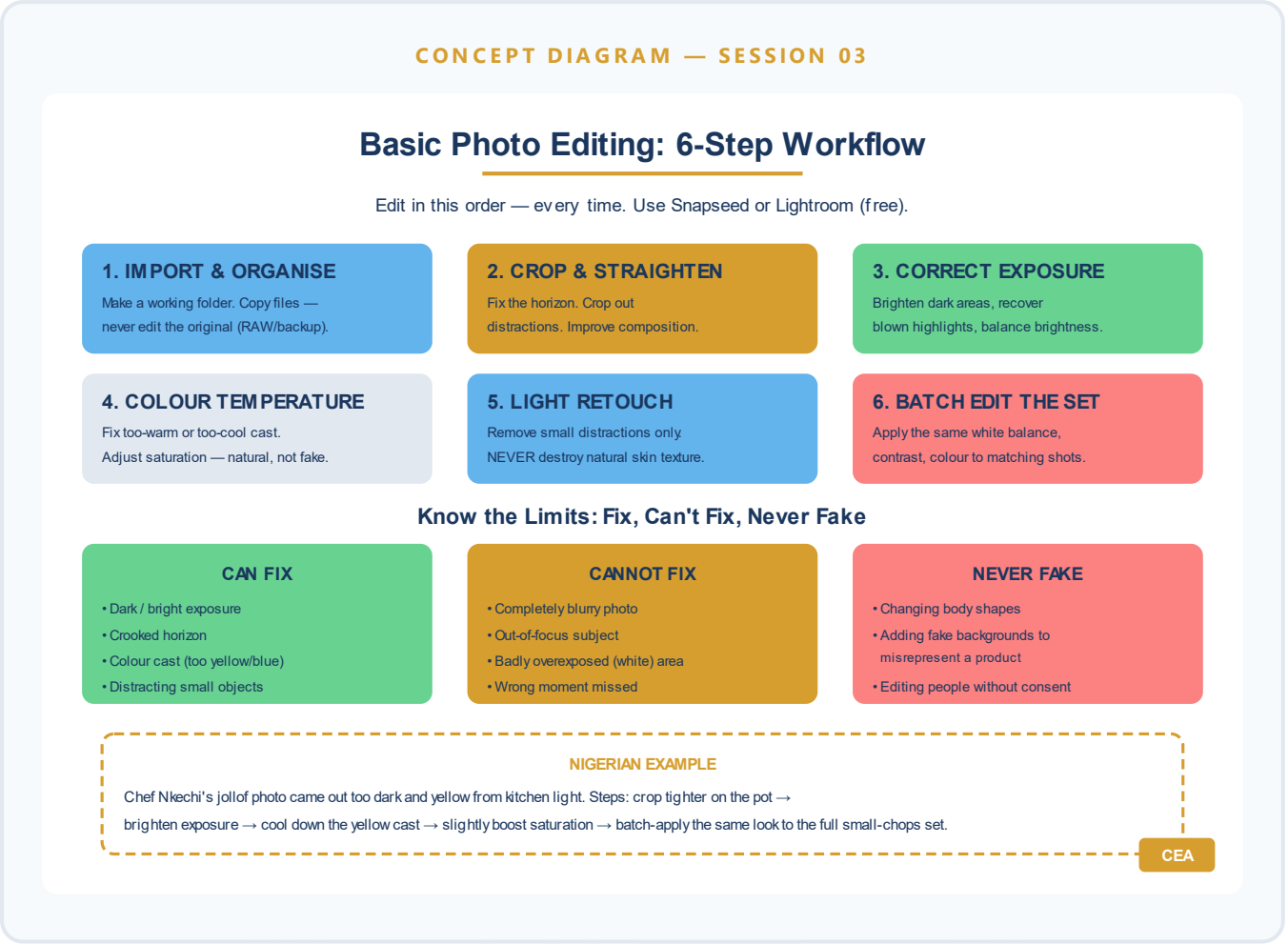
END OF SESSION 2

Next: Session 3 â€" Shooting People, Products and Events.

SESSION 03 OF 6

Shooting People Products and Events

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 03



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 3 â€" SHOOTING PEOPLE, PRODUCTS AND EVENTS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	3 of 6
Session title	Shooting People, Products and Events
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (practical, subject-focused)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"2 â€" the learner should be able to produce a sharp, correctly exposed photo, apply the rule of thirds, and identify good and bad light. The 5-step sharpness routine and the

Item	Detail
	four composition techniques are assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Sessions 1 and 2 you learned the technical and artistic foundations. Today you apply them to the three subjects that earn money: people (portraits), products (business images) and events (moments). This session closes Week 1's foundations folder.
Preparation before class	A willing colleague or mannequin for the portrait demonstration; a simple product (a shoe, a bag, a plate of food, a phone accessory) for the product demonstration; a plain surface (a table, a bedsheet, a piece of cardboard) and a white card or reflector for the product scene; printed consent forms for any person photographed; the "Foundations Folder Checklist" (Section H) printed per learner; a simulated event setup (a person pouring a drink, cutting a cake, or handing over an item) for the event demonstration.

Instructor note on tone: This session is about confidence with subjects. Many learners are nervous about photographing people â€" they fear being intrusive or getting it wrong. Create a supportive atmosphere. Emphasise consent, kindness and clear communication. Celebrate every good portrait, even imperfect ones.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Put a subject at ease** before photographing them, using simple communication and direction.
2. **Direct a simple portrait pose** â€" position the subject's body, hands and face for a natural, flattering result.
3. **Produce a sharp, well-lit portrait** using natural light, the rule of thirds and the 5-step sharpness routine.
4. **Build a clean product scene** â€" choose a surface, manage the background, control reflections and light the product flatteringly.
5. **Produce a usable product image** suitable for a WhatsApp Business catalogue or Jiji listing.
6. **Work a simulated event** â€" capture key moments sharply, adapt to changing light and stay unobtrusive.
7. **Confirm consent** for every person photographed, using a printed consent form.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera.
- Instructor's phone connected to a projector or large screen.
- A phone tripod or improvised stand.
- A white card, reflector or A4 paper for bouncing light.
- A plain surface for the product scene: a table, a white bedsheet, a piece of cardboard or a clean floor.

Software

- The phone's built-in camera app (default shooting tool).
- No editing software needed today; editing begins in Session 4.

Accounts

- None required this session.

Sample files

- **Three portrait examples** (printed or projected): one poorly posed (stiff, awkward, bad light), one acceptably posed, one well-posed and well-lit.
- **Three product examples** (printed or projected): one cluttered, poorly lit product shot; one acceptable; one clean, professional product shot.
- **Consent form** (printed per learner) â€" a simple one-page form with the subject's name, signature, date and a statement that they agree to be photographed.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 3.1 â€" "Portrait Checklist" (a table: light, pose, focus, background, expression â€" each with a tick box).
- Worksheet 3.2 â€" "Product Scene Planner" (a table: surface, background, light direction, angle, props).
- Worksheet 3.3 â€" "Event Moment Log" (a table: moment, light condition, sharpness, result).

Tools

- A whiteboard and markers.
- A ruler for drawing the product scene diagram.

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a capable phone

- Any phone with a working camera works. A learner without a phone may pair with a classmate, use an academy phone or use an academy computer with a webcam. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Consent and safety note: Before photographing any person in this class â€" including classmates â€" ask for their permission first and have them sign the consent form. If someone says no, put the camera down. No exceptions. For the simulated event, use classmates who have agreed to participate.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show three portraits of the same person:

- **Portrait A (poor):** The person is standing against a bright window (backlit â€" face is dark), arms stiff at their sides, looking uncomfortable, the background is cluttered, the photo is slightly blurry.
- **Portrait B (acceptable):** The person is in open shade, looking at the camera, arms relaxed, but the pose is stiff and the expression is awkward â€" like a passport photo.
- **Portrait C (strong):** The person is near a window (soft light on their face), body turned slightly, hands doing something natural (holding a cup, resting on a table), a genuine smile, clean background, sharp focus on the eyes.

What the instructor says:

> *"Same person. Three photos. One looks like a mistake, one looks like an ID card, and one looks like a professional portrait. Hands up â€" which one would you use for a business profile? â€¦ Photo C, almost everyone. Now tell me: what is different about Photo C?"*

Expected learner response: Learners will say things like "the light is better," "she is smiling," "she looks comfortable," "the background is clean," "you can see her face," "she looks natural." Accept all answers and write the key phrases on the board: **light, pose, expression, background, comfort.**

Then reveal the lesson: Say clearly:

> *"A good portrait is not about the person being beautiful â€" it is about the photographer making them look their best. The light, the pose, the background, the moment â€" all of those are the photographer's choices. Today you learn to make those choices for people, products and events. By the end of this session, you will have a portrait, a product shot and an event shot in your foundations folder."*

Why this opener works: It uses the same person in all three photos, proving that the photographer â€" not the subject â€" makes the difference. It introduces the three subjects (people, products, events) before any technical explanation.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the four composition techniques we learned in Session 2?"

- Expected answer: Rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry/perspective.
- Common gap: Learners may remember rule of thirds but forget the others. Clarify: "Off-centre placement, using a natural frame, using lines to lead the eye, and using symmetry or depth."

Question 2: "What are the four natural light conditions, and which ones are flattering for portraits?"

- Expected answer: Golden hour (flattering), window light (flattering), open shade (flattering), harsh midday sun (unflattering â€" avoid).
- Common gap: Learners may say "more light is better." Clarify: "Soft, indirect light is flattering. Direct, harsh light creates shadows and squinting. The best light is often the gentlest light."

Question 3: "What is the 5-step sharpness routine?"

- Expected answer: Steady hold, tap to focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames.
- Common gap: Learners may remember the steps but not the order. Clarify: "Steady, focus, exposure, background, frames â€" in that order."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have the tools: sharpness, composition and light. Today we point those tools at the three things that pay: people, products and events. These are the subjects clients pay for. A business owner pays for product photos. A family pays for portraits. A church or school pays for event coverage. Today you prove you can deliver all three."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the four composition techniques, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Photographing people â€" the portrait

The idea. A portrait is a photograph of a person that shows who they are â€" their character, their mood, their professionalism. A good portrait makes the subject look their best: comfortable, confident and well-lit. A good portrait is not about the subject being naturally photogenic â€" it is about the photographer creating the conditions for a good photo.

The three things that make a good portrait (teach these and return to them all session):

Element	What it means	How to get it right
Light	The light on the subject's face	Use soft, directional light â€" window light or open shade. Never harsh midday sun. Never backlight (unless intentional).
Pose	How the subject's body is positioned	Give the subject something to do with their hands. Turn the body slightly. Ask them to relax. Avoid stiff, straight-on poses.
Expression	The subject's face and emotion	Talk to the subject. Make them laugh. Capture a genuine moment, not a forced smile. Take many frames â€" the best expression is often between poses.

Putting the subject at ease (the most important portrait skill):

Many learners are nervous about photographing people. This is normal. The solution is communication:

1. **Introduce yourself.** Tell the person your name and what you are doing. "Hello, I'm Chinedu, I'm learning photography and I'd like to take your portrait. Is that okay?"
2. **Explain what you need.** "I'm going to ask you to stand near this window and just be yourself. I'll take a few photos and we'll check them together."
3. **Give direction, not orders.** Instead of "stand there and smile," say "why don't you lean against the wall and look out the window for a moment?" Direction gives the subject something to do; orders make them stiff.
4. **Talk while you shoot.** Do not shoot in silence. Ask about their day, their work, their family. The best expressions happen when the subject is relaxed and engaged.

5. **Show them the result.** After taking a few photos, show the subject the screen. "Look â€" that one is beautiful. See how the light catches your face?" This builds trust and makes them more comfortable.

Simple posing basics (for beginners):

Do not overcomplicate posing. These four steps work for almost everyone:

1. **Turn the body slightly.** Ask the subject to turn their body about 30â€"45 degrees away from the camera. This is more flattering than standing straight on â€" it creates a natural line and avoids the "passport photo" look.
2. **Give the hands something to do.** Stiff arms at the sides look awkward. Ask the subject to hold something (a cup, a phone, a book), rest their hands on a surface, or cross their arms loosely. Hands that are doing something look natural.
3. **Angle the face.** Ask the subject to turn their face slightly toward the light. If the light is coming from the left, they should turn their face left. This ensures the face is well-lit.
4. **Capture the moment between poses.** The best expression is often not the posed smile â€" it is the laugh, the thoughtful look, the natural moment between directions. Take many frames and capture these.

Light for portraits â€" the two best options:

- **Window light:** Place the subject near a window, facing the window or at a 45-degree angle to it. The window provides soft, directional light that is flattering on the face. Never place the subject with their back to the window (backlight â€" the face goes dark).
- **Open shade:** Place the subject in the shade of a tree or building, with a bright, open area in front of them. The shade eliminates harsh shadows and squinting. The subject should be in shade, but the light in front of them should be bright.

Background for portraits:

- Clean and uncluttered. A plain wall, a blurred background, or a simple outdoor setting.
- Nothing growing out of the subject's head â€" no poles, no branches, no distracting objects.
- Use the rule of thirds â€" place the subject's eyes on the top horizontal line, on one of the vertical lines.

Worked example:

- Weak: A person standing straight on, arms at their sides, in harsh midday sun, against a cluttered background, with a forced smile. The photo looks like a mugshot.
- Strong: The same person, turned slightly, holding a cup, near a window with soft light on their face, against a clean wall, with a genuine laugh. The photo looks like a professional portrait.

Real-life comparison. A good portrait is like a good conversation. If you stand stiffly and say nothing, the conversation is awkward. If you relax, gesture naturally, and engage with the other person, the conversation flows. A portrait works the same way â€" the photographer's job is to make the subject relax and then capture the natural moment.

Misconception to correct. "The subject needs to be naturally photogenic." No. A good photographer can make almost anyone look good by controlling the light, the pose and the moment. Photogenic means "photographed well" â€" and that is the photographer's work, not the subject's gift.

F.2 Photographing products â€" the business image

The idea. A product photograph is a photograph of an item for sale â€" for a WhatsApp Business catalogue, a Jiji listing, an Instagram post or a flyer. A good product photo shows the product clearly, makes it looks appealing, and gives the buyer confidence to purchase. A poor product photo â€" dark, blurry, cluttered â€" makes the buyer walk away.

The four elements of a good product photo (teach these and return to them all session):

Element	What it means	How to get it right
Surface	What the product sits on	A clean, plain surface â€" a white bedsheet, a wooden table, a piece of cardboard. No clutter.
Background	What is behind the product	A plain, uncluttered background â€" a wall, a sheet hung up, a blurred background. Nothing distracting.
Light	How the product is lit	Soft, even light â€" window light or open shade. No harsh shadows. Reflector (white card) to fill shadows.

Element	What it means	How to get it right
Angle	Where the camera is positioned	Eye level or slightly above. Show the product's best side. For food, shoot from above (flat lay) or at 45 degrees.

Building a product scene â€” step by step:

1. **Choose the surface.** Find a clean, plain surface â€” a table, a bed, a piece of cardboard. Cover it with a white sheet, a plain cloth or a piece of paper if needed. The surface should be clean and uncluttered.
2. **Set the background.** Behind the product, place a plain background â€— a wall, a sheet hung up, or a large piece of paper. The background should be plain and complementary to the product. For a dark product, use a light background. For a light product, use a dark background.
3. **Position the product.** Place the product on the surface. Make sure it is clean â€— wipe off dust, fingerprints, smudges. Arrange it at its best angle â€— the side that shows the product's shape, label or detail.
4. **Set the light.** Place the product near a window (soft light) or in open shade. If one side of the product is in shadow, use a white card or reflector on the shadow side to bounce light back. This "fills" the shadows and makes the product look evenly lit.
5. **Compose the photo.** Use the rule of thirds â€— place the product on a grid intersection. Use the 5-step sharpness routine. Take several frames. Check the result by zooming in.

Managing reflections:

- Shiny products (glass, metal, polished surfaces) create reflections â€— the camera, the photographer, the room.
- To reduce reflections: shoot from a slight angle, not straight on. Use soft light (window light, not direct sun). Place a white card on the opposite side of the product to fill in the shadow and balance the reflection.
- To eliminate reflections on glass: place a black card or cloth behind the product (not visible to the camera) to create a clean, dark background behind the glass.

Worked example â€— photographing a shoe:

- Weak: A shoe on a cluttered floor, in a dim corner, with other shoes and objects around it. The shoe is dark, the background is messy, the photo is blurry. The buyer cannot see the shoe clearly.
- Strong: The same shoe, on a white sheet near a window, with a white card bouncing light onto the shadow side. The shoe is sharp, well-lit, and the background is clean. The buyer can see every detail â€— the colour, the texture, the sole. This photo makes the buyer want to purchase.

Real-life comparison. A product photo is like a shop window display. A good shop window is clean, well-lit, and shows the product at its best â€— with nothing distracting from it. A poor shop window is cluttered, dim, and shows the product buried among other items. Your job as a product photographer is to create a clean, well-lit "shop window" for every product.

Misconception to correct. "I need a photo studio and professional lighting to take good product photos." No. A window, a white sheet and a cardboard reflector are enough to produce professional-quality product photos. The principles matter more than the equipment.

F.3 Photographing events â€— the moment

The idea. An event is a gathering where things happen â€— a birthday party, a church service, a naming ceremony, a wedding, a shop opening, a graduation. Event photography means capturing the key moments of the event â€— the smiles, the actions, the emotions â€— sharply and well-lit, while staying unobtrusive.

The three challenges of event photography (teach these and return to them all session):

Challenge	What it means	How to handle it
Changing light	The light changes â€— indoors to outdoors, bright to dim, one side of the room to the other	Check the light constantly. Adjust exposure as you move. Use HDR for high-contrast scenes. Be ready to shoot in any light.
Moving subjects	People move â€— walking, talking, dancing, hugging	Use the 5-step sharpness routine. Take many frames. Capture the moment, not just the pose. Be ready â€— anticipate what will happen next.

Challenge	What it means	How to handle it
Staying unobtrusive	You are part of the event but should not dominate it	Do not block people's view. Do not use flash (unless necessary and permitted). Move quietly. Be respectful. Photograph people with their knowledge and consent.

The five key moments to capture at any event:

1. **The preparation** â€" before the event starts: setting up, decorating, arranging food, people arriving. These photos tell the story of the event.
2. **The greeting** â€" people arriving, shaking hands, hugging, greeting each other. These photos capture the welcome and the community.
3. **The main action** â€" the key moment: cutting the cake, handing over a gift, the first dance, the speech, the performance. This is the moment everyone remembers.
4. **The emotion** â€" the reactions: laughter, tears, surprise, joy. These photos capture the feeling of the event.
5. **The detail** â€" the small things: the decorations, the food, the flowers, the dress, the invitations. These photos complete the story.

How to work an event like a professional:

1. **Arrive early.** Get there before the event starts. Scout the location â€" find the best light, the best angles, the spots where the key moments will happen.
2. **Plan your shots.** Think about the five key moments. Where will the cake be cut? Where will the speeches happen? Where will people gather? Position yourself near those spots.
3. **Stay ready.** Keep your camera on. Keep your finger near the shutter. Anticipate what will happen next. The best moments are often unexpected â€" a child running, a spontaneous laugh, a sudden embrace.
4. **Take many frames.** Events are unpredictable. Take many photos of every moment. One frame will be sharp, one will capture the right expression, one will be perfect.
5. **Be respectful.** Do not block the view. Do not use flash if it will disturb people. Do not photograph anyone who has asked not to be photographed. Consent is just as important at events as in the studio.

Light at events:

- Indoor events often have mixed light â€" overhead lights, windows, sometimes coloured lights. Check the white balance (the colour of the light) and adjust if needed.
- Outdoor events may have changing light â€" sun moving behind clouds, shade moving. Check the exposure constantly.
- If the light is very dim, use a higher ISO (on phones, this is automatic) or use a tripod or steady surface to avoid blur. Do not use flash unless it is necessary and permitted â€" flash can be harsh and distracting.

Worked example â€" a birthday party:

- Weak: Photos of people standing awkwardly, with the cake not visible, in harsh flash light, with the subject's eyes closed. The photos look like an afterthought.
- Strong: Photos of the decorations being set up, guests arriving and greeting each other, the cake being cut (with the knife visible and the candles lit), the birthday person's reaction (joy, surprise), the food on the table, and a group photo of everyone smiling. These photos tell the complete story of the event.

Real-life comparison. Event photography is like being a storyteller. A good storyteller does not just tell you what happened â€" they show you the moments, the emotions, the details. Your photos are the story of the event. The client is not just buying photos â€" they are buying the memory.

Misconception to correct. "Event photography means taking hundreds of photos and hoping some are good." No. A good event photographer plans, anticipates and captures the key moments deliberately. Taking many frames is part of it â€" but the frames are taken with intention, not randomly.

F.4 Consent and respect â€" the photographer's responsibility

The idea. Photography is a profession built on trust. Before you photograph a person â€" in a portrait, at an event, in a public place â€" you must ask for their permission. This is not just politeness â€" it is a professional and ethical obligation.

The consent rule (read this aloud and make sure every learner understands):

- **Ask first.** Before you photograph any person, ask: "May I take your photo?" If they say yes, proceed. If they say no, put the camera down â€" no argument, no exceptions.
- **Under 18 â€" parent or guardian consent.** For anyone under 18, you must have written consent from a parent or guardian before you photograph them. Without it, do not shoot.
- **Show respect.** If someone is uncomfortable, stop. If someone asks you to delete a photo, delete it. If someone does not want to be photographed at an event, do not photograph them.
- **Use a consent form.** For any person photographed for practice, portfolio or client use, have them sign a simple consent form. This protects both you and the subject.

The consent form (simple version):

```
CONSENT TO BE PHOTOGRAPHED

I, _____ (name), agree to be photographed by
_____ (photographer's name) on _____ (date).

I understand that the photographs may be used for:
[ ] Practice and learning
[ ] Portfolio
[ ] Client/business use
[ ] Social media

I give my permission freely and can ask for the photos to be deleted at any time.

Signature: _____
Date: _____

For subjects under 18:
Parent/Guardian name: _____
Parent/Guardian signature: _____
Date: _____
```

Why consent matters:

- It is respectful. People have the right to control how their image is used.
- It is professional. A photographer who asks consent is trusted. A photographer who does not is avoided.
- It is legal. In Nigeria, using someone's image without permission â€" especially for commercial purposes â€" can create legal problems.
- It builds your reputation. Clients hire photographers they trust. Trust starts with consent.

Misconception to correct. "If I am in a public place, I can photograph anyone." Not exactly. You can photograph public scenes and buildings, but photographing identifiable people â€" especially for commercial use â€" requires consent. When in doubt, ask.

F.5 Summary of the lecture

- A good portrait has three elements: light, pose and expression. Put the subject at ease, use soft light, give direction, and capture the moment.
- A good product photo has four elements: surface, background, light and angle. Build a clean scene, use soft light, and compose deliberately.
- Event photography has three challenges: changing light, moving subjects and staying unobtrusive. Capture the five key moments: preparation, greeting, main action, emotion and detail.
- Consent is mandatory: ask first, get parent/guardian consent for under-18s, use a consent form, and respect people's wishes.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Clean lens] --> D[Sharp photo]
    B[Steady hands] --> D
```

```
C[Good light] --> D
D --> E[Usable shot]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A willing colleague or mannequin for the portrait.
- A simple product (a shoe, a bag, a plate of food) and a plain surface (white sheet, table).
- A white card or reflector.
- A consent form (signed by the colleague before the demo).
- A simulated event setup: a person pouring a drink or cutting a cake.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" the portrait (5 minutes)

Say: "I am going to photograph Adaeze. Watch how I set up the light, direct the pose and capture the moment."

Step 1 â€" Light: Position Adaeze near a window. "Soft light from the window, falling on her face. She is not facing the window directly â€" she is at a 45-degree angle. This gives depth to her face."

Step 2 â€" Background: Check the background. "Clean wall behind her. Nothing distracting."

Step 3 â€" Pose: "Adaeze, turn your body slightly to the left. Rest your hand on the table. Now turn your face toward the light â€" yes, like that. Perfect."

Step 4 â€" Direction: "Now look out the window for a moment â€" just naturally. â€¦ Now look back at me. â€¦ Tell me about your work â€" what do you do? â€¦ [Adaeze talks and laughs]"

Step 5 â€" Capture: Take several photos while Adaeze talks. Show the best one on the projector. "See â€" she is relaxed, the light is soft on her face, her hands are doing something natural, and she is laughing. That is a portrait."

Say: "The difference between a snapshot and a portrait is not the camera â€" it is the time you take to make the person comfortable. Talk to them, give them something to do, and capture the moment when they forget about the camera."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" the product scene (5 minutes)

Say: "Now I am going to photograph this shoe for a WhatsApp Business catalogue. Watch how I build the scene."

Step 1 â€" Surface: Lay a white sheet on the table. "Clean, plain surface. No clutter."

Step 2 â€" Background: Hang a white sheet behind the table. "Plain background. Nothing distracting."

Step 3 â€" Product: Place the shoe on the sheet. Wipe it clean. "The shoe is clean â€" no dust, no smudges. I am placing it at a 45-degree angle so you can see the shape and the label."

Step 4 â€" Light: Position the shoe near a window. "Soft light from the window. One side is in shadow â€" I am going to fill it with a white card." Place a white card on the shadow side. "The card bounces light back onto the shadow side. Now the shoe is evenly lit."

Step 5 â€" Compose: Use the rule of thirds. "The shoe is on a grid intersection. I am using the 5-step sharpness routine â€" steady, focus, exposure, background, frames."

Step 6 â€" Capture: Take several photos. Show the best one. "Sharp, well-lit, clean background. This photo makes the buyer want to purchase."

Say: "A product photo is not just a photo of a product â€" it is a sales tool. The cleaner the scene, the more professional the product looks, and the more confident the buyer feels."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" the event moment (4 minutes)

Say: "Now a simulated event. Adaeze is going to pour a drink. Watch how I capture the moment."

Step 1 â€" Anticipate: "I know she is going to pour. I am positioning myself where I can see the action clearly â€" not too close, not too far."

Step 2 â€" Light: "The light is coming from the side. I am checking the exposure â€" it looks good."

Step 3 â€" Capture: Adaeze pours the drink. Take several photos in quick succession. "I took five frames. One will be perfect â€" the liquid mid-pour, the expression on her face, the glass filling up."

Step 4 â€" Review: Show the best frame. "Sharp, well-lit, the action is clear. That is the moment."

Say: "Event photography is about anticipation. You cannot control the moment â€" but you can be ready for it. Position yourself, check the light, and take many frames."

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What is the difference between a snapshot and a portrait?" (Time, communication, light, pose.)
- "Why did I use a white card on the shadow side of the shoe?" (To fill the shadows â€" to bounce light back.)
- "Why did I take five frames of the pour?" (One will be perfect â€" the others may be blurry or the expression may be wrong.)
- "What is the most important thing about photographing people?" (Consent and respect.)
- "Can you take good product photos without a studio?" (Yes â€" a window, a sheet and a card are enough.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner produces a portrait, a product shot and an event shot, completing the foundations folder.

Starting materials: Learner's own phone; a classmate who has agreed to be photographed (with signed consent form); a simple product (a shoe, a bag, a bottle, a book); a plain surface and background; a white card or reflector; the printed worksheets.

Procedure â€" Part 1: Portrait (6 minutes)

1. Ask a classmate to be your subject. Explain what you are doing. Have them sign the consent form.
2. Position your subject near a window or in open shade. Check the light on their face.
3. Direct the pose: turn the body slightly, give the hands something to do, angle the face toward the light.
4. Talk to your subject. Make them comfortable. Take at least five photos.
5. Review the photos. Pick the strongest one. Tick the Portrait Checklist.

Procedure â€" Part 2: Product (6 minutes)

1. Choose a product â€" your bag, a bottle, a book, a shoe.
2. Build the scene: clean surface, plain background, product positioned at its best angle.
3. Set the light: near a window or in open shade. Use a white card to fill shadows.
4. Compose using the rule of thirds. Use the 5-step sharpness routine. Take at least five photos.
5. Review the photos. Pick the strongest one. Fill in the Product Scene Planner.

Procedure â€" Part 3: Event (6 minutes)

1. Work in pairs. One person is the "event" â€" they will perform a simple action (pouring a drink, opening a book, handing over an item). The other is the photographer.
2. The photographer positions themselves, checks the light, and anticipates the action.
3. The "event" person performs the action. The photographer takes at least five photos in quick succession.
4. Review the photos. Pick the strongest one. Fill in the Event Moment Log.
5. Swap roles and repeat.

Expected result: One portrait, one product shot and one event shot, each with a completed worksheet.

Points to pause and predict:

- After the portrait: "Is your subject comfortable? If not, what could you do to make them more relaxed?"
- After the product: "Is the background clean? Is the product well-lit? Would a buyer want to purchase from this photo?"
- After the event: "Did you capture the action clearly? Is the photo sharp? Did you take enough frames?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's subject looks stiff â†' Suggest giving the hands something to do, or asking the subject to talk about something they enjoy.
- Product photo has harsh shadows â†' Have them use the white card to fill the shadow side.

- Event photo is blurry â†' Check if the subject moved too fast. Suggest taking more frames, or asking the subject to move more slowly.
- Learner has not obtained consent â†' Stop the exercise. Remind them of the consent rule. No consent, no photo.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Portrait taken â€" subject comfortable, well-lit, sharp
- ☐ Consent form signed for the portrait subject
- ☐ Product shot taken â€" clean scene, well-lit, sharp
- ☐ Event shot taken â€" action captured sharply
- ☐ Portrait Checklist completed
- ☐ Product Scene Planner completed
- ☐ Event Moment Log completed
- ☐ All three photos saved in the foundations folder

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Complete the foundations folder â€" a 12-image set covering composition, light and subjects.

Setup: You have already taken photos in Sessions 1, 2 and 3. Now you organise and complete your foundations folder â€" the 12-image set that forms the raw material of your capstone portfolio.

Requirements:

1. Review all the photos you have taken so far in the course.
2. Select and organise **12 images** into three groups:
   - **4 composition images** â€" one for each technique (rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry/perspective).
   - **4 light study images** â€" the same subject in four different lighting conditions.
   - **4 subject images** â€" one portrait, one product, one event, and one additional image of your choice.
3. For each image, write one sentence in your workbook: "*This image shows _____ because _____.*"
4. Ensure every image of a person has a signed consent form.
5. Organise all 12 images in your `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname` folder in a subfolder named `Foundations-Folder`.

Constraints:

- Use only photos you have taken yourself during this course.
- Do not use filters or editing â€" these are raw images.
- Every image must be sharp and correctly exposed.
- Every image of a person must have consent.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- 12 images organised into three groups of four.
- Each image has a written description.
- All images are sharp and correctly exposed.
- All consent forms are completed.
- The folder is properly named and organised.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: If you are missing images for a specific category, take them now â€" you have 15 minutes.
- Hint 2: Review your existing photos before taking new ones. You may already have usable images.
- Hint 3: The "additional image of your choice" can be anything â€" a landscape, a detail shot, a creative composition. Choose something you are proud of.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

A strong foundations folder contains:

- **Composition:** Four images, each clearly demonstrating one technique. The rule of thirds image has the subject on a grid intersection. The framing image has a natural frame. The leading lines image has lines leading to the subject. The symmetry/perspective image is balanced or deep.
- **Light study:** Four images of the same subject in four different lights â€" window light, open shade, direct light and backlight. The differences between the images are visible.
- **Subjects:** A portrait (comfortable subject, soft light, clean background), a product shot (clean scene, well-lit), an event shot (action captured sharply) and one additional image.
- Written descriptions: Accurate and specific. "This image shows the rule of thirds because the subject is placed on the right vertical grid line, with space on the left."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- 12 images present and organised (3)
- Each group has four images (2)
- Images are sharp and correctly exposed (2)
- Written descriptions are accurate (2)
- Consent forms completed for all people photographed (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Mama Nkechi* runs a small food business in Port Harcourt â€" *Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices*. She sells homemade soups, spices and pepper soup base through WhatsApp and Instagram. She wants to post photos of her products to attract more customers, but she has never taken a product photo before. She asks her nephew, *Chinedu*, who has a smartphone, to take some photos.

Relevant facts.

- Chinedu has a recent smartphone with a good camera.
- He has never studied photography â€" he just points and shoots.
- Mama Nkechi's products are in plastic containers and glass jars, with handwritten labels.
- The photos are taken in her kitchen, under fluorescent lights, with a cluttered background (pots, pans, ingredients).
- The photos are dark, the labels are hard to read, and the products look unappealing.

Decision point. What should Chinedu do differently to produce photos that will help Mama Nkechi's business?

Possible approaches.

1. Take the photos in the same way but use a brighter flash.
2. Learn to build a clean product scene â€" use natural light, a clean surface, a plain background, and compose deliberately.
3. Ask a professional photographer to take the photos for Mama Nkechi.

Recommended solution. Approach 2. Chinedu's phone is already capable of good product photos. His problem is the scene â€" cluttered background, poor light, no composition. By moving the products near a window, using a clean surface and background, and composing with the rule of thirds, he can produce photos that make Mama Nkechi's products look professional and appealing.

Specific fixes for Chinedu:

- Move the products near a window (soft, natural light).
- Use a clean, plain surface â€" a white sheet or a clean table.
- Use a plain background â€" a wall or a sheet hung up.
- Wipe the containers clean â€" remove smudges and fingerprints.
- Position the products at their best angle â€" labels facing the camera.
- Use the rule of thirds â€" place the product on a grid intersection.
- Take several frames and pick the sharpest.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (brighter flash) makes the photo brighter but does not fix the cluttered background or the unflattering light. Flash creates harsh shadows and makes the products look worse.

- Approach 2 is free, takes a few hours to learn, and the skill stays with Chinedu forever. He can photograph every new product himself.
- Approach 3 works but costs money every time. Mama Nkechi has many products; hiring a photographer for each one is not sustainable.

Professional connection. Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices is the running example for the capstone portfolio (Track A â€" Product). The skills Chinedu learns today â€" building a clean product scene, using natural light, composing deliberately â€" are exactly the skills he will use for the capstone. This is not just a class exercise; this is real preparation for a real photo job.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Stiff, awkward portraits

Symptoms: The subject looks uncomfortable â€" arms stiff, forced smile, staring at the camera. **Likely cause:** The photographer did not communicate with the subject or give direction. **How to investigate:** Ask the photographer: "Did you talk to your subject? Did you give them something to do?" **Corrective steps:** Talk to the subject. Give direction â€" "turn slightly, rest your hand on the table, look out the window." Take photos while the subject is relaxed and engaged. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject looks natural and comfortable in the photo. **How to prevent recurrence:** Always talk to your subject. Never shoot in silence.

K.2 Harsh light on the subject's face

Symptoms: Dark shadows under the eyes, nose and chin. The subject is squinting. **Likely cause:** Photographing in direct midday sun or under a harsh overhead light. **How to investigate:** Check the direction of the shadows. If they are directly under the subject, the light is overhead. **Corrective steps:** Move the subject into open shade or near a window. Use a reflector to fill shadows if needed. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject's face is evenly lit, no squinting. **How to prevent recurrence:** Always check the light before shooting. Avoid harsh overhead light.

K.3 Cluttered product backgrounds

Symptoms: The product is lost among other objects â€" pots, pans, tools, clutter. **Likely cause:** The photographer did not clean up the scene before shooting. **How to investigate:** Look at the photo â€" can you identify the product immediately? **Corrective steps:** Remove everything from the scene except the product and the surface. Use a plain background. **How to confirm resolved:** The product is the clear focus of the photo. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before every product shot, scan the entire frame and remove distractions.

K.4 Blurry event photos

Symptoms: The action is blurred â€" the subject is smeared or the whole photo is soft. **Likely cause:** The subject moved during the exposure, or the camera was not steady. **How to investigate:** Is the background sharp but the subject blurry? If so, the subject moved. Is everything blurry? If so, the camera moved. **Corrective steps:** For moving subjects, take many frames and pick the sharpest. For camera shake, hold the phone steadier or use a surface. **How to confirm resolved:** The action is captured sharply. **How to prevent recurrence:** At events, always take many frames. Hold the phone steady.

K.5 Not obtaining consent

Symptoms: The photographer takes photos of people without asking. **Likely cause:** The photographer does not understand the consent rule or feels awkward asking. **How to investigate:** Ask the photographer: "Did you ask permission before taking that photo?" **Corrective steps:** Stop the exercise. Remind the learner of the consent rule. No consent, no photo. Have them ask the subject and sign the consent form. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject has given permission and signed the form. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make consent the first step of every portrait or event shoot. Never skip it.

K.6 Product photos that do not show the product clearly

Symptoms: The product is too dark, the label is unreadable, or the angle hides the product's best features. **Likely cause:** Poor light, poor angle, or a dirty product. **How to investigate:** Look at the photo â€" can you see the product clearly? Can you read the label? **Corrective steps:** Move the product to better light. Clean the product. Change the angle to show the product's best

side. **How to confirm resolved:** The product is clearly visible, well-lit, and the label is readable. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before every product shot, check the light, clean the product, and choose the best angle.

K.7 Missing the key moment at events

Symptoms: The photographer captures the setup and the aftermath but misses the main action â€" the cake cutting, the handshake, the speech. **Likely cause:** The photographer was not paying attention or was not positioned correctly. **How to investigate:** Ask the photographer: "Where were you standing? Were you ready when the moment happened?" **Corrective steps:** Position yourself near where the key moment will happen. Anticipate what will come next. Keep your finger near the shutter. **How to confirm resolved:** The key moment is captured sharply. **How to prevent recurrence:** At events, always be ready. Anticipate, position, and take many frames.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" look at the actual photo, ask the photographer what they did, and confirm the cause before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Foundations Folder â€" 12 Images"

Purpose: To organise and complete the 12-image foundations folder that forms the raw material of the capstone portfolio. This folder demonstrates your ability to apply sharpness, composition, light and subject skills.

Realistic scenario. You are building your photography portfolio. Your capstone â€" a themed photo shoot for a Port Harcourt client â€" will draw on the skills and images you have developed in Sessions 1â€"3. The foundations folder is your proof that you can deliver.

Detailed instructions:

1. Review all photos taken during Sessions 1, 2 and 3.
2. Select and organise **12 images** into three groups:
   - **4 composition images** â€" one for each technique (rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry/perspective).
   - **4 light study images** â€" the same subject in four different lighting conditions.
   - **4 subject images** â€" one portrait, one product, one event, and one additional image of your choice.
3. For each image, write one sentence: *"This image shows _____ because _____."*
4. Ensure every image of a person has a signed consent form.
5. Organise all 12 images in your `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname` folder in a subfolder named `Foundations-Folder`.
6. Write a short reflection (3â€"5 sentences): *"The strongest image in my folder is _____ because _____. The image I am least happy with is _____ because _____. Next time I would _____."*

Required deliverables:

- A folder with 12 images organised into three groups.
- 12 written descriptions (one per image).
- Signed consent forms for all people photographed.
- A short written reflection.

Submission format: Share the folder with the instructor (via WhatsApp, Google Drive or a USB stick) or bring your phone to Session 4 and show the folder.

Deadline: Before Session 4.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
12 images present and organised	2	All 12 images in the correct groups
Composition images demonstrate techniques	2	Each image clearly shows the named technique
Light study shows variety	2	Four genuinely different lighting conditions
Subject images are strong	2	Portrait, product and event shots are sharp, well-lit and intentional

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Written descriptions and reflection	2	Accurate descriptions and thoughtful reflection

Common mistakes to avoid: missing images; images that do not demonstrate the named technique; blurry or poorly exposed images; missing consent forms; no reflection.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong foundations folder contains:

- **Composition:** Four images, each clearly demonstrating one technique. The rule of thirds image has the subject on a grid intersection. The framing image has a natural frame. The leading lines image has lines leading to the subject. The symmetry/perspective image is balanced or deep.
- **Light study:** Four images of the same subject in four different lights â€" window light, open shade, direct light and backlight. The differences between the images are visible.
- **Subjects:** A portrait (comfortable subject, soft light, clean background), a product shot (clean scene, well-lit), an event shot (action captured sharply) and one additional image.
- Written descriptions: Accurate and specific.
- Reflection: Thoughtful and honest â€" identifies strengths and areas for improvement.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the three things that make a good portrait? Explain one of them.

Q2. Multiple choice. You are photographing a product for a WhatsApp Business catalogue. The product is on a cluttered table under a fluorescent light. What is the single most important thing you should do first? a) Use a beauty filter to make the product look better. b) Move the product to a window or shaded area with better light. c) Take the photo from a higher angle. d) Use the flash to brighten the product.

Q3. Explain in your own words. What are the four elements of a good product photo?

Q4. Practical identification. A portrait photo shows the subject with dark shadows under the eyes and nose, and the subject is squinting. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?

Q5. Matching. Match each event moment to its description: **preparation, greeting, main action, emotion, detail.** a) The cake being cut, the speech, the first dance b) The decorations, the food, the flowers, the invitations c) People arriving, shaking hands, hugging d) Setting up, decorating, arranging food, people arriving e) Laughter, tears, surprise, joy

Q6. Scenario. You are photographing a classmate's portrait. They look stiff and uncomfortable. What are three things you could do to make them more comfortable and get a better photo?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. The three things that make a good portrait are: light (soft, flattering light on the face), pose (natural body position, hands doing something) and expression (genuine emotion, not a forced smile). Explanation of any one: e.g., light means using soft, directional light â€" window light or open shade â€" so the face is evenly lit without harsh shadows.

A2. (b) Move the product to a window or shaded area with better light. Good light is the foundation of a good product photo.

A3. The four elements of a good product photo are: surface (clean, plain surface), background (plain, uncluttered background), light (soft, even light â€" window light or open shade) and angle (eye level or slightly above, showing the product's best side).

A4. The problem is harsh overhead light â€" the light is coming from directly above, creating shadows under the eyes and nose, and causing squinting. Fix: move the subject into open shade or near a window with soft, directional light.

A5. preparation = (d); greeting = (c); main action = (a); emotion = (e); detail = (b).

A6. Three things: (1) Talk to the subject â€" ask about their day, their work, their interests. (2) Give direction, not orders â€" "turn slightly, rest your hand on the table, look out the window." (3) Give the hands something to do â€" hold a cup, rest on a surface, cross arms loosely. (Also acceptable: show them the photos as you go, make them laugh, take photos while they are engaged in conversation.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned to photograph the three subjects that earn money: people, products and events. For portraits, you learned that a good portrait has three elements â€" light, pose and expression â€" and that the most important skill is making the subject comfortable. For products, you learned that a good product photo has four elements â€" surface, background, light and angle â€" and that building a clean scene is the key. For events, you learned that the three challenges are changing light, moving subjects and staying unobtrusive, and that the five key moments are preparation, greeting, main action, emotion and detail. You also learned that consent is mandatory â€" ask first, get parent/guardian consent for under-18s, and use a consent form. You completed your foundations folder â€" 12 images that form the raw material of your capstone portfolio.

Five important takeaways:

1. A good portrait = light + pose + expression. Make the subject comfortable.
2. A good product photo = surface + background + light + angle. Build a clean scene.
3. Event photography = changing light + moving subjects + staying unobtrusive. Capture the five key moments.
4. Consent is mandatory â€" ask first, always.
5. The foundations folder (12 images) is the raw material of your capstone portfolio.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I make a subject feel comfortable and capture a natural expression?
- Can I build a clean product scene with good light?
- Can I capture a key moment at an event sharply?
- Can I explain the consent rule and use a consent form?
- Can I organise my work into a foundations folder?
- Can I look at my own photos and identify what is strong and what needs improvement?

Connection to the next session. You now have the raw material â€" sharp, well-led, well-composed photos of people, products and events. But raw photos are not finished photos. Next session we move to Week 2 â€" Module 2: "Process and Deliver." You will learn to edit your photos in Snapseed or Lightroom Mobile â€" cropping, straightening, correcting exposure, adjusting colour, removing blemishes, and batch-editing a set for consistency. You will learn what editing can fix, what it cannot fix, and what must never be faked. This is where your photos go from good to professional.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner puts the subject at ease through conversation and direction.
- Learner builds a clean product scene without being told to remove clutter.
- Learner captures the key moment at an event by anticipating and taking many frames.
- Learner asks for consent before photographing any person.
- Learner organises their work into a foundations folder with accurate descriptions.
- Learner can explain why a photo works or does not work.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A good portrait depends on the subject being photogenic." â†' No â€" the photographer creates the conditions.
- "I need a studio for good product photos." â†' No â€" a window, a sheet and a card are enough.
- "Event photography is just taking lots of photos." â†' No â€" it is planning, anticipating and capturing key moments deliberately.
- "Consent is optional if I am in a public place." â†' No â€" consent is mandatory for identifiable people, especially for commercial use.
- "Flash fixes bad light." â†' No â€" flash creates harsh shadows and makes photos look worse. Find good light instead.
- "One photo is enough." â†' No â€" always take many frames. One will be perfect.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Portrait practice:** Photograph the same person three times â€" once without talking, once with direction, once while they are engaged in conversation. Compare the results.
2. **Product scene building:** Photograph the same product in three different scenes â€" cluttered, acceptable, clean. Compare the results.
3. **Event anticipation:** At a class event, predict what will happen next and be ready to capture it. Take five frames of the predicted moment.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a printed step-by-step guide for each subject (portrait, product, event). Pair the learner with a confident learner for the practical.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical and assignment.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to photograph a subject in a way that tells a story â€" a portrait that shows the person's personality, a product shot that shows the product in use, or an event sequence (3â€"5 images) that tells the story of a moment from beginning to end. They should also write a short artist's statement explaining their choices.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners photographing all three subjects (Section H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the lecture's event photography section to the key points â€" the three challenges and the five moments â€" and protect the practical time. A learner who leaves without a portrait, a product shot and an event shot has no foundations folder and no material for the capstone.

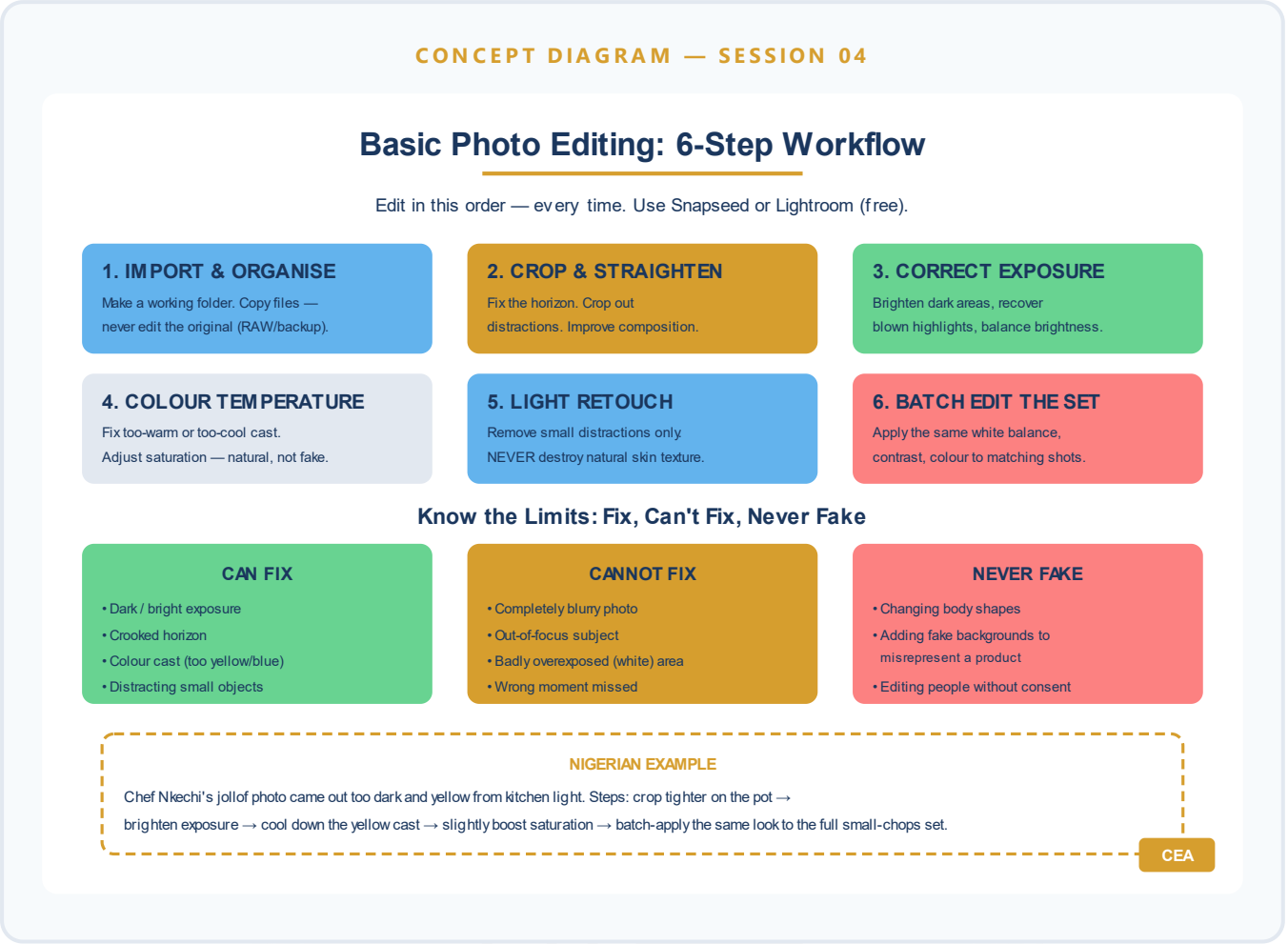
END OF SESSION 3

Next: Session 4 â€" Basic Photo Editing.

SESSION 04 OF 6

Basic Photo Editing

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 04



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 4 â€" BASIC PHOTO EDITING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	4 of 6
Session title	Basic Photo Editing
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: "Process and Deliver"
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (practical, software-focused)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"3 â€" the learner should have a set of raw photos (the foundations folder) and basic smartphone ability. No prior editing experience assumed.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	In Sessions 1â€“3 you learned to shoot sharp, well-lit, well-composed photos. Now you learn to edit them â€” to crop, straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, remove blemishes and batch-edit a set for consistency. Editing is where good photos become professional.
Preparation before class	Academy computers with internet access (for downloading apps if needed); the instructor's phone or computer connected to the projector for live editing demonstration; Snapseed installed on the instructor's device (primary editor); Lightroom Mobile installed as a secondary option; a sample set of raw photos (product, portrait, event) for the demonstration; the "Edit Decision Log" (Section H) printed per learner; a deliberately over-edited sample image for the "honest editing" discussion.

Instructor note on tone: This session must balance skill with ethics. Learners are excited about editing â€” they want to make their photos look amazing. Channel that excitement into honest, disciplined editing. The message is: "Do less, but do it well." Editing should enhance the photo, not transform it into something it is not.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Import and organise** photos into a working folder for editing.
2. **Crop and straighten** a photo to improve composition and remove distractions.
3. **Correct exposure** â€” brighten dark photos, recover highlights, and balance the overall brightness.
4. **Adjust colour temperature and saturation** â€” make colours natural and appealing, not artificial.
5. **Perform basic retouching and blemish removal** â€” clean up small distractions without destroying natural skin texture.
6. **Batch-edit a set** of photos so they have a consistent look â€” matching white balance, contrast and colour.
7. **State clearly** what editing can fix, what it cannot fix, and what must never be faked.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera and the foundations folder of raw photos.
- Academy computers (optional) for learners who prefer editing on a larger screen.
- Instructor's phone or computer connected to a projector for live editing demonstration.

Software

- **Snapseed** (free, primary editor) â€” available on Android and iOS. Download from Google Play Store or Apple App Store.
- **Lightroom Mobile** (free tier, secondary editor) â€” available on Android and iOS. Used for the batch editing demonstration.
- No paid software required. No subscription required.

Accounts

- None required for Snapseed. A free Adobe account is needed for Lightroom Mobile (optional).

Sample files

- **A sample set of raw photos** (product, portrait, event) for the instructor demonstration â€” taken by the instructor or sourced from free/royalty-free images.
- **A deliberately over-edited sample image** â€” a photo with extreme saturation, heavy smoothing, replaced sky, or obvious fakery â€” for the "honest editing" discussion.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 4.1 â€” "Edit Decision Log" (a table: photo name, problem, edit applied, result).
- Worksheet 4.2 â€” "Before and After Comparison" (a table: photo, what I changed, why, honest editing check).

Tools

- A whiteboard and markers for drawing the editing workflow diagram.

Internet

- Required for downloading Snapseed and Lightroom Mobile (if not already installed). Not required for the editing itself â€” both apps work offline once installed.

Alternative for learners who lack a capable phone

- Any smartphone can run Snapseed and Lightroom Mobile. A learner without a phone may use an academy computer with a web-based editor (e.g., Photopea â€” free, browser-based) or pair with a classmate. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Ethics note: Editing must be honest. Do not change a product's true appearance, fake a background, reshape a body beyond normal correction, or edit in a way that lies to a client or viewer. Editing cleans up a photograph; it does not manufacture a false one.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two versions of the same photo:

- **Photo A (raw):** A portrait of a person, slightly crooked, a bit dark, with a small distraction in the background (a trash can, a stray object). The photo is good but not great.
- **Photo B (edited):** The same portrait, straightened, brightened, the distraction removed, the colours natural and warm. The photo looks professional.

What the instructor says:

> *"Same photo. Same person. Same moment. But one looks like it was taken by a beginner, and one looks like it was taken by a professional. The difference is not the camera â€” it is the editing. Hands up â€” which photo would you use for a business profile? â€¦ The edited one, almost everyone. Now tell me: what is different about the edited photo?"*

Expected learner response: Learners will say things like "it is brighter," "it is straight," "the background is cleaner," "the colours look better," "it looks professional." Accept all answers and write the key phrases on the board: **straight, bright, clean, natural, professional.**

Then reveal the lesson: Say clearly:

> *"Editing is not cheating. Editing is part of photography. A raw photo is like a rough draft â€” it has potential, but it needs work. Today you learn to edit your photos in Snapseed â€” a free app you can download today. You will learn to crop, straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, remove distractions and batch-edit a set. But you will also learn the most important rule: edit honestly. Do less, but do it well."*

Why this opener works: It uses the same photo in both versions, proving that editing â€” not the camera â€” makes the difference. It introduces the key editing skills before any technical explanation, and it sets the ethical tone from the start.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five quality words for a good photograph?"

- Expected answer: Clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
- Common gap: Learners may forget one or two. Clarify: "Clarity = sharp. Light = correctly exposed. Composition = intentional arrangement. Moment = right instant. Purpose = does the job."

Question 2: "What is the 5-step sharpness routine?"

- Expected answer: Steady hold, tap to focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames.

- Common gap: Learners may remember the steps but not the order. Clarify: "Steady, focus, exposure, background, frames."

Question 3: "What are the four natural light conditions, and which ones are flattering?"

- Expected answer: Golden hour (flattering), window light (flattering), open shade (flattering), harsh midday sun (unflattering).
- Common gap: Learners may say "more light is better." Clarify: "Soft, indirect light is flattering. Direct, harsh light creates shadows and squinting."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have learned to shoot well â€" sharp, correctly exposed, well-composed photos in good light. But even the best photographers edit their photos. A raw photo is a starting point, not a finished product. Today you learn to edit â€" to take your good photos and make them great. But you also learn the limits: editing can fix small problems, not big ones. And editing must always be honest."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the five quality words, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What editing is and why it matters

The idea. Editing is the process of adjusting a photo after it has been taken â€" improving the composition, correcting the exposure, adjusting the colour and removing distractions. It is the second half of photography: shooting is capturing the image; editing is refining it.

Plain-English definition. Editing is making deliberate changes to a photo to improve it â€" to make it sharper, brighter, cleaner and more appealing, while keeping it honest and true to the original scene.

Why it matters. Even the best photographers edit their photos. A raw photo straight from the camera is rarely perfect â€" it may be slightly crooked, slightly dark, slightly off-colour, or have a small distraction in the background. Editing fixes these small problems and makes the photo look professional. For business, a well-edited photo makes the product or person look more appealing â€" which means more sales.

What editing can fix:

- Cropping â€" removing distractions at the edges of the frame, improving composition.
- Straightening â€" fixing a tilted horizon or a crooked building.
- Exposure â€" brightening a dark photo, recovering detail in bright areas.
- Colour â€" adjusting the warmth or coolness of the photo, making colours natural.
- Distractions â€" removing small objects (a trash can, a stray wire, a blemish).
- Sharpness â€" enhancing detail slightly (but cannot fix a blurry photo).

What editing cannot fix:

- A blurry subject â€" if the subject is out of focus, editing cannot make it sharp.
- Poor composition â€" if the subject is lost in a cluttered scene, cropping can help but cannot completely rescue the photo.
- Bad light â€" if the light is harsh or the subject is a silhouette, editing can improve it slightly but cannot transform it.
- A missed moment â€" if the subject blinked or the action is over, editing cannot bring it back.

What editing must never do (the honest editing rules):

- Do not change a product's true appearance â€" do not make a faded product look new, or a small product look large.
- Do not fake a background â€" do not replace the sky, add elements that were not there, or remove people.
- Do not reshape a body beyond normal correction â€" do not slim a person, enlarge eyes, or alter facial features.
- Do not mislead the viewer â€" if a client or viewer would be deceived by the edit, do not do it.

Real-life comparison. Editing is like grooming. A person can shower, comb their hair, wear clean clothes and look their best â€" but they are still the same person. Editing does the same for a photo: it cleans up the presentation without changing the reality.

But just as you cannot make a short person tall with grooming, you cannot make a blurry photo sharp with editing.

Misconception to correct. "Editing is cheating â€" real photographers do not edit." False. Almost all professional photographs are edited â€" from magazine covers to wedding photos to product catalogues. The question is not whether to edit, but how to edit honestly.

F.2 The editing workflow â€" the order that matters

The idea. Editing is not random â€" it follows a logical order. Each step builds on the previous one. If you edit in the wrong order, you may undo your own work or create problems.

The CEA Editing Workflow (teach this order and return to it all session):

Step	What you do	Why this order
1. Crop and straighten	Remove distractions at the edges, fix tilted lines	Do this first â€" once you crop, you see the final composition and can judge the rest accurately
2. Correct exposure	Brighten dark areas, recover bright areas, balance overall brightness	Do this after cropping â€" the exposure needs of the final composition may differ from the original
3. Adjust colour	Set white balance (warmth/coolness), adjust saturation (colour intensity)	Do this after exposure â€" colour looks different at different brightness levels
4. Retouch	Remove blemishes, small distractions, dust spots	Do this last â€" retouching is detail work, and you want to see the final exposure and colour first
5. Sharpen (optional)	Enhance detail slightly	Do this last â€" sharpening after all other adjustments ensures you sharpen the final image

Why this order matters: If you adjust colour before cropping, you may waste time adjusting colour in areas you later crop away. If you retouch before correcting exposure, you may not see all the blemishes in the dark areas. The workflow saves time and produces better results.

Real-life comparison. The editing workflow is like building a house. You do not paint the walls before you build them. You build the structure (crop and straighten), then install the electrical (exposure), then paint (colour), then add the finishing touches (retouch), then polish (sharpen). Each step depends on the one before it.

Misconception to correct. "I can just use an auto-fix button and be done." Auto-fix is a starting point, not a finished product. It may improve the photo slightly, but it cannot make the decisions that make a photo look professional. Learn the workflow â€" it takes only a little longer and produces much better results.

F.3 Cropping and straightening

The idea. Cropping means cutting away parts of the photo â€" usually the edges â€" to improve the composition. Straightening means rotating the photo slightly to fix tilted lines â€" a crooked horizon, a leaning building, a slanted table.

When to crop:

- To remove distractions at the edges â€" a trash can, a stray object, a person's arm, empty space.
- To improve the composition â€" move the subject to a grid intersection, create more space in the direction the subject is facing.
- To change the aspect ratio â€" make the photo square (1:1) for Instagram, or wider (16:9) for a banner.

When not to crop:

- Do not crop so tightly that you lose important context â€" a portrait needs some space around the subject, a product shot needs some breathing room.
- Do not crop to fix a blurry photo â€" cropping a blurry photo makes it smaller and blurrier, not sharper.

How to crop in Snapseed:

1. Open the photo in Snapseed.
2. Tap **Tools** > **Crop**.
3. Choose an aspect ratio (Free, 1:1, 4:3, 16:9, etc.) or drag the corners freely.

4. Drag the frame to position the subject where you want it.
5. Tap the checkmark to apply.

How to straighten in Snapseed:

1. Open the photo in Snapseed.
2. Tap **Tools** > **Rotate**.
3. Use the slider to rotate the photo until the lines are straight.
4. Tap the checkmark to apply.

Worked example:

- Raw: A portrait of a person, slightly tilted, with a trash can in the bottom left corner and too much empty space above the person's head.
- Edited: Cropped to remove the trash can and the empty space, straightened so the background lines are horizontal, with the person's eyes on the top third line. The photo looks intentional and professional.

Real-life comparison. Cropping is like framing a picture for the wall. You choose the best part of the image and cut away the rest. A good crop makes the subject stand out and removes anything that distracts.

Common mistake. Cropping too aggressively â€" cutting so much that the photo becomes a tiny, pixelated mess. Always check the resolution after cropping. If the photo looks soft or pixelated, you have cropped too much.

F.4 Correcting exposure

The idea. Exposure correction means adjusting the brightness of the photo â€" making dark areas brighter, bright areas darker, and the overall image balanced. The goal is a photo where you can see detail in both the shadows and the highlights â€" not too dark, not too bright.

The three exposure adjustments (teach these and return to them all session):

Adjustment	What it does	When to use it
Brightness	Makes the whole photo brighter or darker	Use first â€" to set the overall brightness
Highlights	Adjusts only the brightest areas of the photo	Use to recover detail in bright areas (a bright sky, a window)
Shadows	Adjusts only the darkest areas of the photo	Use to brighten dark areas (a face in shadow, a dark corner)

How to correct exposure in Snapseed:

1. Open the photo in Snapseed.
2. Tap **Tools** > **Tune Image**.
3. Swipe up or down to choose Brightness, Highlights or Shadows.
4. Swipe left or right to adjust.
5. Tap the checkmark to apply.

The exposure correction workflow:

1. First, adjust **Brightness** to set the overall level.
2. Then, adjust **Highlights** to recover detail in bright areas.
3. Then, adjust **Shadows** to brighten dark areas.
4. Check the result â€" is the subject clearly visible? Are there any pure white or pure black areas with no detail?

Worked example:

- Raw: A portrait where the person's face is slightly dark (in shadow) and the background is slightly bright.
- Edited: Brightness increased slightly, Shadows increased to brighten the face, Highlights decreased slightly to recover detail in the background. The result is a balanced photo where both the face and the background have visible detail.

Real-life comparison. Exposure correction is like adjusting the lights in a room. If the room is too dim, you turn up the brightness. If one corner is too dark, you add a lamp (shadows). If one area is too bright, you dim it (highlights). The goal is even, comfortable light throughout.

Common mistake. Over-correcting â€" brightening a dark photo so much that it looks washed out and unnatural. Small adjustments are usually better than large ones. If the photo needs a huge exposure correction, it was probably badly exposed in the camera â€" prevention is better than cure.

F.5 Adjusting colour â€" white balance and saturation

The idea. Colour adjustment means making the colours in the photo look natural and appealing. Two adjustments matter for beginners: white balance (the warmth or coolness of the photo) and saturation (the intensity of the colours).

White balance:

- Every light source has a colour â€" sunlight is warm (golden), shade is cool (blue), fluorescent light is greenish, incandescent light is orange.
- White balance adjusts the photo so that white objects look white â€" not blue, not orange, not green.
- If the photo looks too warm (too orange/yellow), cool it down. If it looks too cool (too blue), warm it up.
- In Snapseed: **Tools** > **White Balance** â€" adjust the temperature slider.

Saturation:

- Saturation controls how intense the colours are.
- Low saturation = muted, subtle colours. High saturation = vivid, intense colours.
- The goal is natural, appealing colours â€" not oversaturated, cartoonish colours.
- In Snapseed: **Tools** > **Tune Image** > **Saturation** â€" adjust the slider.

The colour adjustment workflow:

1. First, set the **white balance** â€" make the colours look natural.
2. Then, adjust **saturation** â€" make the colours appealing but not artificial.
3. Check the result â€" do the colours look like the real scene, or do they look fake?

Worked example:

- Raw: A product photo taken under fluorescent light â€" the product looks greenish and unnatural.
- Edited: White balance adjusted to remove the green cast, saturation increased slightly to make the product's colours pop. The result is a photo where the product looks natural and appealing.

Real-life comparison. White balance is like choosing the right light bulb. A warm bulb makes a room feel cozy, a cool bulb makes it feel clean. You choose the bulb that fits the mood. In photography, you choose the white balance that makes the colours look true to the scene.

Common mistake. Oversaturation â€" cranking the saturation so high that the colours look cartoonish and unnatural. A little saturation goes a long way. The goal is to make the photo look like a better version of reality, not a different reality.

F.6 Retouching and blemish removal

The idea. Retouching means removing small distractions and imperfections â€" blemishes on skin, dust spots on a product, a stray object in the background. The goal is to clean up the photo without changing the subject's appearance.

What retouching can do:

- Remove a pimple or blemish on skin (while keeping natural skin texture).
- Remove a dust spot or smudge on a product.
- Remove a small distraction in the background (a wire, a leaf, a piece of litter).
- Remove a stray hair or a piece of lint on clothing.

What retouching must not do:

- Do not smooth skin so much that it looks plastic â€" keep natural texture.
- Do not remove wrinkles, scars or moles that are part of the person's identity.
- Do not remove or add elements that change the story of the photo.
- Do not reshape the body or face.

How to retouch in Snapseed:

1. Open the photo in Snapseed.
2. Tap **Tools** > **Healing**.
3. Zoom in on the blemish or distraction.
4. Tap or brush over the area you want to remove.
5. Snapseed automatically fills the area with surrounding texture.
6. Tap the checkmark to apply.

The retouching rule (say this slowly):

> *"Retouch to clean up, not to change. Remove the pimple, not the person. Remove the dust spot, not the detail. Keep the texture, keep the truth."*

Worked example:

- Raw: A portrait with a small pimple on the person's forehead and a dust spot on their shirt.
- Edited: The pimple and dust spot are removed using the Healing tool. The skin still has natural texture â€" it does not look airbrushed. The person looks like themselves, just cleaned up.

Real-life comparison. Retouching is like cleaning a window. You remove the dust and smudges so you can see through clearly â€" but you do not change what is on the other side of the glass. Retouching removes distractions so the subject stands out â€" but it does not change the subject.

Common mistake. Over-retouching â€" smoothing skin so much that it looks like plastic, or removing so much that the person looks like a different person. The goal is a clean, natural look â€" not an artificial one.

F.7 Batch editing â€" making a set consistent

The idea. When you have a set of photos â€" for a product catalogue, a portfolio, or a client delivery â€" they should look like they belong together. They should have the same white balance, the same contrast, the same overall feel. Batch editing means applying the same edits to multiple photos so they look consistent.

Why consistency matters:

- A set of product photos with different colours and brightness looks unprofessional â€" like they were taken by different people.
- A portfolio with inconsistent edits looks careless â€" like the photographer did not pay attention.
- A client expects a cohesive set â€" photos that look like they came from the same shoot.

How to batch edit in Snapseed:

1. Edit one photo in the set â€" crop, exposure, colour, retouch.
2. Tap the **Stack** icon (three stacked squares) in the top right.
3. Tap **Copy edits** â€" this saves the edits you made.
4. Open the next photo in the set.
5. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Paste edits** â€" the same edits are applied.
6. Review the result â€" make small adjustments if needed (each photo may need slight tweaks).
7. Repeat for all photos in the set.

How to batch edit in Lightroom Mobile (alternative):

1. Edit one photo in the set.
2. Tap the three dots (â€¦) > **Copy settings**.
3. Select the other photos in the set.
4. Tap **Paste settings** â€" the same edits are applied to all selected photos.
5. Review each photo and make small adjustments if needed.

The batch editing rule:

> *"Copy the edits, paste them, then review each photo individually. Batch editing gets you 90% of the way â€" the last 10% is*

checking each photo and making small adjustments."

Worked example:

- A set of five product photos for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices. Each photo was taken in the same light, but small differences in angle and distance mean the exposure and colour vary slightly.
- The first photo is edited â€" white balance set, exposure corrected, saturation adjusted. The edits are copied and pasted to the other four photos. Each photo is reviewed and small adjustments are made. The result is a set of five photos that look like they came from the same shoot â€" consistent, professional, ready for the client.

Real-life comparison. Batch editing is like making a batch of garri. You mix the ingredients once, then pour into individual cups. Each cup is slightly different â€" a bit more here, a bit less there â€" but they all taste the same. Batch editing does the same for photos: one set of edits, applied to all, with small individual adjustments.

Common mistake. Pasting edits without reviewing â€" assuming the same edits work perfectly for every photo. Each photo is different â€" different angle, different light, different distance. Always review and adjust.

F.8 The honest editing line â€" what must never be faked

The idea. Editing is a tool for improvement, not deception. There is a line between honest editing (cleaning up the photo) and dishonest editing (changing the reality). Every photographer must know where that line is.

The honest editing rules (read these aloud and make sure every learner understands):

Rule	What it means	Example
Do not change a product's true appearance	Do not make a faded product look new, or a small product look large	Do not use editing to make a scratched phone case look brand new
Do not fake a background	Do not replace the sky, add elements that were not there, or remove people	Do not add a beach background to a product photo taken in a kitchen
Do not reshape a body beyond normal correction	Do not slim a person, enlarge eyes, or alter facial features	Do not use editing to make a person look thinner than they are
Do not mislead the viewer	If a client or viewer would be deceived by the edit, do not do it	Do not edit a photo to make a small shop look like a large store

Why these rules matter:

- They protect the client â€" the client pays for an honest representation of their product or themselves.
- They protect the viewer â€" the viewer deserves to see the truth.
- They protect the photographer â€" a photographer who is caught faking edits loses their reputation and their business.
- They protect the profession â€" photography is built on trust. Dishonest editing destroys that trust.

The over-edited photo (show this on the projector):

- A photo with extreme saturation (colours look cartoonish), heavy skin smoothing (skin looks plastic), a replaced sky (the sky is clearly fake), and a reshaped body (the person looks unnaturally thin).
- Ask the class: "What is wrong with this photo?" They should identify the fakery.
- Say: "This is what happens when editing crosses the line. The photo looks fake, the person looks fake, and the viewer feels deceived. This is not editing â€" this is lying."

Real-life comparison. Honest editing is like putting on makeup. A little makeup can enhance your natural features and make you look your best. But so much makeup that you look like a different person is not enhancement â€" it is disguise. The goal is to look like the best version of yourself, not a different person.

Misconception to correct. "If the client wants it, I should do it." No. A client may ask for dishonest edits â€" a faked background, a reshaped body, a changed product. The professional photographer explains why the edit is dishonest and offers an honest alternative. If the client insists, the photographer walks away. Honesty is not negotiable.

F.9 Summary of the lecture

- Editing is the second half of photography â€” refining the raw photo into a finished image.
- The editing workflow: crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch, sharpen.
- Cropping removes distractions and improves composition. Straightening fixes tilted lines.
- Exposure correction balances brightness â€” brightness, highlights and shadows.
- Colour adjustment makes colours natural â€” white balance and saturation.
- Retouching removes small distractions â€” blemishes, dust spots, stray objects.
- Batch editing makes a set consistent â€” copy edits, paste, review each photo.
- The honest editing line: do not change a product's appearance, fake a background, reshape a body, or mislead the viewer.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Shoot] --> B[Import] --> C[Edit exposure] --> D[Adjust color] --> E[Crop & straighten] --> F[Export]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- Snapseed installed on the instructor's phone, connected to the projector.
- A sample raw photo â€” a portrait that is slightly crooked, slightly dark, with a small distraction in the background.
- A sample set of three product photos for the batch editing demonstration.
- A deliberately over-edited photo for the honest editing discussion.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” the full edit workflow (8 minutes)

Say: "I am going to edit this portrait from start to finish. Watch each step and tell me what I am doing."

Step 1 â€” Crop and straighten:

- Open the photo in Snapseed. Tap **Tools** > **Crop**.
- "The photo is slightly tilted and there is a distraction in the bottom left. I am going to crop to remove the distraction and straighten the horizon."
- Crop the photo, rotate slightly to straighten. Tap the checkmark.
- "Now the composition is cleaner and the lines are straight."

Step 2 â€” Correct exposure:

- Tap **Tools** > **Tune Image**.
- "The face is a little dark. I am going to increase the brightness slightly, then increase the shadows to brighten the face."
- Adjust brightness, then shadows. Tap the checkmark.
- "Now the face is clearly visible."

Step 3 â€” Adjust colour:

- Tap **Tools** > **White Balance**.
- "The photo looks a little cool â€” a bit blue. I am going to warm it up slightly."
- Adjust the temperature slider. Tap the checkmark.
- "Now the colours look natural and warm."

Step 4 â€” Retouch:

- Tap **Tools** > **Healing**.
- "There is a small blemish on the person's cheek. I am going to remove it."
- Zoom in, tap the blemish. Tap the checkmark.
- "The blemish is gone, but the skin still has natural texture. That is the goal."

Step 5 â€” Review:

- Show the before and after side by side.
- "Same person, same moment. But the edited version is cleaner, brighter, warmer and more professional. That is what editing does â€" it refines, it does not transform."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" batch editing (4 minutes)

Say: "Now I am going to make these three product photos consistent. They were taken in the same light, but small differences mean they do not look like a set."

Step 1: Edit the first photo â€" white balance, exposure, saturation. "This is my reference edit."

Step 2: Tap the **Stack** icon > **Copy edits**.

Step 3: Open the second photo. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Paste edits**. "The same edits are applied."

Step 4: Review the second photo. "It looks good, but the exposure is slightly different because the angle is different. I am going to adjust the brightness slightly."

Step 5: Repeat for the third photo.

Say: "Three photos, one look. They belong together now. That is batch editing â€" copy, paste, review, adjust."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" the honest editing line (3 minutes)

Show the over-edited photo. "This photo has been edited dishonestly. What is wrong with it?"

Expected learner response: "The colours are too strong," "the skin looks fake," "the sky is not real," "the person looks different."

Say: "Exactly. This is what happens when editing crosses the line. The photo looks fake, and the viewer feels deceived. Remember: edit to enhance, not to deceive. Do less, but do it well."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Why do we crop first, not last?" (Because the final composition determines what else needs adjusting.)
- "What is the difference between white balance and saturation?" (White balance is warmth/coolness; saturation is colour intensity.)
- "Why do we retouch last?" (Because we want to see the final exposure and colour before removing blemishes.)
- "Can editing fix a blurry photo?" (No â€" editing cannot create detail that was not captured.)
- "What is the most important rule of editing?" (Be honest. Do not deceive.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner edits one photo using the full workflow and batch-edits a set of three photos.

Starting materials: Learner's own phone with Snapseed installed; a raw photo from their foundations folder; a set of three photos (product, portrait or event) for batch editing; the printed Edit Decision Log.

Procedure â€" Part 1: Full edit workflow (10 minutes)

The instructor calls out each step. Learners follow on their own phones. Instructor walks the room.

1. Open Snapseed. Import a raw photo from your foundations folder.
2. **Crop and straighten:** Remove distractions, fix tilted lines. Tap the checkmark.
3. **Correct exposure:** Adjust brightness, highlights and shadows. Tap the checkmark.
4. **Adjust colour:** Set white balance, adjust saturation. Tap the checkmark.
5. **Retouch:** Remove one blemish or distraction using the Healing tool. Tap the checkmark.
6. **Review:** Compare the before and after. Write one sentence in the Edit Decision Log: "I changed _____ because _____."
7. **Save:** Export the edited photo to your gallery.

Procedure â€" Part 2: Batch editing (8 minutes)

8. Choose three photos from your foundations folder â€" they should be from the same shoot or subject.
9. Edit the first photo using the workflow above. This is your reference edit.

10. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Copy edits**.
11. Open the second photo. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Paste edits**. Review and adjust if needed.
12. Open the third photo. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Paste edits**. Review and adjust if needed.
13. Compare all three photos. Do they look like a set? If not, make small adjustments.
14. Write one sentence in the Edit Decision Log: "The set looks consistent because _____."

Expected result: One fully edited photo and a set of three batch-edited photos, each with a written description.

Points to pause and predict:

- After cropping: "Does the composition feel better? Is the subject where you want it?"
- After exposure correction: "Can you see detail in both the bright and dark areas?"
- After batch editing: "Do the three photos look like they belong together? If not, what is different?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner cannot find a tool â†' Show them on their phone. Snapseed's interface is visual â€" point to the icon.
- Over-edited photo â†' Ask: "Does this look like the real scene, or does it look fake?" Guide them to reduce the adjustments.
- Batch edits look inconsistent â†' Check if the photos were taken in different light. If so, they may need more individual adjustment.
- Learner wants to use a beauty filter â†' Remind them of the honest editing rules. Beauty filters that reshape the face are not allowed.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ One photo edited using the full workflow (crop, exposure, colour, retouch)
- ☐ Edit Decision Log completed for the single photo
- ☐ Three photos batch-edited for consistency
- ☐ Edit Decision Log completed for the set
- ☐ All edits are honest â€" no faked backgrounds, no reshaped bodies, no changed products
- ☐ All edited photos saved to the gallery

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Edit a set of five photos for a fictional client â€" Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices.

Scenario. Mama Nkechi needs a set of five product photos for her WhatsApp Business catalogue. She has given you five raw photos of her products (soup containers, spice jars, pepper soup base). The photos are usable but need editing â€" they are slightly crooked, slightly dark, and the colours are inconsistent.

Requirements:

1. Edit all five photos using the full workflow: crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch.
2. Batch-edit the set so all five photos have a consistent look â€" matching white balance, contrast and colour.
3. For each photo, write one sentence in the Edit Decision Log: "I changed _____ because _____."
4. Ensure all edits are honest â€" do not change the products' appearance, do not fake backgrounds, do not mislead the viewer.
5. Save all five edited photos in a folder named `MamaNkechi-Edited`.

Constraints:

- Use only Snapseed or Lightroom Mobile â€" no paid software.
- Do not use beauty filters or any filter that changes the products' appearance.
- The set must look like it came from the same shoot â€" consistent, professional, ready for the client.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Five photos edited using the full workflow.
- The set looks consistent â€" matching white balance, contrast and colour.

- All edits are honest and professional.
- Edit Decision Log completed for all five photos.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: Edit the first photo completely, then copy the edits to the other four. Review each one and make small adjustments.
- Hint 2: If the colours look inconsistent, check the white balance first â€" this is usually the cause.
- Hint 3: If a photo looks over-edited, reduce the adjustments. Small changes are usually better.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

A strong edited set contains:

- **Photo 1 (soup container):** Cropped to remove distractions, straightened, exposure corrected (shadows increased to brighten the label), white balance set to warm (to make the soup look appetising), saturation increased slightly. The label is readable, the soup looks warm and appealing.
- **Photo 2 (spice jar):** Same edits applied via batch. Small adjustment to exposure because the angle is different. The spice colours look rich and natural.
- **Photo 3 (pepper soup base):** Same edits applied via batch. Small adjustment to white balance because the light was slightly different. The product looks consistent with the others.
- **Photo 4 (product in use â€" a bowl of soup):** Same edits applied via batch. The soup looks warm and appetising, the colours are natural.
- **Photo 5 (group shot of all products):** Same edits applied via batch. All products look consistent â€" same white balance, same warmth, same overall feel.

The set looks like it came from the same shoot â€" professional, consistent, ready for Mama Nkechi's WhatsApp Business catalogue.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- All five photos edited using the full workflow (3)
- The set looks consistent (3)
- All edits are honest and professional (2)
- Edit Decision Log completed (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Blessing* is a photographer in Port Harcourt. She was hired to photograph a small restaurant's menu items for their Instagram page. She took the photos, edited them in Snapseed, and delivered them. The restaurant owner was happy â€" the photos looked professional and the food looked appetising. But then a customer visited the restaurant, ordered a dish, and posted a photo of the real dish next to Blessing's photo. The real dish looked nothing like the photo â€" the portion was smaller, the colours were duller, and the presentation was different. The customer accused the restaurant of false advertising.

Relevant facts.

- Blessing edited the photos honestly â€" she did not change the food's appearance or fake anything.
- But she increased the saturation significantly, making the colours look more vivid than reality.
- She used a slight blur on the background to make the food stand out â€" this is a common and acceptable technique.
- She did not tell the restaurant owner that she had increased the saturation.

Decision point. Did Blessing do something wrong? If so, what?

Possible approaches.

1. Blessing did nothing wrong â€" all photographers edit their photos, and the restaurant owner approved the final images.
2. Blessing should have been more careful with the saturation â€" the colours should look natural, not exaggerated.
3. Blessing should have told the restaurant owner what edits she made, so the owner could decide if they were acceptable.

Recommended solution. Approaches 2 and 3. Blessing's editing crossed the line from enhancement to exaggeration. The saturation was increased so much that the food looked different from reality. While she did not fake anything, she changed the food's appearance enough to mislead the customer. The lesson: edit to make the photo look like the best version of reality â€" not a different reality. And always communicate with the client about significant edits.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 ignores the customer's experience â€” the customer felt deceived, and the restaurant's reputation was damaged.
- Approach 2 is the minimum â€” the colours should look natural, not exaggerated. Small adjustments are usually better.
- Approach 3 is the professional standard â€” the client should know what edits were made and have the right to approve or request changes.

Professional connection. This case study illustrates the honest editing line in practice. Editing is a tool for improvement, not deception. A photographer who edits honestly â€” enhancing the photo without changing the reality â€” builds trust with clients and viewers. A photographer who edits dishonestly â€” exaggerating, faking, or misleading â€” loses that trust. The honest editing line is not just an ethical rule â€” it is a business strategy.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Over-editing â€” colours look cartoonish

Symptoms: The photo looks unnatural â€” colours are too vivid, skin looks plastic, the overall image looks fake. **Likely cause:** Saturation increased too much, or skin smoothing applied too heavily. **How to investigate:** Compare the edited photo to the original. Does the edited version look like a better version of reality, or a different reality? **Corrective steps:** Reduce the saturation. Reduce the skin smoothing. Aim for natural, appealing colours â€” not artificial ones. **How to confirm resolved:** The photo looks like a better version of the original, not a different image. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make small adjustments. Step back and look at the photo after each edit. If it looks too much, reduce it.

K.2 Cropping too aggressively

Symptoms: The photo is very small, pixelated, or has lost important context. **Likely cause:** Cropping so much that the resolution is too low, or cutting away important parts of the scene. **How to investigate:** Check the photo's resolution after cropping. Is it still high enough for the intended use? **Corrective steps:** Crop less. If you need a tighter crop, take the photo from closer next time â€” do not rely on cropping to fix a distant subject. **How to confirm resolved:** The photo is sharp and has sufficient resolution. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before cropping, ask: "Do I need this much crop? Can I achieve the same result by moving closer?"

K.3 Inconsistent batch edits

Symptoms: The set of photos looks mismatched â€” different colours, different brightness, different overall feel. **Likely cause:** The photos were taken in different light, and the batch edits were pasted without reviewing each photo individually. **How to investigate:** Compare the photos side by side. Are the colours and brightness consistent? **Corrective steps:** Review each photo individually. Make small adjustments to white balance, exposure and saturation as needed. **How to confirm resolved:** All photos in the set look like they came from the same shoot. **How to prevent recurrence:** After pasting batch edits, always review each photo and adjust.

K.4 Over-retouching â€” skin looks plastic

Symptoms: The person's skin looks unnaturally smooth â€” like plastic or airbrushed. **Likely cause:** The Healing tool or a smoothing filter was applied too heavily. **How to investigate:** Zoom in on the skin. Can you see natural texture â€” pores, fine lines, skin grain? **Corrective steps:** Reduce the retouching. Keep natural skin texture. Remove blemishes, not texture. **How to confirm resolved:** The skin looks clean but natural â€” like the person, not a mannequin. **How to prevent recurrence:** Use the Healing tool sparingly. Remove the blemish, not the skin.

K.5 Editing a blurry photo

Symptoms: The photographer spends time editing a blurry photo, trying to make it sharp. **Likely cause:** The photo was out of focus or the subject moved during the exposure. **How to investigate:** Zoom in on the subject. Is it sharp or blurry? **Corrective steps:** Accept that editing cannot fix a blurry photo. Use the photo only if the blur is minor and the composition is strong. Otherwise, discard it and retake. **How to confirm resolved:** The photographer stops trying to fix the unfixable and focuses on

prevention â€" better focus technique, faster shutter, or a steadier hold. **How to prevent recurrence:** Always focus-check in the camera. Take sharp photos from the start.

K.6 Faking edits â€" changing reality

Symptoms: The edited photo shows something that was not in the original â€" a replaced sky, a removed person, a reshaped body, a changed product. **Likely cause:** The photographer used editing to deceive â€" to make the photo look like something it is not. **How to investigate:** Compare the edited photo to the original. Are there elements that were not in the original? **Corrective steps:** Undo the faked edits. Edit honestly â€" enhance, do not deceive. **How to confirm resolved:** The edited photo is a better version of the original, not a different image. **How to prevent recurrence:** Follow the honest editing rules. If an edit would mislead the viewer, do not do it.

K.7 Not saving the edited photo

Symptoms: The learner edits the photo but forgets to export or save it. The edits are lost. **Likely cause:** The learner does not know how to save the edited photo in Snapseed. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner to show you the edited photo in their gallery. If it is not there, they did not save it. **Corrective steps:** Show them how to export: Tap **Export** > **Save** (saves a copy) or **Export** > **Save a copy** (keeps the original). **How to confirm resolved:** The edited photo is in the gallery. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make saving the final step of every edit. Always export before closing the app.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" look at the actual photo, compare it to the original, and confirm the cause before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Edit a Set, Not a Single â€" My Five-Image Edited Set"

Purpose: To practise the full editing workflow and batch editing on a set of five photos, producing a consistent, professional set that forms the editing style for the capstone portfolio.

Realistic scenario. You are preparing a set of product photos for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices â€" the running example for the capstone portfolio (Track A â€" Product). Mama Nkechi has given you five raw photos of her products. Your job is to edit them into a consistent, professional set for her WhatsApp Business catalogue.

Detailed instructions:

1. Choose five photos from your foundations folder â€" they should be of the same subject or from the same shoot (e.g., five product photos, five portraits, or five event photos).
2. Edit the first photo using the full workflow: crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch.
3. Copy the edits from the first photo and paste them to the other four.
4. Review each photo individually. Make small adjustments as needed â€" each photo may need slight tweaks.
5. For each photo, write one sentence in your Edit Decision Log: "I changed _____ because _____."
6. Ensure all edits are honest â€" do not change the subject's appearance, do not fake backgrounds, do not mislead the viewer.
7. Save all five edited photos in a folder named `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname/Edited-Set`.
8. Write a short reflection (3â€"5 sentences): "*The edit I am most proud of is _____ because _____. The hardest part of editing was _____. Next time I would _____.*"

Required deliverables:

- A folder with five edited photos.
- An Edit Decision Log with five entries.
- A short written reflection.

Submission format: Share the folder with the instructor (via WhatsApp, Google Drive or a USB stick) or bring your phone to Session 5 and show the folder.

Deadline: Before Session 5.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Full workflow applied	2	All five photos edited: crop, exposure, colour, retouch
Consistency of the set	3	All five photos look like they belong together
Honest editing	2	No faked backgrounds, no reshaped bodies, no changed products
Edit Decision Log	2	Accurate descriptions of changes and reasons
Reflection	1	Thoughtful and honest

Common mistakes to avoid: over-editing; inconsistent batch edits; faking edits; not saving the edited photos; not completing the Edit Decision Log.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong edited set contains:

- Five photos, each edited using the full workflow.
- The set looks consistent â€" matching white balance, contrast and colour.
- All edits are honest â€" the photos look like better versions of the originals, not different images.
- The Edit Decision Log is accurate and specific.
- The reflection is thoughtful â€" identifies strengths and areas for improvement.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is the editing workflow? Name the steps in order.

Q2. Multiple choice. You are editing a portrait. The person's face is slightly dark and the background is slightly bright. What should you adjust first? a) Saturation b) Shadows c) White balance d) Crop

Q3. Explain in your own words. What is the difference between white balance and saturation?

Q4. Practical identification. A classmate's edited photo has skin that looks like plastic â€" unnaturally smooth, with no texture. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?

Q5. Matching. Match each editing term to what it does: **crop, straighten, exposure, retouch.** a) Removes distractions at the edges of the frame b) Fixes tilted lines c) Adjusts brightness â€" brightens dark areas, recovers bright areas d) Removes blemishes and small distractions

Q6. Scenario. You are batch-editing a set of five product photos. You paste the same edits to all five, but they still look inconsistent. What is the most likely reason, and what should you do?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. The editing workflow is: (1) Crop and straighten, (2) Correct exposure, (3) Adjust colour (white balance and saturation), (4) Retouch (remove blemishes and distractions), (5) Sharpen (optional). Each step builds on the previous one.

A2. (b) Shadows. The face is dark, so you should increase the shadows to brighten it. (You might also decrease the highlights to recover detail in the bright background.)

A3. White balance adjusts the warmth or coolness of the photo â€" making colours look natural (not too orange, not too blue). Saturation adjusts the intensity of the colours â€" making them more vivid or more muted. White balance is about colour accuracy; saturation is about colour intensity.

A4. The problem is over-retouching â€" the skin has been smoothed so much that it looks unnatural. Fix: reduce the retouching. Keep natural skin texture. Remove blemishes, not texture.

A5. crop = (a); straighten = (b); exposure = (c); retouch = (d).

A6. The most likely reason is that the photos were taken in slightly different light or from slightly different angles, so the same edits do not work perfectly for every photo. What to do: review each photo individually and make small adjustments to white

balance, exposure and saturation as needed. Batch editing gets you most of the way â€" the last step is individual review.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that editing is the second half of photography â€" refining the raw photo into a finished image. You learned the editing workflow: crop and straighten first, then correct exposure, then adjust colour, then retouch, then sharpen. You learned that cropping removes distractions and improves composition. You learned that exposure correction balances brightness â€" brightness, highlights and shadows. You learned that colour adjustment makes colours natural â€" white balance and saturation. You learned that retouching removes small distractions â€" blemishes, dust spots â€" while keeping natural texture. You learned that batch editing makes a set consistent â€" copy edits, paste, review each photo. And you learned the most important rule: edit honestly. Do not change a product's appearance, fake a background, reshape a body, or mislead the viewer. Do less, but do it well.

Five important takeaways:

1. The editing workflow: crop, exposure, colour, retouch, sharpen â€" in that order.
2. Editing can fix small problems â€" cropping, exposure, colour, blemishes â€" not big ones.
3. Batch editing makes a set consistent â€" copy, paste, review, adjust.
4. The honest editing line: enhance, do not deceive.
5. Do less, but do it well â€" small, honest edits produce professional results.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I edit a photo using the full workflow without looking at my notes?
- Can I explain the difference between white balance and saturation?
- Can I batch-edit a set of photos so they look consistent?
- Can I retouch a blemish without destroying natural skin texture?
- Can I state the honest editing rules and explain why they matter?
- Can I look at an edited photo and tell if it has been edited honestly or dishonestly?

Connection to the next session. You now have the skills to shoot and edit professional-quality photos. Next session we turn to the business side: building a portfolio, pricing your work in naira, and working with clients. You will learn to select your strongest images, assemble a cohesive portfolio in Canva, build a package price list, and run a client workflow from brief to delivery. You will also learn about consent and releases â€" the legal and ethical foundation of professional photography. A timed simulation from a short client brief will test everything you have learned so far.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner follows the editing workflow in the correct order without being reminded.
- Learner makes small, honest edits â€" not over-edited, not faked.
- Learner batch-edits a set and reviews each photo individually.
- Learner can explain the honest editing rules and why they matter.
- Learner saves edited photos and organises them properly.
- Learner can look at an edited photo and identify over-editing or dishonest edits.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Editing is cheating." â†' No â€" editing is part of photography. The question is how to edit honestly.
- "More editing is better." â†' No â€" do less, but do it well. Small, honest edits produce professional results.
- "I can fix anything in editing." â†' No â€" editing cannot fix a blurry photo, poor composition, or bad light.
- "Batch editing means I do not need to review each photo." â†' No â€" always review and adjust individually.
- "The client wants it, so I should do it." â†' No â€" honesty is not negotiable. Offer an honest alternative.
- "Beauty filters are fine for business photos." â†' No â€" beauty filters that reshape the face are misleading and unprofessional.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Workflow drill:** Give the learner a raw photo and have them edit it step by step, naming each step as they go. Review the result together.
2. **Before-and-after comparison:** Have the learner edit a photo, then show the original and the edited version side by side. Ask: "What did you change? Why? Is it honest?"
3. **Over-editing identification:** Show three edited photos â€" one honest, one over-edited, one faked. Have the learner identify which is which and explain why.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a printed step-by-step guide for the editing workflow with screenshots. Pair the learner with a confident learner for the practical.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical and assignment.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to edit a photo for a specific purpose â€" a product photo for a catalogue, a portrait for a business profile, or an event photo for a newsletter â€" and write a short artist's statement explaining their editing choices and why they are honest. They should also research and present one advanced editing technique not covered in the session (e.g., selective editing, curves, or split toning).

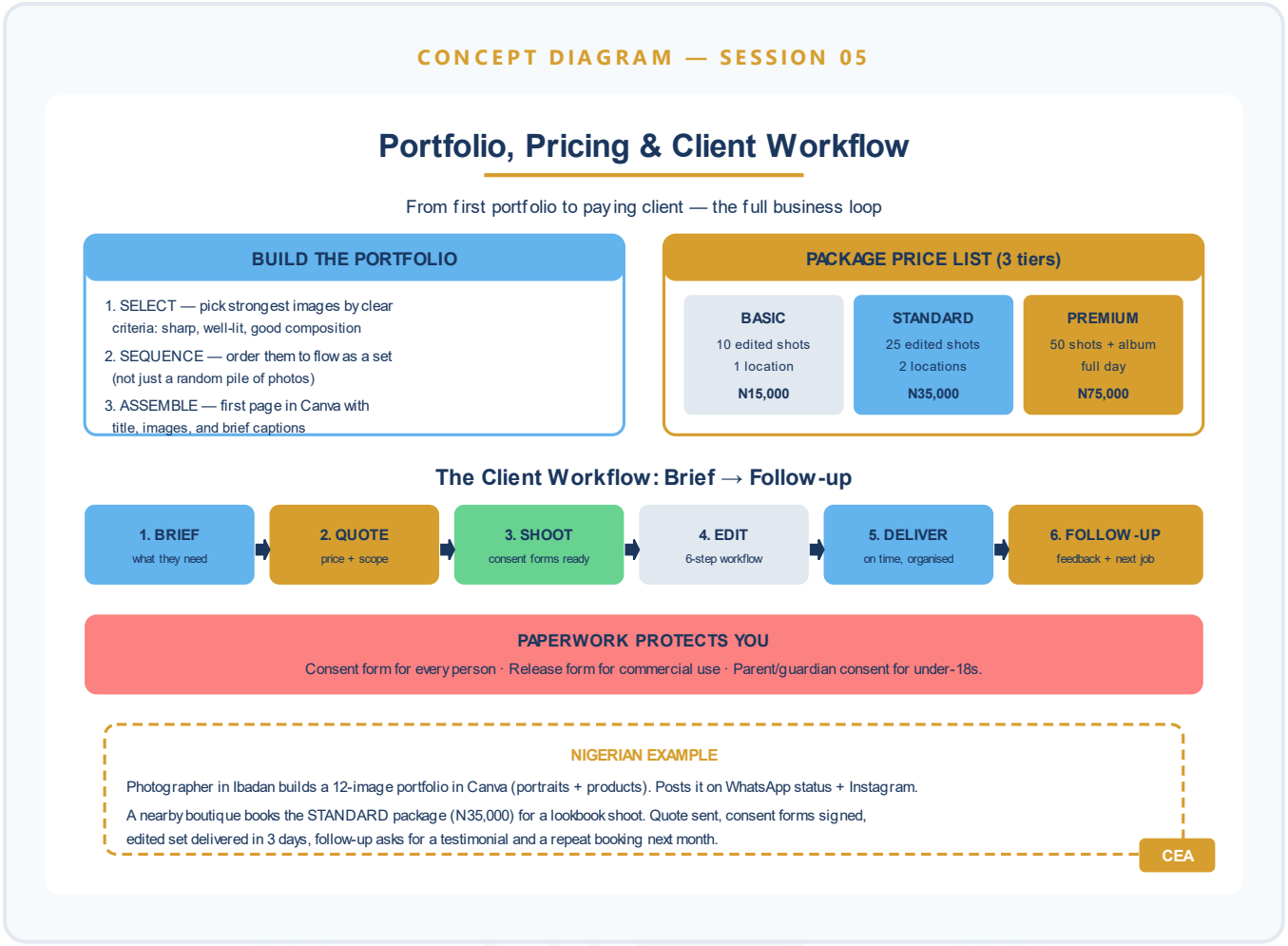
Timing guidance. The priority is learners editing photos using the full workflow (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the lecture's batch editing section to the key points â€" copy, paste, review â€" and protect the practical time. A learner who leaves without editing a photo and batch-editing a set has no editing skill and no material for the capstone.

END OF SESSION 4

Next: Session 5 â€" Building a Portfolio and Pricing Photography.

SESSION 05 OF 6

Building a Portfolio and Pricing Photography



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 5 â€" BUILDING A PORTFOLIO AND PRICING PHOTOGRAPHY

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	5 of 6
Session title	Building a Portfolio and Pricing Photography
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: "Process and Deliver"
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (practical, business-focused)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"4 â€" the learner should have a foundations folder of raw photos, an edited set, and the ability to shoot and edit to a usable standard. No prior business or pricing knowledge

Item	Detail
	assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Sessions 1â€“4 you learned to shoot and edit professional-quality photos. Now you learn to select your strongest work, assemble a cohesive portfolio, price your services in naira, and work with clients professionally. This session prepares you for the capstone â€” the themed photo shoot and mini portfolio.
Preparation before class	Academy computers with internet access and Canva installed or accessible; the instructor's computer connected to the projector for live Canva demonstration; a sample portfolio (printed or projected) showing a strong and a weak portfolio; a sample price list for a fictional Port Harcourt photographer; printed consent and release forms; the "Portfolio Selection Sheet" (Section H) printed per learner; a short fictional client brief for the timed simulation.

Instructor note on tone: This session is about professionalism and business. Many learners are creative but uncomfortable with the business side â€” pricing, talking about money, presenting their work. Create a supportive, practical atmosphere. Emphasise that pricing is not greedy â€” it is fair. Presenting your work is not arrogance â€” it is professionalism. The goal is to help learners see themselves as professionals, not hobbyists.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Select** the strongest images from their body of work, using clear quality criteria.
2. **Sequence** a portfolio so it flows as a cohesive set â€” not just a collection of individual photos.
3. **Assemble** a first portfolio page in Canva, with a title, images and brief descriptions.
4. **Build a package price list** in naira with at least three packages, each with clear deliverables.
5. **Describe a client workflow** from brief to delivery: brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
6. **Use consent and release forms** correctly, including parent/guardian consent for under-18s.
7. **Complete a timed simulation** â€” plan, shoot, edit and present a delivery-ready set from a short client brief.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with their foundations folder and edited set.
- Academy computers with internet access for Canva.
- Instructor's computer connected to a projector for live Canva demonstration.

Software

- **Canva** (free tier) â€” available at canva.com or as a mobile app. Used for assembling the portfolio.
- No paid software required. No subscription required.

Accounts

- A free Canva account (email sign-up) â€” learners should create this before or during the session.

Sample files

- **A sample portfolio** (printed or projected) â€” one strong portfolio (cohesive, well-sequenced, professional) and one weak portfolio (random order, inconsistent quality, no flow).
- **A sample price list** for a fictional Port Harcourt photographer â€” showing three packages with clear deliverables in naira.
- **Consent and release forms** (printed per learner).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 5.1 â€” "Portfolio Selection Sheet" (a table: image, quality rating, reason for selection/rejection).
- Worksheet 5.2 â€” "Package Price List Template" (a table: package name, what is included, price in naira).

- Worksheet 5.3 â€" "Client Workflow Sheet" (a table: step, what happens, who is responsible).

Tools

- A whiteboard and markers for drawing the client workflow diagram.

Internet

- Required for Canva. Not required for the rest of the session.

Alternative for learners who lack a computer or internet

- A learner without computer access may use the Canva mobile app on their phone, or assemble a printed portfolio with printed photos and handwritten descriptions. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Ethics note: Consent and releases are not optional. Before using any person's image in a portfolio or for commercial purposes, obtain written consent. For under-18s, obtain parent/guardian consent. This is a legal and ethical obligation.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two portfolios:

- **Portfolio A (strong):** A set of five product photos for a fictional food business. The photos are consistent â€" same style, same light, same background. They are sequenced to tell a story: the ingredients, the preparation, the finished dish, the packaging, the happy customer. The portfolio has a title, the photographer's name, and a brief description of each photo.
- **Portfolio B (weak):** A set of ten photos â€" some product shots, some portraits, some landscapes, some event photos. They are in random order, with different styles and quality levels. There is no title, no description, no flow.

What the instructor says:

> *"Two portfolios. Both contain good photos. But one looks like a professional photographer made it, and one looks like someone just dumped all their photos in a folder. Hands up â€" which portfolio would you hire? â€¦ Portfolio A, almost everyone. Now tell me: what is different about Portfolio A?"*

Expected learner response: Learners will say things like "it looks organised," "the photos match," "it tells a story," "it has a title," "it looks professional," "it is not mixed up." Accept all answers and write the key phrases on the board: **consistent, organised, story, title, professional, flow.**

Then reveal the lesson: Say clearly:

> *"A portfolio is not 'all my best photos.' It is the right photos in the right order, telling the right story. Today you learn to select your strongest work, sequence it so it flows, and assemble it in Canva. You also learn to price your work in naira â€" because photography is a skill, and skills have value. And you learn to work with clients professionally â€" from the first brief to the final delivery. By the end of this session, you will have a first portfolio page, a price list, and a client workflow sheet."*

Why this opener works: It uses two portfolios with the same quality of photos but very different presentation, proving that selection and sequencing â€" not just photo quality â€" make the difference. It introduces the business side of photography before any technical explanation.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What is the editing workflow? Name the steps in order."

- Expected answer: Crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch, sharpen.
- Common gap: Learners may forget the order. Clarify: "Crop first, then exposure, then colour, then retouch, then sharpen."

Question 2: "What are the honest editing rules? Name two."

- Expected answer: Do not change a product's true appearance; do not fake a background; do not reshape a body beyond normal correction; do not mislead the viewer.
- Common gap: Learners may remember one rule but not others. Clarify: "Enhance, do not deceive. If a client or viewer would be misled, do not do it."

Question 3: "What is batch editing, and why does it matter?"

- Expected answer: Batch editing means applying the same edits to multiple photos so they look consistent. It matters because a set of photos should look like they belong together â€" not like they were taken by different people.
- Common gap: Learners may think batch editing means pasting edits without reviewing. Clarify: "Copy, paste, review each photo, adjust. Batch editing gets you 90% of the way â€" the last 10% is individual review."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You can shoot and edit professional-quality photos. But a photographer is not just a person who takes photos â€" a photographer is a professional who delivers a product to a client. Today you learn the professional side: selecting your best work, building a portfolio, pricing your services, and working with clients. This is where your skill becomes a business."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the editing workflow, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing it on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What a portfolio is and why it matters

The idea. A portfolio is a curated collection of your best work, presented in a way that shows your skill, your style and your professionalism. It is not a dump of every photo you have ever taken â€" it is a deliberate selection of your strongest images, sequenced to tell a story.

Plain-English definition. A portfolio is a small, carefully chosen set of your best photographs, organised to show a potential client what you can do. It is your professional face â€" the first thing a client sees when they consider hiring you.

Why it matters:

- It shows your skill. A portfolio proves you can deliver professional-quality work.
- It shows your style. A portfolio shows the kind of photography you do best â€" portraits, products, events.
- It builds trust. A professional portfolio makes a client feel confident hiring you.
- It wins work. A strong portfolio is the difference between getting hired and being passed over.

The three rules of a strong portfolio (teach these and return to them all session):

Rule	What it means	Why it matters
1. Select ruthlessly	Include only your strongest images â€" not every photo you like	A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio. Quality over quantity.
2. Sequence for flow	Arrange the photos so they tell a story â€" not random order	A portfolio that flows feels professional. A random collection feels careless.
3. Show consistency	The photos should look like they belong together â€" same style, same quality	Consistency shows you can deliver a reliable standard. Inconsistency shows you cannot.

What a portfolio is NOT:

- It is not "all my best photos." It is the *right* photos â€" the ones that show your skill and style for the work you want to do.
- It is not a random collection. It is a curated, sequenced set.
- It is not a place for experiments. It is a professional presentation â€" save experiments for your personal work.

Real-life comparison. A portfolio is like a job resume. A resume is not a list of everything you have ever done â€" it is a curated selection of your most relevant experience, presented clearly and professionally. A portfolio does the same for your photography: it shows the client the best of what you can do, in a way that makes them want to hire you.

Misconception to correct. "I need to have hundreds of photos before I can build a portfolio." No. A strong portfolio can be five photos. A weak portfolio is weak even with five hundred. Quality and curation matter more than quantity.

F.2 Selecting your best work

The idea. Selecting your best work is the most important skill in building a portfolio. It requires honesty â€” you must be able to look at your own photos and say "this one is not good enough." This is hard, because you have an emotional attachment to your photos. But a professional learns to select ruthlessly.

The selection criteria (teach these and return to them all session):

Criterion	What to ask yourself	Why it matters
Sharpness	Is the subject sharp? Can I see the detail when I zoom in?	A blurry photo is unusable â€” no exceptions.
Exposure	Is the photo correctly exposed â€ not too dark, not too bright?	A poorly exposed photo looks amateur.
Composition	Is the composition intentional? Does the photo look like someone made choices?	A poorly composed photo looks accidental.
Light	Is the light flattering? Does the subject look their best?	Bad light ruins an otherwise good photo.
Moment	Does the photo capture the right instant? Does it feel alive?	A missed moment is a missed opportunity.
Honesty	Is the photo honestly edited? Does it look like the real scene?	A dishonest photo destroys trust.

The selection process:

1. Gather all your photos from the course â€ the foundations folder, the edited set, any other photos you are proud of.
2. Review each photo against the six criteria.
3. Rate each photo: **Strong** (meets all criteria), **Acceptable** (meets most criteria), **Weak** (fails one or more criteria).
4. Select only the **Strong** photos for your portfolio. If you do not have enough Strong photos, shoot more â€ do not lower your standard.
5. Aim for 5â€"8 photos for a mini portfolio. Quality over quantity.

The ruthless selection rule (say this slowly):

> *"If a photo is not Strong, it does not go in the portfolio. Not 'almost Strong.' Not 'good enough.' Strong. A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio."*

Real-life comparison. Selecting your best work is like a chef choosing ingredients for a signature dish. The chef does not use every ingredient in the kitchen â€ they choose the best, the freshest, the most flavourful. A portfolio is your signature dish â€ use only your best ingredients.

Common mistake. Including a photo because you like the memory, not because the photo is strong. A photo of a beautiful sunset that is slightly blurry does not belong in your portfolio â€ no matter how much you enjoyed the sunset. The portfolio is about the photo, not the memory.

F.3 Sequencing a portfolio â€ telling a story

The idea. A portfolio is not just a collection of strong photos â€ it is a sequence that tells a story. The order matters. A well-sequenced portfolio flows naturally, building from one photo to the next, creating a cohesive experience for the viewer.

The sequencing principles (teach these and return to them all session):

Principle	What it means	Example
1. Start strong	Your first photo should be your strongest â€” it sets the impression	Open with your most impactful image
2. Build gradually	Move from strong to strongest â€” build the story	Start with a wide shot, move to details, end with the hero shot
3. Create contrast	Vary the photos â€ different angles, different scales, different moods	Do not put three similar photos next to each other
4. End strong	Your last photo should be memorable â€ it is what the viewer remembers	Close with your most emotional or impactful image
5. Keep it consistent	All photos should look like they belong together â€ same style, same quality	Do not mix heavily edited and unedited photos

The story arc for a product portfolio:

1. **The hero shot** â€ the product at its best, the first impression.
2. **The detail shot** â€ a close-up of the product's texture, label or key feature.
3. **The context shot** â€ the product in use or in its environment.
4. **The variety shot** â€ showing the range of products or options.
5. **The closing shot** â€ a memorable image that leaves a lasting impression.

The story arc for a portrait portfolio:

1. **The establishing shot** â€ a wide portrait showing the person in their environment.
2. **The character shot** â€ a closer portrait showing the person's personality.
3. **The detail shot** â€ hands, eyes, or a meaningful object.
4. **The emotion shot** â€ a genuine laugh, a thoughtful look, a moment of joy.
5. **The closing shot** â€ a strong, memorable portrait that captures the person's essence.

Real-life comparison. Sequencing a portfolio is like telling a story. A good story has a beginning (the hook), a middle (the development) and an end (the resolution). A portfolio does the same â€ it draws the viewer in, builds interest, and leaves a lasting impression.

Common mistake. Putting all your strongest photos at the beginning and letting the quality drop off at the end. The viewer remembers the last photo most â€ make it count.

F.4 Building a portfolio in Canva

The idea. Canva is a free, browser-based design tool that makes it easy to assemble a professional-looking portfolio. You do not need design experience â€ Canva provides templates, drag-and-drop editing and professional layouts.

How to build a portfolio page in Canva:

1. **Create a free account** at canva.com (or download the Canva app).
2. **Choose a template** â€ search for "portfolio" or "photo gallery" in the template library. Choose a clean, simple template â€ do not choose anything too busy or colourful.
3. **Add a title** â€ your name, the course name and the date. Example: "Chinedu Okafor â€ CEA Photography â€ October 2026."
4. **Add your photos** â€ drag and drop your selected photos into the template. Arrange them in your sequenced order.
5. **Add brief descriptions** â€ under each photo, add one sentence explaining what the photo shows and why it is in the portfolio. Example: "Product shot â€ Mama Nkechi's pepper soup base. Natural window light, rule of thirds composition."
6. **Review and adjust** â€ check the layout, the spacing, the alignment. Make sure everything looks clean and professional.
7. **Export** â€ download the portfolio as a PDF or PNG. This is your portfolio file.

The portfolio page checklist:

- ☐ Title with your name, course and date
- ☐ 5â€"8 photos, sequenced for flow

- ☐ Brief description under each photo
- ☐ Clean, professional layout
- ☐ Consistent style across all photos
- ☐ Exported as a PDF or PNG

Real-life comparison. Building a portfolio in Canva is like arranging a shop window. You choose the best products, arrange them in a pleasing order, add clear labels, and make sure everything looks clean and professional. Canva is your shop window â€" make it inviting.

Common mistake. Using a template that is too busy or colourful â€" the template competes with your photos for attention. Choose a clean, simple template that lets your photos stand out.

F.5 Pricing your photography â€" packages in naira

The idea. Pricing is one of the hardest parts of photography â€" especially for beginners. You do not want to charge too little (you devalue your work) or too much (you price yourself out of the market). The solution is to build clear packages with defined deliverables, so the client knows exactly what they are getting for their money.

The two pricing models:

Model	What it means	When to use it
Per hour	You charge for the time you spend shooting	Good for events, where the time is the main variable
Per package	You charge a fixed price for a defined set of deliverables	Good for portraits and products, where the deliverables are clear

The package pricing model (recommended for beginners):

A package is a fixed price for a clear set of deliverables. The client knows what they are getting, and you know what you are delivering. This removes ambiguity and builds trust.

Three sample packages for a product photographer in Port Harcourt:

Package	What is included	Price (example)
Basic	5 edited product photos, 1 background option, 3-day delivery	â‚¦15,000
Standard	10 edited product photos, 2 background options, 2-day delivery, 1 revision round	â‚¦30,000
Premium	20 edited product photos, 3 background options, 1-day delivery, 2 revision rounds, social media captions	â‚¦60,000

Three sample packages for a portrait photographer in Port Harcourt:

Package	What is included	Price (example)
Basic	30-minute shoot, 5 edited photos, 1 location, 3-day delivery	â‚¦10,000
Standard	1-hour shoot, 10 edited photos, 2 locations, 2-day delivery, 1 revision round	â‚¦25,000
Premium	2-hour shoot, 20 edited photos, 3 locations, 1-day delivery, 2 revision rounds, printed photos	â‚¦50,000

How to set your prices:

1. **Research the market** â€" what do other photographers in Port Harcourt charge? Ask around, check social media, look at competitor pricing.
2. **Calculate your costs** â€" your time, transport, editing time, any props or materials.
3. **Set a fair price** â€" not so little that you lose money, not so much that you price yourself out. As a beginner, you may charge less than an experienced photographer â€" but do not work for free.
4. **Offer packages** â€" packages make it easy for the client to say yes. They know what they are getting, and you know what you are delivering.
5. **Be transparent** â€" state your prices clearly. Do not hide them or make the client guess.

The pricing rules (teach these and return to them all session):

- **Never work for free** (except for practice or an agreed favour). Free work devalues your skill and sets an expectation that your work is worth nothing.
- **State your prices clearly** â€" do not be vague or apologistic. Your skill has value.
- **Deliver what you promise** â€" if you say 10 photos, deliver 10 photos. If you say 3-day delivery, deliver in 3 days.
- **Revise your prices as you grow** â€" as your skill and reputation grow, your prices should grow too.

Real-life comparison. Pricing is like a market trader setting prices for her goods. She knows her costs, she knows what the market will bear, and she sets a fair price. She does not give her goods away for free, and she does not charge so much that no one buys. A photographer does the same â€" set a fair price for a clear deliverable.

Misconception to correct. "I am a beginner, so I should charge very little or nothing." No. You have a skill that took time and effort to learn. Charge a fair price â€" less than an experienced photographer, perhaps, but not nothing. Free work devalues your skill and makes it harder to charge fairly later.

F.6 The client workflow â€" from brief to delivery

The idea. A professional photographer does not just take photos â€" they manage a process. The client workflow is the step-by-step process from the first conversation to the final delivery. It ensures nothing is missed, the client knows what to expect, and the work is delivered professionally.

The six-step client workflow (teach these and return to them all session):

Step	What happens	Who is responsible
1. Brief	The client explains what they need â€" the purpose, the subject, the style, the deadline	Client provides, photographer listens and asks questions
2. Quote	The photographer provides a price based on the brief â€" a package price or an hourly rate	Photographer
3. Shoot	The photographer plans and executes the shoot â€" location, light, composition, consent	Photographer
4. Edit	The photographer edits the photos â€" crop, exposure, colour, retouch, batch edit	Photographer
5. Deliver	The photographer delivers the final photos â€" in the agreed format, by the agreed deadline	Photographer
6. Follow-up	The photographer checks that the client is happy, asks for feedback, and requests a testimonial or referral if appropriate	Photographer

The brief â€" the most important step: The brief is the foundation of the entire job. A clear brief means a clear delivery. A vague brief means a confused client and a missed expectation.

The brief should answer these questions:

- What is the purpose of the photos? (Product catalogue, portrait, event coverage, social media?)
- What is the subject? (A specific product, a person, an event?)
- What style do you want? (Clean and minimal, warm and natural, dramatic?)
- How many photos do you need?
- What is the deadline?
- What is the budget?
- Are there any specific requirements? (Background, props, locations, consent?)

The quote â€" clear and professional:

- State the package or price clearly.
- State what is included â€" number of photos, delivery time, revision rounds.
- State what is not included â€" extra photos, rush delivery, additional locations.
- State the payment terms â€" deposit (e.g., 50% before the shoot), balance on delivery.

The shoot â€" planned and professional:

- Arrive on time.
- Check the light, the background, the composition.
- Obtain consent from any person photographed.
- Take more photos than needed â€" you can always edit down.

The edit â€" honest and consistent:

- Use the editing workflow: crop, exposure, colour, retouch, sharpen.
- Batch-edit for consistency.
- Review each photo individually.

The delivery â€" on time and in the agreed format:

- Deliver the photos in the agreed format (JPEG, PNG, PDF).
- Deliver by the agreed deadline.
- Include a brief note explaining what was delivered and how to use the photos.

The follow-up â€" build the relationship:

- Check that the client is happy.
- Ask for feedback â€" what went well, what could be improved.
- If the client is happy, ask for a testimonial or a referral.
- Stay in touch â€" a past client is the best source of future work.

Real-life comparison. The client workflow is like a restaurant experience. The brief is the customer telling the waiter what they want. The quote is the menu price. The shoot is the kitchen preparing the meal. The edit is the chef plating the dish. The delivery is the waiter serving the meal. The follow-up is the manager asking if everything was satisfactory. A good restaurant manages all six steps â€" a good photographer does the same.

Common mistake. Skipping the brief â€" just showing up and shooting without understanding what the client wants. This leads to missed expectations, wasted time and an unhappy client. Always start with a clear brief.

F.7 Consent and releases â€" the legal and ethical foundation

The idea. Before you photograph a person â€" for practice, portfolio or client use â€" you must obtain their consent. Before you use a person's image commercially, you must obtain a release. This is not just politeness â€" it is a legal and ethical obligation.

The difference between consent and a release:

Document	What it is	When you need it
Consent form	The person agrees to be photographed	Before you take the photo
Model release	The person agrees to let you use their image	Before you use the image (portfolio, client work, social media)

The consent form (simple version):

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CONSENT TO BE PHOTOGRAPHED

I, _____ (name), agree to be photographed by
_____ (photographer's name) on _____ (date).

I understand that the photographs may be used for:
[ ] Practice and learning
[ ] Portfolio
[ ] Client/business use
[ ] Social media

I give my permission freely and can ask for the photos to be deleted at any time.

Signature: _____
Date: _____
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For subjects under 18:
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Parent/Guardian name: _____
Parent/Guardian signature: _____
Date: _____
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The model release (simple version):

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MODEL RELEASE

I, _____ (name), give _____ (photographer's name)
permission to use my photograph for:
[ ] Portfolio
[ ] Client/business use
[ ] Social media
[ ] Other: _____

I understand that:
- I am giving this permission freely.
- I can withdraw this permission at any time by contacting the photographer.
- I will not receive payment for the use of my image (unless otherwise agreed in writing).

Signature: _____
Date: _____

For subjects under 18:
Parent/Guardian name: _____
Parent/Guardian signature: _____
Date: _____
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Why consent and releases matter:

- They are respectful. People have the right to control how their image is used.
- They are professional. A photographer who obtains consent and releases is trusted. One who does not is avoided.
- They are legal. In Nigeria, using someone's image without permission â€" especially for commercial purposes â€" can create legal problems.
- They protect both parties. The photographer has proof of permission. The subject has the right to withdraw permission.

Misconception to correct. "If I am in a public place, I do not need consent." Not exactly. You can photograph public scenes and buildings, but photographing identifiable people â€" especially for commercial use â€" requires consent. When in doubt, ask.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- A portfolio is a curated collection of your best work, sequenced to tell a story.
- Select ruthlessly â€" only Strong photos go in the portfolio.
- Sequence for flow â€" start strong, build gradually, end strong, keep it consistent.
- Build the portfolio in Canva â€" clean template, title, photos, descriptions, export as PDF.
- Price your work in packages â€" clear deliverables, fair prices in naira.
- Follow the client workflow â€" brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
- Obtain consent and releases â€" before photographing and before using images.

Key concept diagram:

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flowchart LR
    A[Best 20 photos] --> B[Portfolio website] --> C[Set package prices] --> D[Get first client]
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G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A computer with Canva open, connected to the projector.

- A set of sample photos (product or portrait) for the portfolio demonstration.
- A sample price list and client workflow sheet.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" selecting and sequencing (4 minutes)

Say: "I have 12 photos from a product shoot. I am going to select the strongest five and sequence them for a portfolio."

Step 1: Show all 12 photos quickly. "I am going to rate each one: Strong, Acceptable or Weak."

Step 2: Rate each photo out loud. "This one is Strong â€" sharp, well-lit, good composition. This one is Acceptable â€" slightly dark. This one is Weak â€" blurry."

Step 3: Select the five Strong photos. "These are my five. Quality over quantity."

Step 4: Sequence them. "I will start with the hero shot â€" the product at its best. Then a detail shot. Then a context shot. Then a variety shot. Then a closing shot â€" something memorable."

Say: "Selection is the hardest part. You have to be honest with yourself. But a portfolio with five Strong photos is better than a portfolio with ten mixed photos."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" building the portfolio in Canva (6 minutes)

Say: "Now I am going to assemble the portfolio in Canva. Watch each step."

Step 1: Open Canva. Search for a "portfolio" template. Choose a clean, simple one.

Step 2: Add a title. "Chinedu Okafor â€" CEA Photography â€" October 2026."

Step 3: Drag and drop the five selected photos into the template. Arrange them in the sequenced order.

Step 4: Add brief descriptions under each photo. "Product shot â€" Mama Nkechi's pepper soup base. Natural window light, rule of thirds composition."

Step 5: Review the layout. Adjust spacing and alignment.

Step 6: Export as a PDF.

Say: "A portfolio is your professional face. It should be clean, organised and easy to read. The photos are the star â€" the layout should support them, not compete with them."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" pricing and workflow (4 minutes)

Say: "Now I am going to show you a price list and a client workflow. These are the business tools every photographer needs."

Show the sample price list. "Three packages: Basic, Standard, Premium. Each has clear deliverables â€" number of photos, delivery time, revision rounds. The prices are in naira. As a beginner, you might charge less than these examples â€" but the structure is the same."

Show the client workflow sheet. "Six steps: brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up. The brief is the most important â€" if you do not understand what the client wants, you cannot deliver it. The follow-up is the most forgotten â€" but it is how you build long-term relationships."

Say: "Pricing is not greedy â€" it is fair. You have a skill, and skills have value. Present your prices clearly, deliver what you promise, and follow up to make sure the client is happy. That is professionalism."

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why do we select only Strong photos?" (A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio.)
- "Why does the first photo matter most?" (It sets the impression â€" start strong.)
- "Why use packages instead of hourly rates?" (Packages are clear â€" the client knows what they are getting.)
- "What is the most important step in the client workflow?" (The brief â€" if you do not understand the need, you cannot deliver.)
- "Why do we need a model release?" (To use someone's image commercially, you need their written permission.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner selects and sequences a set of photos, builds a first portfolio page in Canva, and creates a price list and client workflow sheet.

Starting materials: Learner's own phone or academy computer; Canva account (free); the learner's foundations folder and edited set; the printed worksheets.

Procedure â€" Part 1: Selection and sequencing (6 minutes)

1. Gather all your photos from the course â€" foundations folder, edited set, any other photos.
2. Review each photo against the six criteria: sharpness, exposure, composition, light, moment, honesty.
3. Rate each photo: Strong, Acceptable or Weak.
4. Select 5â€"8 Strong photos for your portfolio.
5. Sequence them: start strong, build gradually, end strong, keep it consistent.
6. Write your selection and sequencing decisions in the Portfolio Selection Sheet.

Procedure â€" Part 2: Building the portfolio in Canva (8 minutes)

7. Open Canva. Search for a portfolio template. Choose a clean, simple one.
8. Add a title: your name, course name, date.
9. Add your selected photos in the sequenced order.
10. Add a brief description under each photo.
11. Review and adjust the layout.
12. Export as a PDF.

Procedure â€" Part 3: Price list and workflow (4 minutes)

13. Create a price list with at least three packages. Use the Package Price List Template. Set fair prices in naira.
14. Complete the Client Workflow Sheet â€" the six steps from brief to follow-up.
15. Write one sentence: "My pricing philosophy is _____."

Expected result: A portfolio page (PDF), a price list with three packages, and a completed client workflow sheet.

Points to pause and predict:

- After selection: "Are all your selected photos Strong? If not, replace them."
- After sequencing: "Does your portfolio flow? Does it start strong and end strong?"
- After Canva: "Is your layout clean? Do the photos stand out?"
- After pricing: "Are your prices fair â€" not too low, not too high?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner includes too many photos â†' Remind them: "Quality over quantity. 5â€"8 photos."
- Learner's portfolio has no flow â†' Ask: "What story does your portfolio tell? Does it start strong and end strong?"
- Learner's Canva layout is too busy â†' Suggest a simpler template. "The photos are the star."
- Learner's prices are too low â†' Ask: "What is your time worth? Do not undervalue your skill."
- Learner's prices are too high â†' Ask: "What do other photographers in Port Harcourt charge? Research the market."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ 5â€"8 Strong photos selected
- ☐ Photos sequenced for flow
- ☐ Portfolio Selection Sheet completed
- ☐ Portfolio page built in Canva and exported as PDF
- ☐ Price list with three packages created
- ☐ Client Workflow Sheet completed
- ☐ Pricing philosophy stated

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Complete a timed simulation â€" plan, shoot, edit and present a delivery-ready set from a short client brief.

Scenario. You have been hired by *Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices* (the running capstone example) to photograph five product photos for her WhatsApp Business catalogue. You have 15 minutes to complete the entire job â€" from brief to delivery.

The brief (read this carefully):

- **Client:** Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices
- **Purpose:** WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram
- **Subject:** Five products â€" pepper soup base, dried fish, spice mix, palm oil, and a bowl of finished soup
- **Style:** Clean, appetising, natural light, consistent look
- **Deliverables:** Five edited photos, consistent style, delivered as JPEG files
- **Deadline:** 15 minutes from now

Requirements:

1. **Plan (2 minutes):** Read the brief. Plan your shoot â€" which products, what order, what light, what background. Write a quick shot list.
2. **Shoot (6 minutes):** Photograph the five products. Use the 5-step sharpness routine. Use natural light. Compose deliberately. Take several frames of each product.
3. **Edit (5 minutes):** Edit the five photos using the workflow. Batch-edit for consistency. Save as JPEG.
4. **Present (2 minutes):** Present your five photos to the class (or to a partner). Explain your choices â€" light, composition, editing.

Constraints:

- Use only the built-in camera app and Snapseed â€" no paid software.
- All edits must be honest â€" do not change the products' appearance.
- The five photos must look consistent â€" same style, same light, same overall feel.
- You must deliver five photos in 15 minutes.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Five photos delivered within 15 minutes.
- All photos are sharp, correctly exposed and well-composed.
- The set looks consistent â€" like it came from the same shoot.
- All edits are honest.
- The learner can explain their choices.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: Plan before you shoot. Know which products, what order, what light.
- Hint 2: Use the same light and background for all five photos â€" this ensures consistency.
- Hint 3: Edit the first photo completely, then copy the edits to the other four. Review each one.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

A strong simulation delivery contains:

- **Five photos:** Pepper soup base, dried fish, spice mix, palm oil, and a bowl of finished soup.
- **Consistent style:** All photographed in the same light (window light or open shade), same background (plain surface), same angle (45 degrees or eye level).
- **Sharp and correctly exposed:** All five photos are sharp on the product, correctly exposed.
- **Honest edits:** Cropped, exposure corrected, colour adjusted, batch-edited for consistency. No faked backgrounds, no changed products.
- **Presentation:** The learner explains their choices â€" "I used window light for soft, flattering light. I placed each product on a grid intersection. I batch-edited for consistency."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Five photos delivered within 15 minutes (2)
- All photos sharp and correctly exposed (2)
- The set looks consistent (2)
- All edits are honest (2)

- Presentation explains choices clearly (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Emeka* is a beginner photographer in Port Harcourt. He has been shooting for a few months and has a collection of photos he is proud of. He wants to start charging for his work, but he does not know how to present himself or price his services. He posts his photos on Instagram with the caption "DM for prices" and waits for clients. After three months, he has had only two enquiries and no bookings.

Relevant facts.

- Emeka has no portfolio â€" just individual Instagram posts.
- He has no price list â€" he tells people to "DM for prices."
- He has no client workflow â€" he does not know how to handle a brief, quote or delivery.
- He has no consent forms â€" he photographs people without asking.
- His photos are actually good â€" sharp, well-lit, well-composed.

Decision point. What is the main reason Emeka is not getting clients?

Possible approaches.

1. Emeka needs better photos â€" his current work is not good enough.
2. Emeka needs to present himself professionally â€" a portfolio, a price list, a clear workflow.
3. Emeka needs to post more often on Instagram â€" consistency on social media is the key.

Recommended solution. Approach 2. Emeka's photos are good â€" his problem is presentation. A potential client who sees individual Instagram posts with "DM for prices" does not know what Emeka offers, what it costs, or what to expect. A professional portfolio, a clear price list and a defined workflow make it easy for a client to say yes.

Specific fixes for Emeka:

- Build a portfolio: Select his strongest 5â€"8 photos, sequence them, assemble them in Canva.
- Create a price list: Three packages with clear deliverables in naira.
- Define a client workflow: Brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
- Obtain consent: Ask before photographing people, use consent forms.
- Present clearly: Instead of "DM for prices," post his portfolio and price list. Let the work speak.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is unnecessary â€" Emeka's photos are already good. Better photos will not fix a presentation problem.
- Approach 2 addresses the actual gap â€" presentation and professionalism. It is free (Canva is free, pricing is just a document) and immediately makes Emeka look professional.
- Approach 3 is partially true â€" consistency on social media matters â€" but without a portfolio and price list, more posts will not convert followers into clients.

Professional connection. This case study illustrates the difference between a hobbyist and a professional. A hobbyist takes photos and posts them. A professional presents their work, prices their services and manages the client relationship. The skill is the same â€" the presentation is what makes the difference. Emeka has the skill; he needs the presentation.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Including too many photos in the portfolio

Symptoms: The portfolio has 15, 20 or 30 photos â€" it feels overwhelming and unfocused. **Likely cause:** The learner is emotionally attached to their photos and cannot bear to leave any out. **How to investigate:** Count the photos. Is the number between 5 and 8? If not, it is too many. **Corrective steps:** Reduce to 5â€"8 photos. Select only the Strong ones. Quality over

quantity. **How to confirm resolved:** The portfolio has 5â€“8 Strong photos. **How to prevent recurrence:** Set a limit before you start. "I will select exactly 7 photos. No more."

K.2 Portfolio with no flow â€” random order

Symptoms: The photos are in no particular order â€” a product shot, then a portrait, then a landscape, then another product shot. **Likely cause:** The learner selected strong photos but did not think about sequencing. **How to investigate:** Look at the portfolio â€” does it tell a story? Does it flow naturally from one photo to the next? **Corrective steps:** Sequence the photos: start strong, build gradually, end strong, create contrast, keep it consistent. **How to confirm resolved:** The portfolio flows naturally â€” it tells a story. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before finalising the portfolio, ask: "What story does this tell? Does it start strong and end strong?"

K.3 Pricing too low â€” devaluing the work

Symptoms: The learner charges â‚¦2,000 for a set of 10 professional product photos â€” far below the market rate. **Likely cause:** The learner is afraid of losing the client, or does not understand the value of their skill. **How to investigate:** Compare the learner's prices to the market rate for similar work in Port Harcourt. **Corrective steps:** Research the market. Calculate costs. Set a fair price â€” less than an experienced photographer, perhaps, but not a fraction of the market rate. **How to confirm resolved:** The prices are fair â€” not too low, not too high. **How to prevent recurrence:** Remember: your skill has value. Free or near-free work devalues your skill and sets an expectation that your work is worth nothing.

K.4 Pricing too high â€” pricing yourself out

Symptoms: The learner charges â‚¦100,000 for a basic product shoot â€” far above the market rate for a beginner. **Likely cause:** The learner does not understand the market, or is trying to charge experienced-photographer rates as a beginner. **How to investigate:** Compare the learner's prices to the market rate for a beginner in Port Harcourt. **Corrective steps:** Research the market. As a beginner, charge less than an experienced photographer. Build your reputation, then raise your prices. **How to confirm resolved:** The prices are competitive â€” fair for a beginner. **How to prevent recurrence:** Start with fair beginner prices. Raise them as your skill and reputation grow.

K.5 Skipping the brief â€” shooting without understanding

Symptoms: The learner shows up to a shoot without knowing what the client wants â€” the purpose, the subject, the style, the deadline. **Likely cause:** The learner did not ask for a brief, or did not listen to the client's answers. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "What did the client ask for? What is the purpose? What is the deadline?" **Corrective steps:** Always start with a brief. Ask the client: What is the purpose? What is the subject? What style? How many photos? What is the deadline? What is the budget? **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can state the client's needs clearly. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make the brief the first step of every job. Never skip it.

K.6 Not obtaining consent or releases

Symptoms: The learner photographs people without asking, or uses images in a portfolio without a release. **Likely cause:** The learner does not understand the consent and release requirements. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "Did you ask permission before photographing that person? Do you have a signed release?" **Corrective steps:** Stop. Obtain consent before photographing. Obtain a release before using the image. Use the printed forms. **How to confirm resolved:** Consent and release forms are signed and filed. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make consent the first step of every portrait or event shoot. Make releases the first step of every portfolio or client use.

K.7 Not following up after delivery

Symptoms: The learner delivers the photos and never contacts the client again. **Likely cause:** The learner does not know that follow-up is part of the professional workflow. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "Did you check that the client was happy? Did you ask for feedback?" **Corrective steps:** After delivery, follow up. Check that the client is happy. Ask for feedback. If the client is happy, ask for a testimonial or referral. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has a follow-up process. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make follow-up the final step of every job. A past client is the best source of future work.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€” look at the actual portfolio, price list or workflow, and confirm the cause before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Price List and Client Workflow Sheet"

Purpose: To create a professional price list with three packages in naira and a client workflow sheet that defines the process from brief to delivery. These are the business tools you will use for the capstone and for your first paying clients.

Realistic scenario. You are preparing to launch your photography service in Port Harcourt. You need a price list that potential clients can understand and a workflow that ensures you deliver professionally every time. Your first potential client is Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices â€" the running capstone example.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Create a price list** with at least three packages. Use the Package Price List Template. For each package, state:
    - Package name (Basic, Standard, Premium)
    - What is included (number of photos, delivery time, revision rounds, any extras)
    - Price in naira (â‚¦)
2. **Set fair prices.** Research what other photographers in Port Harcourt charge. As a beginner, charge less than an experienced photographer â€" but do not work for free.
3. **Complete the Client Workflow Sheet.** For each of the six steps (brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up), state:
    - What happens in this step
    - Who is responsible
    - What the client should expect
4. **Write a short pricing philosophy** (3â€"5 sentences): "I believe photographers should charge fairly because _____. My prices are fair because _____. As my skill grows, my prices will _____."
5. **Prepare a consent form and a model release.** Use the printed templates. Fill in your name and the date. These are ready for your first client.

Required deliverables:

- A price list with three packages in naira.
- A completed Client Workflow Sheet.
- A short pricing philosophy.
- A prepared consent form and model release.

Submission format: Save as `Pricing_YourName.docx` (or `.pdf`) and upload to `/Photography/Week2/Pricing/`. You may also bring a printed copy to Session 6.

Deadline: Before Session 6.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Three packages with clear deliverables	3	Each package has a name, clear inclusions and a price
Prices are fair (in naira)	2	Not too low, not too high â€" fair for a beginner
Client Workflow Sheet completed	2	All six steps described clearly
Pricing philosophy	2	Thoughtful and honest
Consent and release forms prepared	1	Ready for use

Common mistakes to avoid: pricing too low (devaluing your work); pricing too high (pricing yourself out); vague deliverables ("some photos" instead of "10 edited photos"); skipping the workflow steps; not preparing consent forms.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong submission contains:

- **Price list:** Three packages â€" Basic (5 photos, â‚¦15,000), Standard (10 photos, â‚¦30,000), Premium (20 photos, â‚¦60,000). Each with clear deliverables.

- **Client Workflow Sheet:** Six steps, each described clearly â€" brief (client explains needs), quote (photographer provides price), shoot (photographer plans and executes), edit (photographer edits honestly), deliver (photographer delivers on time), follow-up (photographer checks satisfaction).
- **Pricing philosophy:** "I believe photographers should charge fairly because our skill, time and equipment have value. My prices are fair because I researched the market and set prices that reflect my beginner level. As my skill grows, my prices will grow too."
- **Consent and release forms:** Prepared with the photographer's name and date, ready for signatures.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is a portfolio, and what are the three rules of a strong portfolio?

Q2. Multiple choice. You are building a portfolio and you have 20 photos you like. How many should you include? a) All 20 â€" more is better b) 10 â€" a nice round number c) 5â€"8 â€" only the strongest, quality over quantity d) 3 â€" keep it very short

Q3. Explain in your own words. What is the difference between a consent form and a model release?

Q4. Practical identification. A classmate's portfolio has photos in random order â€" a product shot, then a portrait, then a landscape, then another product shot. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?

Q5. Matching. Match each step of the client workflow to what happens: **brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.** a) The photographer delivers the final photos b) The client explains what they need c) The photographer checks that the client is happy d) The photographer provides a price e) The photographer takes the photos f) The photographer edits the photos

Q6. Scenario. You are a beginner photographer. A client asks you to photograph 10 product photos. You are not sure what to charge. What are three things you should do to set a fair price?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. A portfolio is a curated collection of your best work, sequenced to tell a story. The three rules of a strong portfolio are: (1) Select ruthlessly â€" only Strong photos go in. (2) Sequence for flow â€" start strong, build gradually, end strong. (3) Show consistency â€" all photos should look like they belong together.

A2. (c) 5â€"8 â€" only the strongest, quality over quantity. A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio.

A3. A consent form is signed before the photo is taken â€" the person agrees to be photographed. A model release is signed before the image is used â€" the person agrees to let you use their image (for portfolio, client work or social media). Consent is for the shoot; the release is for the use.

A4. The problem is lack of sequencing â€" the portfolio has no flow, no story. Fix: sequence the photos deliberately â€" start strong, build gradually, end strong, create contrast, keep it consistent. Arrange them to tell a story.

A5. brief = (b); quote = (d); shoot = (e); edit = (f); deliver = (a); follow-up = (c).

A6. Three things: (1) Research the market â€" what do other photographers in Port Harcourt charge? (2) Calculate your costs â€" your time, transport, editing time. (3) Set a fair price â€" not too low (devalues your work), not too high (prices you out). As a beginner, charge less than an experienced photographer â€" but do not work for free.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that a portfolio is not "all my best photos" â€" it is the right photos in the right order, telling the right story. You learned to select ruthlessly (only Strong photos), sequence for flow (start strong, build gradually, end strong) and show consistency (all photos belong together). You learned to build a portfolio in Canva â€" a clean template, a title, your photos and brief descriptions. You learned to price your work in packages â€" clear deliverables, fair prices in naira. You learned the client workflow â€" brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up. And you learned that consent and releases are not optional â€" they are the legal and ethical foundation of professional photography. You completed a timed simulation â€" planning, shooting, editing and presenting a delivery-ready set in 15 minutes.

Five important takeaways:

1. A portfolio is the right photos in the right order â€" select ruthlessly, sequence for flow, show consistency.
2. Build your portfolio in Canva â€" clean, professional, exported as a PDF.
3. Price your work in packages â€" clear deliverables, fair prices in naira, never work for free.
4. Follow the client workflow â€" brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
5. Obtain consent and releases â€" before photographing and before using images.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I select my strongest photos and explain why they are strong?
- Can I sequence a portfolio so it tells a story?
- Can I build a portfolio page in Canva?
- Can I create a price list with three packages in naira?
- Can I describe the six steps of the client workflow?
- Can I explain the difference between consent and a release?
- Can I complete a timed simulation â€" plan, shoot, edit and present in 15 minutes?

Connection to the next session. This is it â€" the capstone. Everything you have learned in Sessions 1â€"5 comes together in Session 6. You will take your chosen brief â€" a product set for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices or a portrait set for Ms. Amaka â€" plan the shoot with a shot list, shoot it, select the strongest frames, edit the set consistently, assemble a mini portfolio and present it in a short talk. Peers and the instructor will give structured feedback. This is your proof of skill â€" the deliverable that earns your CEA Certificate in Photography.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner selects Strong photos and rejects Weak ones without hesitation.
- Learner sequences a portfolio with a clear story â€" start strong, end strong.
- Learner builds a clean, professional portfolio in Canva.
- Learner creates a price list with clear packages and fair prices in naira.
- Learner describes the client workflow accurately and completely.
- Learner obtains consent and releases before photographing and using images.
- Learner completes the timed simulation within the time limit.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A portfolio should have as many photos as possible." â†' No â€" quality over quantity. 5â€"8 Strong photos.
- "I should charge very little because I am a beginner." â†' No â€" charge fairly. Free work devalues your skill.
- "The brief is not important â€" I can figure it out as I go." â†' No â€" the brief is the foundation. Skip it and you will miss the client's needs.
- "Consent is only needed for commercial work." â†' No â€" consent is needed before photographing any person, always.
- "Follow-up is optional." â†' No â€" follow-up builds relationships and generates referrals.
- "I do not need a price list â€" I will just negotiate." â†' No â€" a clear price list makes it easy for the client to say yes.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Selection drill:** Give the learner 20 photos and have them select the strongest 5. Review together â€" are they truly the strongest?
2. **Sequencing drill:** Give the learner 5 photos and have them sequence them for flow. Review â€" does it start strong and end strong?
3. **Pricing research:** Have the learner research three photographers in Port Harcourt and compare their prices. Discuss what is fair for a beginner.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a partially completed portfolio template in Canva with the photos already inserted â€" the learner adds descriptions and adjusts the layout. Provide a price list with the packages already named â€" the learner fills in the deliverables and prices.

- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical, simulation and assignment.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to build a complete portfolio (not just one page) with a title page, an about page, a services page and a contact page. They should also create a second price list for a different type of photography (e.g., if they did products, they do portraits) and write a short marketing plan â€" how they will find their first three clients.

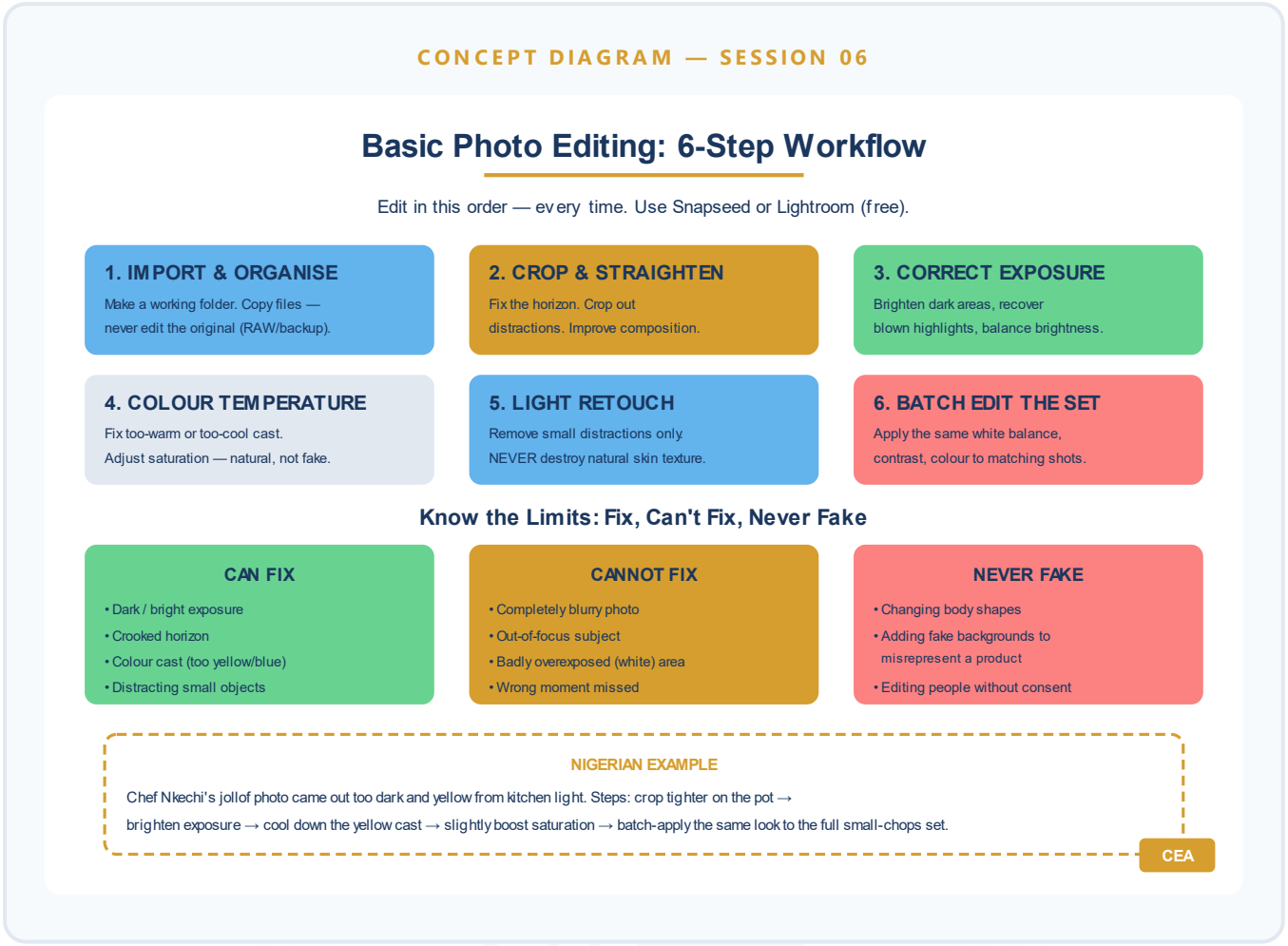
Timing guidance. The priority is learners building a portfolio, creating a price list and completing the simulation (Sections H, I and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the lecture's pricing section to the key points â€" packages, fair prices, never free â€" and protect the practical and simulation time. A learner who leaves without a portfolio, a price list and a completed simulation has no business foundation for the capstone.

END OF SESSION 5

Next: Session 6 â€" Capstone: Photo Shoot and Portfolio.

SESSION 06 OF 6

Capstone Photo Shoot and Portfolio



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 6 â€" CAPSTONE: PHOTO SHOOT AND PORTFOLIO

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	6 of 6
Session title	Capstone: Photo Shoot and Portfolio
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: "Process and Deliver"
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (practical, capstone assessment)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"5 â€" the learner should have a foundations folder, an edited set, a portfolio page, a price list and a client workflow sheet. All shooting, editing, composition, lighting and

Item	Detail
	business skills are assumed.
Connection to previous work	This is the final session and the capstone assessment. Everything learned in Sessions 1â€"5 comes together: the learner plans, shoots, edits, assembles and presents a themed photo set for a fictional Port Harcourt client. This is the deliverable that earns the CEA Certificate in Photography.
Preparation before class	The two fictional client briefs (Track A â€" Product: Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices; Track B â€" Portrait: Ms. Amaka) printed per learner; academy computers with Canva and internet access; the instructor's computer connected to the projector; printed capstone assessment rubrics; a timer for the presentation segment; consent forms for any person photographed; a simple product set (soup containers, spice jars, food items) or a portrait setup (a chair, a window, a plain background) depending on the learners' chosen tracks.

Instructor note on tone: This session is a celebration and an assessment. The learners have worked hard for two weeks â€" today they prove what they can do. Create an atmosphere of pride and professionalism. The presentations should feel like a mini graduation â€" each learner stands, presents their work, and receives structured feedback. Be warm, be specific, be honest. The goal is for every learner to leave feeling like a photographer.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Take a brief** and translate it into a one-page brief and shot plan (client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location).
2. **Shoot a themed set** of at least 5 finished images (up to 8), applying all shooting skills: sharpness, composition, light, moment and consent.
3. **Select the strongest frames** honestly and edit the set consistently using the editing workflow.
4. **Assemble a mini portfolio** in Canva with a title page, the edited set, and a contact sheet of selects.
5. **Obtain and document consent** â€" signed consent for every identifiable person in the final set (parent/guardian for under-18s), or a note that no identifiable third parties appear.
6. **Present and defend the work** in a short talk: the brief, light, compositions, edits, consent obtained and what they would do differently.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera.
- Academy computers with Canva and internet access.
- Instructor's computer connected to the projector.
- A phone tripod or improvised stand.
- A white card or reflector.
- A simple product set or portrait setup (depending on the learners' chosen tracks).

Software

- The phone's built-in camera app.
- Snapseed or Lightroom Mobile (for editing).
- Canva (free tier, for assembling the portfolio).

Accounts

- A free Canva account.

Sample files

- **The two fictional client briefs** (Track A and Track B) printed per learner.

- **The capstone assessment rubric** printed per learner (for peer feedback).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 6.1 â€" "Brief and Shot Plan" (a form: client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location).
- Worksheet 6.2 â€" "Presentation Notes" (a form: brief, light, compositions, edits, consent, what I would do differently).

Tools

- A timer for the presentation segment.
- A whiteboard and markers.

Internet

- Required for Canva. Not required for shooting or editing.

Alternative for learners who lack a capable phone

- Any phone with a working camera works. A learner without a phone may pair with a classmate, use an academy phone or use an academy computer with a webcam. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Consent and safety note: Before photographing any person â€" including classmates â€" ask for their permission first and have them sign the consent form. If someone says no, put the camera down. No exceptions. For the portrait track, the subject must be an adult, or if under 18, a parent/guardian must sign the consent form before the shutter is pressed.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show a single photograph â€" a strong, professional product shot or portrait. Do not explain it. Just show it.

What the instructor says:

> *"Look at this photo. In a moment, I am going to ask you to tell me everything you notice. Not just 'it is nice' â€" I want details. Where is the light coming from? How is the subject composed? Is it sharp? What mood does it create? What would you do differently? You have two minutes to study it. Then we will discuss."*

After two minutes, ask the class to call out what they notice. Write their observations on the board. They should identify: light direction, composition (rule of thirds, framing, leading lines), sharpness, exposure, colour, mood, background, moment.

Then reveal the lesson: Say clearly:

> *"Everything you just said â€" light, composition, sharpness, mood â€" that is what you have learned in five sessions. Today you prove it. This is your capstone: a themed photo shoot for a fictional Port Harcourt client. You will plan it, shoot it, edit it, assemble it and present it. This is not an exam â€" it is a demonstration of everything you can do. By the end of this session, you will have a mini portfolio and a presentation. That is your proof of skill â€" the deliverable that earns your CEA Certificate in Photography."*

Why this opener works: It activates everything the learners have studied â€" light, composition, sharpness, mood â€" and frames the capstone as a demonstration of skill, not a test. It builds confidence before the work begins.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five quality words for a good photograph?"

- Expected answer: Clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
- Common gap: Learners may forget one or two. Clarify: "Clarity = sharp. Light = correctly exposed. Composition = intentional arrangement. Moment = right instant. Purpose = does the job."

Question 2: "What is the editing workflow? Name the steps in order."

- Expected answer: Crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch, sharpen.
- Common gap: Learners may forget the order. Clarify: "Crop first, then exposure, then colour, then retouch, then sharpen."

Question 3: "What are the six steps of the client workflow?"

- Expected answer: Brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
- Common gap: Learners may forget follow-up. Clarify: "Brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up. Follow-up is the most forgotten â€" but it is how you build relationships."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have all the skills. Today you use them all. The capstone is not about learning something new â€" it is about proving what you already know. Plan carefully, shoot deliberately, edit honestly, present confidently. This is your moment."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the five quality words or the editing workflow, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 The capstone â€" what it is and what it requires

The idea. The capstone is the final project of the course â€" a themed photo shoot for a fictional Port Harcourt client, planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio. It is the deliverable that earns the CEA Certificate in Photography. It is not an exam â€" it is a demonstration of everything you have learned.

The two tracks (the learner chooses one):

Track A â€" Product: Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices

- Mama Nkechi is a fictional small food business in Port Harcourt.
- She needs a clean, appetising, consistent set of product images for her WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram.
- The products: pepper soup base, dried fish, spice mix, palm oil, and a bowl of finished soup.
- The style: clean, natural light, consistent look, honest editing.
- The deliverable: 5â€"8 edited product photos, assembled as a mini portfolio.

Track B â€" Portrait: Ms. Amaka

- Ms. Amaka is a fictional Port Harcourt entrepreneur.
- She needs a small set of professional, natural portraits for her business profile and social pages.
- She is an adult. For any real person under 18 photographed for practice instead, written parent/guardian consent is mandatory before the shutter is pressed.
- The style: natural light, clean background, genuine expression, honest editing.
- The deliverable: 5â€"8 edited portraits, assembled as a mini portfolio.

The required components of the capstone:

Component	What it is	Why it matters
1. Brief and shot plan	A one-page document: client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location	Shows you planned deliberately, not randomly
2. Themed set (5â€"8 images)	The finished photos, edited consistently	The core deliverable â€" the proof of skill
3. Contact sheet of selects	A grid of the raw selects before editing	Shows your selection process â€" you chose the strongest
4. Consent evidence	Signed consent for every identifiable person, or a note that no identifiable third parties appear	Legal and ethical requirement

Component	What it is	Why it matters
5. Mini portfolio (Canva)	A PDF or grid with a title page (name, course, date, client)	Professional presentation
6. Presentation	A short talk defending the work	Shows you can explain your choices â€" the mark of a professional

What success looks like:

- The set is sharp, well-lit, honestly edited and clearly usable by the client.
- The images hang together as one body of work â€" consistent, cohesive, professional.
- Every consent requirement is met.
- The learner can explain every decision â€" where they stood, where the light came from, what they cropped, what they refused to fake.
- It need not be studio-perfect â€" only honest, complete, entry-level professional work.

Real-life comparison. The capstone is like a final dish in a cooking course. You have learned the techniques â€" chopping, seasoning, cooking, plating. Now you prepare a complete meal for a guest. The guest does not expect a Michelin-star restaurant â€" they expect a well-cooked, honestly prepared meal that shows you have learned the craft. The capstone is your meal. Cook it with care.

Misconception to correct. "The capstone needs to be perfect." No. The capstone needs to be honest, complete and entry-level professional. It is not about perfection â€" it is about demonstrating that you can plan, shoot, edit, assemble and present a themed photo set. A learner who delivers an honest, complete set has passed â€" even if the photos are not magazine-cover quality.

F.2 The brief and shot plan â€" thinking before shooting

The idea. The brief and shot plan is the foundation of the capstone. It is a one-page document that forces you to think before you shoot: What does the client need? What is the concept? What shots will I take? What light will I use? Where will I shoot? A clear plan means a clear delivery.

The brief and shot plan template:

```
BRIEF AND SHOT PLAN

Photographer: _____
Client: _____
Track: [ ] Product (Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices)
       [ ] Portrait (Ms. Amaka)
Date: _____

1. CLIENT NEED
What does the client need these photos for?
_____
What is the purpose? (Catalogue, profile, social media?)
_____

2. CONCEPT
What is the overall look and feel?
_____
What style? (Clean, warm, natural, dramatic?)
_____

3. SHOT LIST
What specific shots will I take?
1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
```



```
4. LIGHT PLAN
```

```
Where will the light come from? (Window, open shade, golden hour?)
_____
What time of day? _____
Do I need a reflector? [ ] Yes [ ] No

5. LOCATION
Where will I shoot?
_____
Do I need permission to shoot there? [ ] Yes [ ] No

6. CONSENT
Who will be photographed? _____
Have they signed a consent form? [ ] Yes [ ] No
If under 18, has a parent/guardian signed? [ ] Yes [ ] No
```

Why the brief and shot plan matters:

- It forces you to think before you shoot. A plan prevents wasted time and missed shots.
- It shows the client (and the instructor) that you are professional â€" you do not just point and shoot.
- It gives you a checklist â€" you can tick off each shot as you complete it.
- It is the first component of the capstone â€" without it, the rest is incomplete.

Real-life comparison. The brief and shot plan is like a building blueprint. A builder does not start laying bricks without a plan â€" the plan ensures the building is sound, the rooms are the right size, and nothing is missing. The brief and shot plan does the same for your photo shoot â€" it ensures the set is complete, the shots are deliberate, and nothing is forgotten.

Common mistake. Skipping the plan and just shooting. This leads to missed shots, inconsistent style and a set that does not hang together. Always plan first.

F.3 Shooting the capstone set â€" applying everything

The idea. The capstone shoot is where everything comes together. You apply all the skills you have learned: sharpness, composition, light, moment, consent. The goal is a set of 5â€"8 photos that are sharp, well-lit, well-composed, honestly edited and consistent.

The shooting checklist (use this for every shot):

- ☐ **Consent obtained** â€" signed form for every person photographed
- ☐ **Light checked** â€" direction, softness, colour
- ☐ **Background checked** â€" clean, uncluttered, appropriate
- ☐ **Composition planned** â€" rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry
- ☐ **Sharpness routine** â€" steady, focus, exposure, background, frames
- ☐ **Several frames taken** â€" at least 3 per shot
- ☐ **Focus checked** â€" zoom in to confirm sharpness
- ☐ **Moment captured** â€" the right expression, the right action

Shooting tips for the capstone:

1. **Start with the plan.** Review your shot list. Know what you are going to shoot before you start.
2. **Check the light first.** Before you position the subject or product, check the light. Is it soft? Is it flattering? Is it coming from the right direction?
3. **Build the scene.** For products: clean surface, plain background, product positioned at its best angle. For portraits: clean background, subject positioned in good light.
4. **Shoot the plan.** Work through your shot list systematically. Do not skip shots.
5. **Take more than you need.** If your plan says 5 shots, take 8. You can always edit down.
6. **Review as you go.** After each shot, check the photo. Is it sharp? Is it well-lit? Is the composition right? If not, adjust and retake.
7. **Stay honest.** Do not use filters. Do not fake anything. Shoot what is real.

Real-life comparison. Shooting the capstone is like performing a piece of music you have practised. You know the notes, the rhythm, the dynamics. Now you perform it â€" not perfectly, but with skill and feeling. The performance is the proof of practice.

Common mistake. Rushing through the shoot to get it over with. The capstone is not a race. Take your time. Check each shot. The quality of the shoot determines the quality of the portfolio.

F.4 Selecting and editing the set

The idea. After the shoot, you have a folder of raw photos. Your job is to select the strongest ones and edit them consistently. This is where the editing workflow and batch editing skills come in.

The selection process:

1. Review all the raw photos from the shoot.
2. Rate each photo: Strong, Acceptable or Weak.
3. Select 5â€"8 Strong photos for the final set.
4. Create a contact sheet â€" a grid of the selected photos before editing. This shows your selection process.
5. Edit the selected photos using the workflow: crop, exposure, colour, retouch, sharpen.
6. Batch-edit for consistency â€" copy the edits from the first photo, paste to the others, review each one individually.
7. Export the final set as JPEG files.

The editing rules for the capstone:

- Edit honestly. Do not change the product's appearance. Do not fake a background. Do not reshape a body.
- Edit consistently. All photos in the set should look like they belong together.
- Edit to enhance, not to transform. The goal is a better version of reality, not a different reality.

Real-life comparison. Selecting and editing is like editing a film. The director shoots hours of footage, then selects the best scenes and edits them into a coherent story. You do the same â€" you select the best frames and edit them into a cohesive set.

Common mistake. Including a photo because you like the memory, not because it is strong. The capstone set should contain only Strong photos â€" no exceptions.

F.5 Assembling the mini portfolio in Canva

The idea. The mini portfolio is the final presentation of the capstone â€" a professional document that shows the client (and the instructor) what you can do. It is assembled in Canva and exported as a PDF.

The mini portfolio structure:

Page	What it contains
Title page	Your name, course name, date, client name
The set	5â€"8 edited photos, sequenced for flow, with brief descriptions
Contact sheet	A grid of the raw selects before editing
Consent note	A statement that consent was obtained for all identifiable people, or that no identifiable third parties appear

How to assemble the mini portfolio in Canva:

1. Open Canva. Choose a clean, simple portfolio template.
2. **Title page:** Add your name, "CEA Photography â€" Capstone," the date, and the client name.
3. **The set:** Add your 5â€"8 edited photos in the sequenced order. Add a brief description under each photo.
4. **Contact sheet:** Add a grid of your raw selects (before editing). Label it "Contact Sheet â€" Selects."
5. **Consent note:** Add a page with a statement: "Consent was obtained for all identifiable people in this set. Signed consent forms are available on request." Or: "No identifiable third parties appear in this set."
6. **Review and export:** Check the layout, spacing and alignment. Export as a PDF.

Real-life comparison. The mini portfolio is like a book. The title page is the cover. The set is the chapters. The contact sheet is the appendix. The consent note is the legal page. A good book is well-organised, easy to read and professionally presented. Your mini portfolio should be the same.

Common mistake. Rushing the portfolio assembly. The portfolio is the client's first impression of your work â€” take the time to make it clean and professional.

F.6 The presentation â€” defending your work

The idea. The presentation is the final component of the capstone â€” a short talk where you explain your work and defend your choices. This is where you show that you are not just a person who takes photos, but a professional who understands what they did and why.

The presentation structure (3â€“5 minutes per learner):

Section	What to say
1. The brief	Who is the client? What did they need? What was the purpose?
2. The plan	What was your concept? What shots did you plan? What light did you use?
3. The shoot	Where did you shoot? What challenges did you face? How did you handle them?
4. The edits	What did you change? Why? How did you keep it honest?
5. The consent	Who did you photograph? How did you obtain consent?
6. What I would do differently	What did you learn? What would you improve next time?

The presentation rules:

- Be honest. If something did not go well, say so. Honesty is a sign of professionalism.
- Be specific. Do not say "I took some photos." Say "I positioned the product near a window for soft, directional light and used the rule of thirds to place it on a grid intersection."
- Be confident. You have worked hard for two weeks. Own your work.
- Be open to feedback. The audience will give feedback â€” receive it gracefully.

Real-life comparison. The presentation is like a job interview. You are not just showing your work â€” you are explaining your thinking, your process and your professionalism. The interviewer (the client, the instructor) is judging not just the photos, but the photographer â€” can you think, can you plan, can you explain, can you learn?

Common mistake. Being vague. "I took some photos and edited them" is not a presentation. Be specific â€” explain every choice, every challenge, every decision.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- The capstone is a themed photo shoot for a fictional Port Harcourt client, planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio.
- Two tracks: Product (Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices) or Portrait (Ms. Amaka).
- Six required components: brief and shot plan, themed set (5â€“8 images), contact sheet, consent evidence, mini portfolio (Canva), presentation.
- Plan first â€” the brief and shot plan is the foundation.
- Shoot deliberately â€” apply all skills: sharpness, composition, light, moment, consent.
- Select and edit honestly â€” only Strong photos, consistent edits, no fakery.
- Assemble professionally â€” clean Canva portfolio, exported as PDF.
- Present confidently â€” explain every choice, be honest, be open to feedback.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Plan shoot] --> B[Shoot 30+ frames] --> C[Select best 5] --> D[Edit] --> E[Portfolio ready]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A completed brief and shot plan (for Track A or B).
- A set of raw photos from a sample shoot.
- A completed mini portfolio in Canva.
- A sample presentation.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” the brief and shot plan (3 minutes)

Say: "This is my brief and shot plan for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices. Watch how I think before I shoot."

Show the completed brief and shot plan. Walk through each section:

- Client need: "Mama Nkechi needs product photos for her WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram."
- Concept: "Clean, appetising, natural light, consistent look."
- Shot list: "Eight shots â€” hero shot, detail shots, context shots, variety shots."
- Light plan: "Window light, morning, reflector for fill."
- Location: "Her kitchen, near the window."
- Consent: "No people in the final set â€— products only."

Say: "A plan is not paperwork â€— it is thinking. It forces you to make decisions before you shoot, so you do not waste time and miss shots."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” selecting and editing (5 minutes)

Say: "I have 20 raw photos from the shoot. Now I select the strongest and edit them consistently."

Step 1: Show all 20 photos quickly. Rate each one. "This one is Strong â€— sharp, well-lit. This one is Weak â€— blurry. This one is Acceptable â€— slightly dark."

Step 2: Select the strongest 6. "These are my six. Quality over quantity."

Step 3: Create a contact sheet â€— a grid of the 6 selected photos before editing.

Step 4: Edit the first photo using the workflow. "Crop, exposure, colour, retouch, sharpen."

Step 5: Copy the edits, paste to the other five. Review each one. "This one needs a small exposure adjustment â€— the angle is different."

Step 6: Show the final set. "Six photos, consistent style, honest edits. This is the set."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€” assembling the portfolio (4 minutes)

Say: "Now I assemble the mini portfolio in Canva."

Step 1: Open Canva. Choose a clean template.

Step 2: Add the title page. "Chinedu Okafor â€— CEA Photography â€— Capstone â€— October 2026 â€— Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices."

Step 3: Add the six edited photos in sequence. Add brief descriptions.

Step 4: Add the contact sheet.

Step 5: Add the consent note. "No identifiable third parties appear in this set."

Step 6: Export as a PDF.

Say: "The portfolio is the client's first impression. It should be clean, organised and professional."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€” the presentation (3 minutes)

Say: "Now I present my work. Watch how I explain my choices."

Give a 3-minute presentation following the structure:

- The brief: "Mama Nkechi needs product photos for her catalogue."

- The plan: "Clean, natural light, consistent look."
- The shoot: "I photographed in her kitchen, near the window, in the morning."
- The edits: "I cropped, corrected exposure, adjusted colour, batch-edited for consistency."
- The consent: "No people in the final set â€" products only."
- What I would do differently: "Next time I would use a tripod for even sharper shots and experiment with more angles."

Say: "The presentation is not just showing photos â€" it is showing your thinking. Be specific, be honest, be confident."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why is the brief and shot plan important?" (It forces you to think before you shoot.)
- "Why select only Strong photos?" (A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio.)
- "Why batch-edit?" (For consistency â€" the set should look like it belongs together.)
- "Why is the presentation important?" (It shows you can explain your choices â€" the mark of a professional.)
- "What is the most important rule of the capstone?" (Be honest. Do not fake anything.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner completes the brief and shot plan, shoots a themed set, selects and edits the photos, and assembles a mini portfolio.

Starting materials: Learner's own phone; the chosen track brief; a product set or portrait setup; Canva on an academy computer or phone; the printed worksheets.

Procedure â€" Part 1: Brief and shot plan (4 minutes)

1. Choose your track: Product (Mama Nkechi's) or Portrait (Ms. Amaka).
2. Complete the Brief and Shot Plan worksheet. Fill in every section.
3. Review your plan with the instructor or a partner.

Procedure â€" Part 2: Shoot the set (8 minutes)

4. Set up your scene: products on a clean surface near a window, or a portrait subject in good light.
5. Obtain consent from any person photographed. Sign the consent form.
6. Work through your shot list. For each shot, use the shooting checklist.
7. Take at least 3 frames per shot. Review as you go.
8. Aim for 5â€"8 Strong photos.

Procedure â€" Part 3: Select and edit (4 minutes)

9. Review all raw photos. Rate each one: Strong, Acceptable or Weak.
10. Select 5â€"8 Strong photos. Create a contact sheet.
11. Edit the first photo using the workflow. Copy edits to the others. Review each one.
12. Export the final set as JPEG files.

Procedure â€" Part 4: Assemble the portfolio (2 minutes)

13. Open Canva. Choose a clean template.
14. Add the title page, the edited set, the contact sheet and the consent note.
15. Export as a PDF.

Expected result: A completed brief and shot plan, a set of 5â€"8 edited photos, a contact sheet, a mini portfolio (PDF) and a completed consent form.

Points to pause and predict:

- After the plan: "Is your plan clear? Do you know what you are going to shoot?"
- After the shoot: "Do you have enough Strong photos? If not, shoot more."
- After editing: "Does your set look consistent? Are all edits honest?"
- After the portfolio: "Is your portfolio clean and professional?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's plan is vague â†' Help them be specific. "What exact shots? What exact light?"
- Learner's photos are inconsistent â†' Check if they used the same light and background. Batch-edit for consistency.
- Learner's edits are dishonest â†' Remind them of the honest editing rules. "Enhance, do not deceive."
- Learner has not obtained consent â†' Stop. No consent, no photo.
- Learner's portfolio is incomplete â†' Help them prioritise. "Title page, set, consent note â€" the minimum."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Brief and shot plan completed
- ☐ Consent obtained and documented
- ☐ 5â€"8 Strong photos shot
- ☐ Contact sheet created
- ☐ Set edited consistently and honestly
- ☐ Mini portfolio assembled in Canva and exported as PDF
- ☐ Presentation notes prepared

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Prepare and deliver your capstone presentation.

Setup: You have completed your shoot, edits and portfolio. Now you prepare your presentation and deliver it to the class.

Requirements:

1. **Prepare your presentation (5 minutes):** Use the Presentation Notes worksheet. Plan what you will say for each section: brief, plan, shoot, edits, consent, what I would do differently.
2. **Deliver your presentation (3â€"5 minutes per learner):** Stand, present your portfolio on the projector, and explain your choices. Be specific, be honest, be confident.
3. **Receive feedback (2 minutes per learner):** The audience (peers and instructor) gives structured feedback using the capstone assessment rubric.

Constraints:

- Your presentation must be 3â€"5 minutes. Not shorter, not longer.
- You must use the Presentation Notes worksheet â€" do not speak from memory alone.
- You must show your portfolio on the projector â€" the audience needs to see your work.
- You must be honest â€" if something did not go well, say so.

Time allowance: 15 minutes (for preparation and the first round of presentations).

Success criteria:

- Presentation is 3â€"5 minutes.
- All six sections are covered: brief, plan, shoot, edits, consent, what I would do differently.
- The portfolio is shown on the projector.
- The learner is specific, honest and confident.
- The learner receives and acknowledges feedback.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: Use your Presentation Notes worksheet as a guide â€" do not memorise, just refer to it.
- Hint 2: Be specific. Instead of "I took some photos," say "I positioned the product near a window for soft light."
- Hint 3: If you are nervous, remember â€" you have worked hard for two weeks. You know your work. Own it.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model presentation â€" do not show learners):

A strong presentation follows this structure:

- **Brief:** "My client is Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices. She needs product photos for her WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram."

- **Plan:** "My concept was clean, appetising, natural light. I planned eight shots â€" hero, detail, context and variety."
- **Shoot:** "I photographed in her kitchen, near the window, in the morning. The light was soft and directional. I used a white card to fill shadows."
- **Edits:** "I cropped, corrected exposure, adjusted colour and batch-edited for consistency. All edits are honest â€" I did not change the products' appearance."
- **Consent:** "No people in the final set â€" products only."
- **What I would do differently:** "Next time I would use a tripod for even sharper shots and experiment with more angles."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- All six sections covered (3)
- Specific and honest (3)
- Portfolio shown on projector (2)
- Confident delivery (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Chinedu* has just completed the CEA Photography course. He has his capstone portfolio â€" a set of product photos for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices. He is ready to find his first paying client. He posts his portfolio on Instagram with the caption "Photographer available for bookings. DM for prices." After one week, he has had 15 likes but no enquiries.

Relevant facts.

- Chinedu's portfolio is strong â€" sharp, well-lit, consistent, professional.
- He has a price list â€" three packages in naira.
- He has a client workflow â€" brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
- He has consent forms ready.
- But he does not know how to reach potential clients.

Decision point. What should Chinedu do to find his first paying client?

Possible approaches.

1. Post more often on Instagram â€" consistency on social media is the key.
2. Reach out directly to small businesses in Port Harcourt â€" offer his services in person or by phone.
3. Lower his prices significantly â€" charge less than the competition to attract clients.

Recommended solution. Approach 2. Chinedu's portfolio is strong â€" his problem is visibility, not quality. Posting more on Instagram may help eventually, but the fastest way to find a first client is to reach out directly. Small businesses in Port Harcourt â€" food vendors, tailors, salons, shops â€" need product photos. Chinedu can visit them, show his portfolio on his phone, and offer his services. A face-to-face conversation with a strong portfolio is more powerful than an Instagram post.

Specific steps for Chinedu:

1. Identify 10 small businesses in his area that need product photos.
2. Visit each one â€" introduce himself, show his portfolio on his phone, explain his packages.
3. Offer a fair price â€" his Basic package (5 photos for â‚¦15,000) is an easy entry point.
4. Follow up â€" if the business is not ready now, check back in a week.
5. Deliver excellently â€" his first client is his most important marketing tool. A happy client refers others.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (post more) is passive â€" it may work eventually, but it is slow and uncertain.
- Approach 2 (reach out directly) is active â€" it requires courage, but it is the fastest way to find a first client.
- Approach 3 (lower prices) is unnecessary â€" Chinedu's prices are already fair. Lowering them further devalues his work and sets an expectation that his skill is cheap.

Professional connection. This case study illustrates the transition from student to professional. Chinedu has the skill â€" now he needs the client. The transition requires courage (reaching out), professionalism (a strong portfolio and clear pricing) and persistence (following up). The first client is the hardest â€" but once Chinedu delivers excellent work, the referrals will come.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Skipping the brief and shot plan

Symptoms: The learner starts shooting without a plan â€" no clear concept, no shot list, no light plan. **Likely cause:** The learner is eager to shoot and does not see the value of planning. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "What is your concept? What shots are you going to take? What light will you use?" **Corrective steps:** Stop the shoot. Complete the brief and shot plan first. A plan prevents wasted time and missed shots. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has a completed brief and shot plan. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make the brief and shot plan the first step of every shoot. No plan, no shoot.

K.2 Inconsistent set â€" photos do not belong together

Symptoms: The set of photos looks like they came from different shoots â€" different light, different background, different style. **Likely cause:** The learner did not use the same light and background for all photos, or did not batch-edit for consistency. **How to investigate:** Compare the photos side by side. Are the colours, brightness and style consistent? **Corrective steps:** Re-shoot using the same light and background. Batch-edit for consistency. Review each photo individually. **How to confirm resolved:** All photos in the set look like they belong together. **How to prevent recurrence:** For a themed set, use the same light, background and editing style throughout.

K.3 Dishonest edits â€" changing reality

Symptoms: The edited photos show something that was not in the original â€" a replaced sky, a removed person, a reshaped body, a changed product. **Likely cause:** The learner used editing to deceive â€" to make the photo look like something it is not. **How to investigate:** Compare the edited photos to the originals. Are there elements that were not in the original? **Corrective steps:** Undo the dishonest edits. Edit honestly â€" enhance, do not deceive. **How to confirm resolved:** The edited photos are better versions of the originals, not different images. **How to prevent recurrence:** Follow the honest editing rules. If an edit would mislead the viewer, do not do it.

K.4 Missing consent

Symptoms: The learner has photographed people without obtaining consent, or has not documented consent. **Likely cause:** The learner does not understand the consent requirement, or feels awkward asking. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "Did you ask permission before photographing that person? Do you have a signed consent form?" **Corrective steps:** Stop. Obtain consent. If the photo has already been taken, ask the subject now. If they say no, delete the photo. **How to confirm resolved:** Consent is obtained and documented for every person photographed. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make consent the first step of every portrait or event shoot. No consent, no photo.

K.5 Incomplete portfolio â€" missing components

Symptoms: The mini portfolio is missing one or more required components â€" no title page, no contact sheet, no consent note. **Likely cause:** The learner ran out of time or did not understand the requirements. **How to investigate:** Check the portfolio against the six required components. Which are missing? **Corrective steps:** Add the missing components. Prioritise: title page, set, consent note â€" the minimum. **How to confirm resolved:** All six components are present. **How to prevent recurrence:** Use the portfolio checklist. Review before submitting.

K.6 Vague presentation â€" cannot explain choices

Symptoms: The learner says "I took some photos and edited them" â€" no specifics, no explanation of choices. **Likely cause:** The learner did not prepare the presentation or does not understand the importance of explaining choices. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "Why did you choose that light? Why did you crop that way? What did you refuse to fake?" **Corrective steps:** Help the learner prepare. Use the Presentation Notes worksheet. Practice the presentation. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain every choice specifically and honestly. **How to prevent recurrence:** The presentation is a required component â€" prepare it as carefully as the photos.

K.7 Rushing the shoot â€" not enough Strong photos

Symptoms: The learner has only 2â€"3 Strong photos â€" not enough for a 5â€"8 photo set. **Likely cause:** The learner rushed through the shoot, did not take enough frames, or did not review as they went. **How to investigate:** Count the Strong photos. If fewer than 5, the shoot was insufficient. **Corrective steps:** Re-shoot. Take more frames. Review as you go. Use the shooting

checklist. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has 5â€“8 Strong photos. **How to prevent recurrence:** The capstone is not a race. Take your time. Check each shot.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€” look at the actual photos, portfolio and presentation, and confirm the cause before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Capstone Mini Portfolio and Presentation"

Purpose: To complete the capstone â€” the themed photo shoot and mini portfolio that earns the CEA Certificate in Photography. This is the final deliverable of the course.

Realistic scenario. You are a graduate of the CEA Photography course. Your capstone is your proof of skill â€” the portfolio you will show to potential clients, use to win work, and keep as the first item in your professional portfolio.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Complete the brief and shot plan** (Worksheet 6.1). Fill in every section.
2. **Shoot your themed set** â€” 5â€“8 photos for your chosen track (Product or Portrait). Use the shooting checklist. Obtain consent.
3. **Select and edit the set** â€” select the strongest photos, create a contact sheet, edit consistently and honestly.
4. **Assemble the mini portfolio in Canva** â€” title page, the set, contact sheet, consent note. Export as a PDF.
5. **Prepare your presentation** (Worksheet 6.2) â€” plan what you will say for each section.
6. **Deliver your presentation** â€” 3â€“5 minutes, specific, honest, confident.

Required deliverables:

- A completed brief and shot plan.
- A set of 5â€“8 edited photos (JPEG files).
- A contact sheet of selects.
- A mini portfolio (PDF) assembled in Canva.
- A completed consent form (or a note that no identifiable third parties appear).
- A completed Presentation Notes worksheet.

Submission format: Share the portfolio PDF and the photo folder with the instructor (via WhatsApp, Google Drive or a USB stick). Deliver the presentation in class.

Deadline: Before the end of Session 6.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Brief and shot plan completed	1	All sections filled in clearly
Themed set (5â€“8 images)	2	Sharp, well-lit, well-composed, consistent
Honest editing	2	No faked backgrounds, no changed products, no reshaped bodies
Mini portfolio assembled	2	Clean, professional, all components present
Consent documented	1	Signed forms or note that no third parties appear
Presentation	2	Specific, honest, confident, covers all six sections

Common mistakes to avoid: skipping the plan; inconsistent set; dishonest edits; missing consent; incomplete portfolio; vague presentation.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong capstone contains:

- **Brief and shot plan:** Complete, specific, thoughtful. Clear concept, shot list, light plan, location, consent plan.
- **Themed set:** 5â€“8 photos, all Strong â€” sharp, well-lit, well-composed, consistent style, honest edits.

- **Contact sheet:** A grid of the raw selects before editing â€" shows the selection process.
- **Mini portfolio:** Clean Canva layout â€" title page, sequenced set with descriptions, contact sheet, consent note. Exported as PDF.
- **Consent:** Signed forms for all people photographed, or a clear note that no identifiable third parties appear.
- **Presentation:** 3â€"5 minutes, covers all six sections â€" brief, plan, shoot, edits, consent, what I would do differently. Specific, honest, confident.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is the capstone, and what are the six required components?

Q2. Multiple choice. You are shooting your capstone product set. You have planned 8 shots but after shooting you only have 4 Strong photos. What should you do? a) Use the 4 Strong photos and fill the set with Acceptable photos. b) Re-shoot to get more Strong photos â€" the set needs 5â€"8 Strong images. c) Lower your standard â€" 4 photos is enough for a beginner. d) Use editing to make the Acceptable photos look Strong.

Q3. Explain in your own words. Why is the brief and shot plan important? What happens if you skip it?

Q4. Practical identification. A classmate's capstone portfolio has photos with different light, different backgrounds and different colour temperatures. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?

Q5. Matching. Match each capstone component to what it is: **brief and shot plan, themed set, contact sheet, consent evidence, mini portfolio, presentation.** a) A short talk defending the work b) A one-page document: client need, concept, shot list, light plan c) A grid of the raw selects before editing d) Signed consent forms or a note that no third parties appear e) 5â€"8 edited photos, consistent style f) A PDF assembled in Canva with a title page

Q6. Scenario. You are delivering your capstone presentation. You are nervous and not sure what to say. What are three things you can do to prepare and deliver a strong presentation?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. The capstone is the final project of the course â€" a themed photo shoot for a fictional Port Harcourt client, planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio. The six required components are: (1) brief and shot plan, (2) themed set (5â€"8 images), (3) contact sheet of selects, (4) consent evidence, (5) mini portfolio in Canva, (6) presentation.

A2. (b) Re-shoot to get more Strong photos â€" the set needs 5â€"8 Strong images. A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio. Do not lower your standard or fill the set with Acceptable photos.

A3. The brief and shot plan is important because it forces you to think before you shoot â€" what does the client need, what is the concept, what shots will you take, what light will you use. If you skip it, you waste time, miss shots, and produce an inconsistent set.

A4. The problem is inconsistency â€" the photos do not look like they belong together. Fix: re-shoot using the same light and background for all photos. Batch-edit for consistency. Review each photo individually.

A5. brief and shot plan = (b); themed set = (e); contact sheet = (c); consent evidence = (d); mini portfolio = (f); presentation = (a).

A6. Three things: (1) Use the Presentation Notes worksheet â€" plan what you will say for each section. (2) Be specific â€" instead of "I took some photos," say "I positioned the product near a window for soft light." (3) Remember â€" you have worked hard for two weeks. You know your work. Own it. (Also acceptable: practice with a partner, take a deep breath before you start, focus on being honest rather than perfect.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you completed your capstone â€" the final project of the CEA Photography course. You chose a track (Product or Portrait), planned your shoot with a brief and shot plan, shot a themed set of 5â€"8 photos, selected the strongest frames, edited them consistently and honestly, assembled a mini portfolio in Canva, and presented your work in a

short talk. You applied everything you have learned in five sessions: sharpness, composition, light, moment, editing, pricing, client workflow, consent and presentation. This is your proof of skill â€" the deliverable that earns your CEA Certificate in Photography.

Five important takeaways:

1. The capstone is a complete photo job â€" planned, shot, edited, assembled and presented.
2. Plan first â€" the brief and shot plan is the foundation of a successful shoot.
3. Shoot deliberately â€" apply all skills: sharpness, composition, light, moment, consent.
4. Edit honestly â€" enhance, do not deceive. Consistency is key.
5. Present confidently â€" explain every choice, be honest, be open to feedback.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I plan a photo shoot with a clear brief and shot list?
- Can I shoot a themed set of 5â€"8 Strong photos?
- Can I select the strongest frames and edit them consistently and honestly?
- Can I assemble a professional mini portfolio in Canva?
- Can I obtain and document consent for every person I photograph?
- Can I present my work and explain my choices confidently?
- Can I describe the client workflow from brief to follow-up?
- Can I price my work fairly in naira?

Connection to the future. You are now a graduate of the CEA Photography course. You have the skills to plan, shoot, edit, price and present professional-quality photographs. Your capstone portfolio is the first item in your professional portfolio â€" use it to win your first clients. Continue to practise, continue to learn, and continue to build your portfolio. "From Zero to Expert, Together" â€" you are no longer zero. You are an entry-level photographer with a foundation to build on. The journey continues.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner completes the brief and shot plan without being reminded.
- Learner shoots a consistent set â€" same light, same background, same style.
- Learner selects only Strong photos and edits them honestly.
- Learner assembles a clean, professional mini portfolio in Canva.
- Learner obtains and documents consent for every person photographed.
- Learner presents confidently â€" explains every choice specifically and honestly.
- Learner receives feedback gracefully and responds thoughtfully.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "The capstone needs to be perfect." â†' No â€" it needs to be honest, complete and entry-level professional.
- "I can skip the plan and just shoot." â†' No â€" the plan is the foundation. No plan, no shoot.
- "I can fill the set with Acceptable photos." â†' No â€" only Strong photos. Quality over quantity.
- "I can fake edits to make the photos look better." â†' No â€" honest editing is non-negotiable.
- "Consent is not needed for the capstone." â†' No â€" consent is always required for identifiable people.
- "The presentation is just showing photos." â†' No â€" it is explaining your thinking. Be specific.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Plan review:** Have the learner complete the brief and shot plan, then review it together. Is it specific? Is it complete?
2. **Consistency check:** Have the learner shoot three photos of the same subject in the same light. Review â€" are they consistent?
3. **Presentation practice:** Have the learner practise the presentation with a partner. Give feedback on specificity and confidence.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a partially completed brief and shot plan â€" the learner fills in the shot list and light plan. Provide a shooting checklist with every step spelled out. Pair the learner with a confident learner for the shoot.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical, presentation and assignment.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to shoot both tracks (Product and Portrait) and assemble two mini portfolios. They should also write a short marketing plan â€" how they will find their first three paying clients â€" and present it to the class.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners completing the capstone â€" shooting, editing, assembling and presenting (Sections H, I and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the lecture's brief and shot plan section to the key points â€" client need, concept, shot list, light plan â€" and protect the practical and presentation time. A learner who leaves without a completed capstone has not earned the certificate.

END OF SESSION 6

Congratulations â€" you have completed the CEA Photography course. From Zero to Expert, Together.